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Second Edition

Pathfinder®



Kingmaker

ADVENTURE PATH

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CONTENT WARNING

The *Pathfinder Kingmaker Adventure Path*, *Pathfinder Kingmaker Bestiary (5E)*, *Pathfinder Kingmaker Bestiary (First Edition)*, and *Pathfinder Kingmaker Companion Guide* contain typical Pathfinder action and adventure, player options, creatures, and more. They also include content related to child abuse and neglect, graphic depictions of torture and violence, substance abuse, and other themes that are appropriate for more mature audiences. Before you run this adventure or use any of the supplementary sourcebooks, understand that consent from everyone at the table—including the players and the Game Master—is vital to a safe and fun play experience. You should talk with your players before beginning the adventure and modify descriptions or events as appropriate.

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INTRODUCTION
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INTO THE STOLEN LANDS

For generations, the Stolen Lands have spanned the southern border of Brevoy. Many attempts have been made to settle them, but to date, none have succeeded, making these 35,000 square miles of wilderness the largest swath of unclaimed land in the entire River Kingdoms. As tensions mount in Brevoy, one of Rostland's swordlords hopes to change that fact; she plans to issue charters to several groups of adventurers, sending them south into the Stolen Lands to reopen old trade routes and defeat the bandits and monsters who have made them too dangerous to use. By sending free agents south, this swordlord of Rostland hopes to create new allies without sacrificing her own position of power in Brevoy.

Yet as with most complex and brilliant plans, the future holds plenty of opportunities for disaster.

CAMPAIGN SYNOPSIS

The *Kingmaker Adventure Path* begins as the player characters attend a feast at Lady Jamandi Aldori's manor in Brevoy, where she reveals to all those in attendance her plans to transform the Stolen Lands into a new nation. After a night of unexpected chaos, where the PCs get their first chance to impress Lady Aldori by helping to defend her home against a group of criminals, they're given their first assignment. The PCs are sent into the Stolen Lands to begin taming the wilderness, with the goal of eventually establishing a brand new nation.

Before they can get truly started, though, they need to begin exploring the wilderness. Using a remote trading post (which is also dealing with frequent bandit raids) as an initial base of operations, the PCs start to explore and map the Stolen Lands. It won't be long before they clash against the most dangerous bandits in the region—a band led by a notorious villain known as the Stag Lord. Locating the Stag Lord's base of operations requires exploration and, when the fort is discovered, careful planning and a bit of luck to prevail against the Stag Lord and his brutal bandit minions.

With the Stag Lord's defeat, the PCs establish themselves as a dominant force in the region, and they can begin to build. A wide range of threats reveal themselves as their kingdom grows, including a troll uprising, an attack by an immense owlbear, political operatives from the neighboring kingdom of Pitax waging a propaganda war, and a sinister cult of Lamashtu who hope to merge the magic of the First World with that of the Abyss. The greatest threat the PCs will face may go unnoticed at first. The nymph queen Nyrissa has been cursed by a demigod known as the Lantern King, and in order to escape her fate, she must destroy nations, and the PCs' new kingdom sits at the top of her list to ruin.

When the population of nearby Varnhold vanishes, the PCs are drawn east into conflict with an ancient cyclops lich named Vordakai. By defeating him, the PCs' nation grows significantly, drawing further attention from competitors to the east—the baron of the nearby town of Fort Drelev, the Tiger Lord barbarians, and the jealous ruler of the neighboring nation of Pitax. As the PCs clash against these new foes, their nation's strength only grows, and in time it becomes a full-fledged kingdom.

It's at this point that the ruler of Pitax, King Irovetti, makes a fateful move. He invites the PCs to take part in a tournament, but this invitation is nothing more than a distraction during which he launches an attack on the PCs' nation. The War of the River Kings follows, and if the PCs can defeat King Irovetti they'll be able to ally with or even annex the city of Pitax, spread their kingdom further, and explore some of their realm's most dangerous locations.

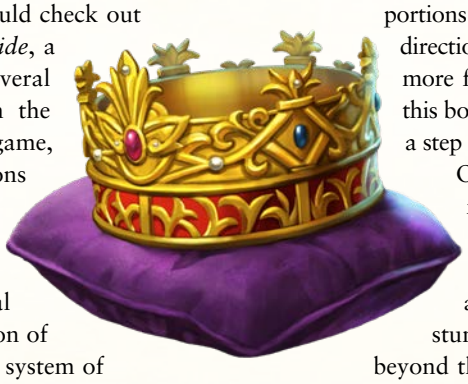
Eventually, the Stolen Lands are stolen no more, and become a thriving nation of their own under the rule of the player characters. It's at this point the nymph queen Nyrissa makes her move and the PCs finally learn the true depth of her influence over the events they've experienced in the campaign. Nyrissa invades the PCs' kingdom from the First World, infesting the realm with supernatural blooms of fey power and uprisings of strange and deadly monsters. The PCs must confront Nyrissa in her eerie realm if they wish to keep their kingdom. Yet with her defeat a greater truth is revealed. Whether the PCs defeat Nyrissa in combat or forgive her for her past misdeeds, the Lantern King grows angry. A final confrontation with this potent demigod will test the PCs to their limits, and could not only save Nyrissa from her fate but change the future of the River Kingdoms forever!

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RUNNING KINGMAKER

Kingmaker is a complete Pathfinder Second Edition campaign based on one of the most popular Adventure Paths of all time. While there's more than enough content in this massive book to bring a party of PCs from 1st to 20th level, Game Masters who want to expand upon the adventure should check out the *Kingmaker Companion Guide*, a 128-page book that presents several NPC companions drawn from the *Pathfinder: Kingmaker* video game, each with their own player options and additional quests ready to enhance your playthrough of Kingmaker. The *Companion Guide* also includes additional details to spice up the exploration of the Stolen Lands, from a robust system of downtime actions the PCs can take while camping in the wilds, to rules for how weather related events and hazards can complicate exploration.



As with all of Paizo's Adventure Paths, Kingmaker has a lively community forum online at **paizo.com/community/forums**. There, you'll find great GM advice, helpful tools to make your game better, questions answered and behind-the-scenes stories from the Paizo team, and even full-fledged gamer-made expansions to the campaign!

RUNNING THE CAMPAIGN

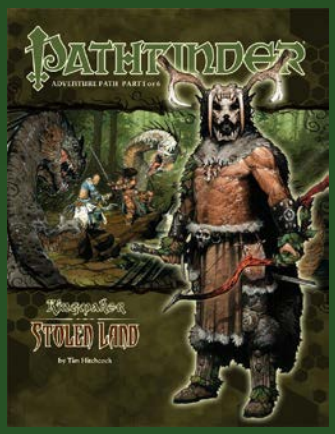
Kingmaker features a primary storyline summarized in the Campaign Synopsis section on the previous page, but there is no set path that the PCs must follow as the story unfolds. This type of campaign, known as a sandbox, brings specific challenges. The framework of the story—particularly the points at which NPCs make requests of the PCs—is meant to guide the players, but for large portions of the campaign, they'll determine the direction the adventure actually takes. The more familiar you are with the contents of this book, the easier it will be for you to stay a step or two ahead of the PCs.

One of the primary difficulties in running a sandbox is that the locations the PCs choose to explore won't necessarily hold challenges appropriate for their level; they can stumble into an encounter that's well beyond their capabilities or one so easy that it's no challenge at all. So, throughout this book, each encounter is assigned a numeric severity level equal to the character level that we expect most parties to be at when they encounter that content. When your party is heading into an encounter that's above their level, consider giving them a bit of advance warning in the form of ominous clues, disturbing omens, or even something as obvious as having them find an old signpost with the words "DANGER AHEAD" scrawled on it. You can also use the NPCs they encounter along the way to guide them; friendly allies can warn the party of terrible threats near their intended destination or suggest reasons to explore more suitable locations instead. The map of the Stolen Lands on pages 56-57

RETURNING TO KINGMAKER

The *Kingmaker Adventure Path* originally appeared in *Pathfinder Adventure Path* #31–36. While those who have played that version of the campaign will find familiar elements within these pages, much has changed. We've added to the beginning and ending, as well as expanding several adventure sites within the Stolen Lands. Some of these draw inspiration from Owlcat's *Pathfinder: Kingmaker* computer game, while others are entirely new to this book. Many of these revisions were inspired by extensive player feedback on the **paizo.com** forums.

If you're new to Kingmaker, now's your chance to experience a campaign that became legendary, a full sandbox experience where your players can chart the course of their own nation!



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KINGMAKER: STORY MILESTONES

Milestone	Chapter and Part(s)	Party Level upon Completion
Defend Oleg's Trading Post from the bandits	Chapter 3, Part 1	2
Defeat the Thorn River Bandits	Chapter 3, Part 2	3
Defeat the Stag Lord	Chapter 3, Part 3	4
Complete your first Kingdom Turn	Chapter 4, Part 1	5
Defeat the troll lord Hargulka and The Beast	Chapter 4, Parts 2–3	6
Discover the location of the Cradle of Lamashtu	Chapter 5, Parts 1–2	7
Defeat the Cult of the Bloom	Chapter 5, Part 3	8
Arrive at the entrance to Vordakai's tomb	Chapter 6, Parts 1–3	9
Defeat Vordakai	Chapter 6, Part 4	10
Defend Tatzlford from attack	Chapter 7, Part 1	11
Liberate Fort Drelev and defeat its baron	Chapter 7, Part 2	12
Defeat Armag the Twice-Born	Chapter 7, Part 3	13
Complete participation at the Rushlight Festival	Chapter 8, Part 1	14
Rescue Evindra and reach 30 Liberation in Pitax	Chapter 8, Parts 3–4	15
Defeat King Irovetti	Chapter 8, Part 5	16
Defeat Foras	Chapter 9, Part 2	17
Discover a way to enter Thousandbreaths	Chapter 9, Part 2	18
Reach the House at the Edge of Time	Chapter 10, Parts 2–3	19
Defeat, forgive, or ally with Nyrissa	Chapter 10, Part 3	20

breaks this campaign into 20 different zones; you can use this map as a handy guide to determine how dangerous a region is before the PCs enter it.

Kingmaker offers many more possible encounters for each level than a party actually needs to advance in power. This means that some of the encounters might never occur in your game, and that's fine! You can always save encounters or even entire dungeons for use in other campaigns. Certainly, a group who accomplishes every single encounter in this campaign will eventually outpace the challenges and find themselves reaching 20th level well before the campaign's end. If you and your group are okay with this, that's fine; it can be fun to blast through content with powerful characters, after all! If you want to spread things out, you can use the slow advancement speed as detailed on page 509 of the *Core Rulebook* so that the PCs will need to complete more encounters.

For a sandbox game like Kingmaker, story-based leveling can be awkward since a big part of the fun of a sandbox campaign is the freedom to explore, get in over your head, retreat and build up power, then return for a rematch against a foe that was once too powerful. Without experience points to represent their progression through the game, players lack a method of tracking and anticipating when they'll be gaining levels, and this can complicate play. If you decide to abandon XP and simply choose when the characters level up, it's recommended that you use 19 specific milestones that, as the PCs complete them, provide excellent points for the party to level up. The table above lists 19 potential milestones, and can also help the GM visualize the expected progression of the party's journey through this campaign.

QUEST SIDEBARS

Throughout Kingmaker, the PCs do more than just encounter the dangers of the Stolen Lands. They'll also solve mysteries, help locals, defeat evil, and otherwise become involved in the unfolding saga of events that compose the Adventure Path. These individual quests are often not connected to one another but, taken as a whole, they weave a complex web of plots. An alphabetical index of quests appears on pages 622–623.

These quests are presented throughout this campaign as quest sidebars, with the following listed after the quest's name.

XP: The experience points the PCs gain for finishing the quest are in addition to any experience points they may earn during the quest by defeating foes, navigating hazards, or earning additional rewards. Some quests also grant Kingdom XP; in this case, the Kingdom XP is listed separately here from the PCs' XP reward. The XP reward is followed by a short description of the quest itself.

Source: This lists the quest's source, be it a found document, a needy NPC, or something else.

Completion: This reveals what the PCs must do in order to complete the quest to earn the XP reward.

Reward: This describes any non-XP reward for completing the quest. In most cases, the PCs must return to the source of the quest to claim such a reward; exceptions and clarifications are detailed here as needed.

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CHARACTER CREATION

When your players create their characters for this Adventure Path, provide them with the information presented here. This section not only provides context for creating characters that fit in well with the region and themes but also helps to manage player expectations for the campaign. A spoiler-free version of this section can be found for free online at **paizo.com** as the *Pathfinder Kingmaker Player's Guide*.

ANCESTRY

Amid the constant threat of civil war, the inhabitants of Brevoy have more pressing concerns than their neighbors' ancestries, and few judge anyone by that alone. Brevans value custom and loyalty; thus, anyone who adheres to local traditions enjoys a high degree of tolerance and acceptance. As such, the region boasts a diverse population.

Characters don't have to be from Brevoy to play the *Kingmaker Adventure Path*, but since the campaign begins as the party receives a charter from the swordlords of Restov, and the initial approach into the Stolen Lands is from Brevoy, players should consider how members of their character's ancestry and class function in this northern kingdom.

The common ancestries from the *Core Rulebook* all work seamlessly with Kingmaker. If a player is considering a rare or uncommon ancestry from another source, the GM should consider challenges and opportunities the story and setting may present for that character, as highlighted below.

THEMATIC ANCESTRIES

Groups of antagonistic kobolds and lizardfolk reside in the Stolen Lands, so players who make characters with these ancestries may have to make difficult choices. Alternately, the presence of such a PC can, at the GM's discretion, make alliances with these groups more likely.

With Kingmaker's thematic ties to the First World, a leshy character could be a fun player option. Likewise, a sprite character might find themselves faced with unexpected advantages or disadvantages in portions of this adventure where the First World has a stronger

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role. It's best for a sprite PC to have no knowledge of the Adventure Path's key villains and very limited knowledge of the First World; a sprite who has lived their whole life on the Material Plane works better in Kingmaker than one who is more familiar with the First World's strangeness.

The proximity of Numeria to the Stolen Lands also makes it likely that some androids and ratfolk have drifted east into the region.

UNAFFILIATED ANCESTRIES

Hobgoblins, along with many of the versatile heritages such as those touched by the planes or beastkin, aren't that common in the region, but neither are they unknown or as unexpected as something like catfolk or tengu. And unlike lizardfolk or kobolds, most in the Stolen Lands don't hold a bias against these ancestries, and they make relatively safe, low-impact options for PCs in Kingmaker. (For a PC with a versatile heritage such as changeling, dhampir, or one of the planar scions, their primary ancestry will also impact how well they fit in Kingmaker.) While azarketi would also fit this category, the lack of opportunities to excel in underwater or aquatic environments makes them a particularly poor choice for this campaign.

UNUSUAL ANCESTRIES

Catfolk, fetchlings, fleshwarps, kitsune, strix, and tengu are not well-known in the Stolen Lands; if players choose from these options, they may often be regarded as unusual or curious visitors by denizens in the River Kingdoms. GMs might want to play up some NPCs' reactions to characters of unexpected ancestries, or consider altering some NPC ancestries to match those characters—if only to help explain why some people in the Stolen Lands know that a catfolk isn't a werecreature!

BACKGROUNDS

Players should choose a background from the list of campaign-specific ones provided on page 12, since these build thematic, story-based links between the characters and the Kingmaker storyline without spoiling the surprises to come. That said, a player who prefers to choose a background from the *Core Rulebook* would be well-suited to choose one of the following thematic choices: animal whisperer, bounty hunter, criminal, emissary, farmhand, field medic, guard, herbalist, hermit, hunter, laborer, merchant, miner, noble, nomad, scout, or warrior.

Backgrounds from the *Advanced Player's Guide* that are thematically appropriate include bandit, cook, courier, outrider, pilgrim, refugee, scavenger, squire, and tax collector.

Certain rare backgrounds from the *Advanced Player's Guide* are also appropriate thematic choices for Kingmaker, including amnesiac, cursed, and royalty. The Feybound rare background is also thematically appropriate, but be careful about building in previous visits to the First World for any PC, as Kingmaker assumes that the first visit to this plane for the heroes happens "on screen" during the campaign itself.

CLASSES

With a wide range of challenges ahead in Kingmaker, a party would benefit greatly from having an equally wide range of character classes represented in the group. A few things to keep in mind for each of the classes are summarized below.

ALCHEMIST

While alchemy doesn't play a particularly important role in the *Kingmaker Adventure Path*, an alchemist still has plenty of opportunities to shine in this campaign, particularly if they focus their research as chirurgeons or mutagenists.

BARBARIAN

The most active barbarians within the Stolen Lands are the Tiger Lords, but they're a violent band of warmongers who play the role of antagonists in the campaign. As such, the Tiger Lords make a poor choice for a PC affiliation. If a player wants their barbarian character to have an affiliation with a local group, work with your GM to generate specifics. If a player chooses to play a member of the Tiger Lords, GMs should work with them to ensure that they won't have knowledge about the current activities of the group to avoid spoiling plotlines. An exiled Tiger Lord barbarian could make for a compelling character who eventually could help the party to more easily recruit the Tiger Lords as allies. The most thematic instincts for a Kingmaker barbarian include animal, dragon, and fury.

BARD

A bard's ability to sway crowds and manipulate social events will often come in handy during Kingmaker. All bard muses are appropriate choices for Kingmaker, particularly if a bard's specific muse is associated with Brevoy, the River Kingdoms, or the First World. King Irovetti, the ruler of the neighboring kingdom of Pitax, fancies himself a renowned artist and entertainer, yet stifles the artists in his realm, so a bard character who fled Pitax could have a ready-made goal to return and start a cultural revolution. Such a bard should not be someone who views King Irovetti as an ally or a source of inspiration, though!

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CHAMPION

Holy warriors are relatively uncommon in the River Kingdoms, though they are not completely absent from the region. Champions who serve Cayden Cailean, Desna, Erastil, or Shelyn are the most thematically appropriate choices for Kingmaker.

CLERIC

All nations have need of healers and spiritual leaders, but those struggling to find their footing at the edge of civilization benefit most from the presence of clerics. While clerics of any faith will find roles in this campaign, deities who have strong thematic ties to events in Kingmaker include Calistria, Cayden Cailean, Desna, Erastil, Gorum, Gozreh, and Shelyn.

DRUID

Druidic traditions are strong in the Stolen Lands, particularly those linked to the First World. The worship of Gozreh and members the Green Faith are the most common druidic traditions followed in the region, while the animal, leaf, and wild druidic orders are the most appropriate choices for Kingmaker.

FIGHTER

The esteemed and exclusive schools of the Aldori swordlords train many of Brevoy's numerous fighters, especially in the southern region of Rostland, so Kingmaker is an excellent opportunity to play a character interested in eventually becoming a swordlord. Alternately, with a focus on mass combat later in the story, a fighter who builds toward a role as a general can be an appropriate choice.

GUNSLINGER

The people of Brevoy and the River Kingdoms know about guns, but these weapons remain incredibly rare in the region. As this is an uncommon class, a player should work with their GM before building a gunslinger, and the GM should be comfortable adjusting the campaign as needed to support this type of character's specialized resource needs.

INVENTOR

Inventors certainly exist in Brevoy and the River Kingdoms, particularly those who are influenced by the futuristic technology of neighboring Numeria. Since rules for advanced technology are not available for *Pathfinder Second Edition* at this time, a player could reskin and adjust descriptions of an inventor PC's abilities and creations to give them a Numerian feel, provided the GM approves. As with the gunslinger, since this is an uncommon class, the player should work with their GM before building an inventor.

INVESTIGATOR

There are plenty of mysteries in the Stolen Lands, and an investigator will have plenty to do throughout this campaign. All investigator methodologies are thematically appropriate for Kingmaker.

MAGUS

While there are no significant organizations associated with this class in the Stolen Lands, the magus is hardly unknown to the people of Brevoy or the River Kingdoms. All categories of hybrid study for the magus work well for the campaign.

MONK

As there are no established or significant monastic orders in the Stolen Lands or the surrounding regions, a traveling explorer or pilgrim likely makes the most sense for a monk character. A monk who seeks to establish their own order may well find an opportunity to do so while the party's kingdom expands.

ORACLE

Oracles are an excellent thematic choice for this campaign, particularly their curses, though it's probably best to keep an oracle's curse self-contained rather than shoehorn it into larger plots in the campaign. The most thematically appropriate mysteries for an oracle are ancestors, battle, life, and tempest.

PSYCHIC

Psychics are not well-known in the Stolen Lands, and most who encounter one would be quick to assume the character is some sort of sorcerer. Emotional acceptance is a strong thematic choice for your subconscious mind.

RANGER

The Stolen Lands make ranger an excellent choice for Kingmaker, especially if the player wants to play a bounty hunter, ex-bandit, explorer, or survivalist.

ROGUE

As with bards, rogues will find many opportunities to manipulate social encounters throughout the campaign. An ex-bandit or a bounty hunter might be a good choice for a rogue character, as would something like a spy or even a diplomat. All rogue rackets are sound choices for Kingmaker.

SORCERER

Kingmaker's thematic ties to the First World make the fey and nymph bloodlines obvious choices for a sorcerer character. While any bloodline will have a chance to stand out, other bloodlines that have thematic ties to Kingmaker include draconic, elemental, and imperial.

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SUMMONER

Summoners of the Godcaller tradition are the most commonly encountered summoners in the region. The best choices, thematically, for a Kingmaker summoner's eidolon include beast, dragon, fey, and plant.

SWASHBUCKLER

Although swashbucklers are often portrayed as counterculture elements that make their names as rebels or oppositional forces to the government, swashbucklers can find plenty of opportunities to excel and stand out in Kingmaker. As long as a swashbuckler character supports the party's kingdom, all swashbuckler styles are thematically appropriate.

THAUMATURGE

Thaumaturges in the region are often misunderstood as investigators, wizards, or other scholars. All thaumaturge implements have use in this campaign, but your GM may have suggestions about specific choices that might mesh well with the game's theme.

WITCH

Witches are quite appropriate for a Kingmaker campaign, particularly if they choose a thematically synergistic patron. Curse, fate, and wild are the most relevant choices.

WIZARD

There are no specific arcane traditions of note in the Stolen Lands, making this an excellent opportunity for a wizard character to establish a school of their own in their kingdom. Any choice of arcane thesis works well for the campaign.

OTHER CONSIDERATIONS

The following should be considered when creating PCs for Kingmaker.

ALIGNMENT

Kingmaker works best if the PCs share at least one primary alignment in common, but as long as the players work well together any alignment can function in this campaign.

ANIMAL COMPANIONS/FAMILIARS

While a character with an animal companion or familiar is not limited in their choices in Kingmaker, the following animals are native to the region and thematically appropriate for this campaign: arboreal sapling, badger, bat, bear, bird, boar, cat, horse, riding drake, scorpion, snake, or wolf.

SKILLS AND FEATS

Wilderness exploration plays a major role in Kingmaker, which means that more action-based skills like Acrobatics and Athletics are as valuable as wilderness skills like Nature and Survival. The ability to track creatures is particularly useful in certain Kingmaker encounters. Social skills like Deception, Diplomacy, and Intimidation will be quite useful, particularly when the heroes are interacting with visitors or antagonists from neighboring realms. Strong choices for Lore specialties include Architecture, Banditry, Brevoy, Farming, First World, Fishing, Forest, Heraldry, Herbalism, Hills, Hunting, Iobaria, Labor, Mercantile, Mining, Mountains, Legal, Pitax, Plains, Politics, River, Scouting, Swamp, and Warfare. In addition, Lore skills focused on deities



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or types of creatures that play important roles in this campaign are excellent choices: Calistria, Cayden Cailean, Desna, Erastil, Gorum, Gozreh, and Shelyn are obvious choices for deity lore, along with Eldest Lore for knowledge of the pantheon of fey demigods; for creatures, the strongest thematic choices would include Boggard, Dragon, Fey, Kobold, Lizardfolk, and Troll Lore. If a player wants to choose a monster Lore, the GM should work with them to suggest options without spoiling too much.

ARCHETYPES

All multiclass archetypes work well for a Kingmaker campaign. Other thematically appropriate archetypes from the *Advanced Player's Guide* include archaeologist, assassin, beastmaster, bounty hunter, celebrity, herbalist, horizon walker, loremaster, marshal, scout, and snarecrafter. The Aldori Duelist archetype from the *Lost Omens World Guide* is an excellent thematic choice, as this campaign begins in Rostland, the home of this fighting style, and the PCs' association with Jamandi Aldori is a great way to unlock access to this archetype.

BUILDING A KINGDOM

As the campaign progresses, players build their own kingdom, found settlements, and go to war with enemy nations. This Adventure Path's rules for building kingdoms, settlements, and fighting wars should be provided to the players so that they can be familiar with them and reference them as needed during play.

LANGUAGES

Kingmaker takes place in the Stolen Lands, where Common is the most widespread language. Other strong choices for languages in Kingmaker include Aklo, Boggard, Cyclops, Draconic, Dwarven, Elven, Gnomish, Goblin, Hallit, Iruxi, Jotun, Necril, Sylvan.

KINGMAKER BACKGROUNDS

The following rare backgrounds are specifically tailored to fit the themes of the *Kingmaker Adventure Path*.

BORDERLANDS PIONEER — BACKGROUND

You have long lived along the southern border of Brevoy, in the shadow of the wilderness known as the Stolen Lands. Life has been hard, but through hunting, trapping, trading, and coaxing crops from the ground, you've learned how to survive on the rugged frontier. Whether because of your personal expertise and familiarity with the borderlands or in order to reclaim your family's land, you've joined the expedition into the Stolen Lands.

Choose two ability boosts. One must be to Strength or Wisdom, and one is a free ability boost.

You're trained in the Nature skill and a Lore skill associated with a particular type of wilderness (choose from forest, hills, mountains, plains, rivers, or swamp). You gain the Train Animal skill feat.

BREVIC NOBLE — BACKGROUND

You claim a tangential but legitimate connection to one of Brevoy's noble families. If you aren't human, you were adopted by one of Brevoy's nobles or were perhaps a favored servant or even a childhood friend of a noble scion. Whatever the case, you've had a comfortable life, though still a far cry from the one your distant cousins or close associates know. An expedition into the storied Stolen Lands seems like just the test to see if you really are worthy of the "noble" title.

Choose two ability boosts. One must be to Constitution or Wisdom, and one is a free ability boost.

Choose one of the Brevic lineages below.

Garess: Family ties to the Golushkin Mountain dwarves left its mark. Your family motto is "Strong as the Mountains." You're trained in the Crafting skill and the Architecture Lore skill. You gain the Specialty Crafting skill feat.

Lebeda: Your family's history of trading along the shores of Lake Reykal pervades your blood. Your family motto is "Success through Grace." You're trained in the Society skill and the Mercantile Lore skill. You gain the Multilingual skill feat.

Lodovka: Your family has made a living off the coasts of the Lake of Mists and Veils since before Brevoy existed. Your family motto is "The Waters, Our Fields." You're trained in the Athletics skill and the Fishing Lore skill. You gain the Underwater Marauder skill feat.

Medvyed: Your family has a deep respect for the wilderness and is skilled at hunting and surviving off the land. Your family motto is "Endurance Overcomes All." You're trained in the Survival skill and the Hunting Lore skill. You gain the Terrain Expertise skill feat (choose your terrain from aquatic, forest, mountain, plains, or swamp).

Orlovsky: Your family has a reputation for avoiding conflicts. Your family motto is "High Above." You're trained in the Diplomacy skill and the Brevoy Lore skill. You gain the Group Impression skill feat.

Surtova: Your family is well known for their political agility and scheming nature. Your family motto is "Ours Is the Right." You're trained in the Deception skill and the Politics Lore skill. You gain the Charming Liar skill feat.

BREVIC OUTCAST — BACKGROUND

One of your parents was a member of one of the great families of Brevoy, perhaps even of the line of Rogarvia itself. Yet you have no substantive proof of your nobility, and you've learned that claiming such without evidence is a fool's game. Whether a recent attempt to prove your heritage brought down the wrath of a noble family or you seek to prove the worth of the blood in your veins, you've joined an expedition into the Stolen Lands, hoping to make a name all your own.

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INTRODUCTION
INTO THE STOLEN LANDS
RUNNING KINGMAKER
CHARACTER CREATION

Choose two ability boosts. One must be to Charisma or Constitution, and one is a free ability boost.

You're trained in the Politics Lore skill. You take a –1 penalty on all Charisma-based skill checks attempted when dealing with members of the nobility, but gain the Haughty Obstinacy human ancestry feat, even if you aren't a human. If you manage to establish yourself as a true noble or secure a leadership role in a kingdom, you no longer take the penalty to Charisma-based checks.

ISSIAN PATRIOT BACKGROUND

You grew up in northern Brevoy, but the call for heroes willing to help take back your country's rightful holdings in the Stolen Lands has inflamed your dreams of profit and possibilities, and you have joined an expedition journeying south.

Choose two ability boosts. One must be to Dexterity or Intelligence, and one is a free ability boost.

You're trained in the Society skill and the Legal Lore skill. You gain the Streetwise skill feat.

LOCAL BRIGAND BACKGROUND

You hail from the River Kingdoms or the more lawless reaches of Brevoy. Your life has been hard. You know how to ambush travelers, bully traders, avoid the law, and camp where no one can find you. Recently, you've run into some trouble, either with the law or with other bandits, and you're looking to get away to somewhere no one would ever think to look for you. An expedition into the rugged wilderness seems like a perfect way to lie low until the trouble blows over.

Choose two ability boosts. One must be to Strength or Constitution, and one is a free ability boost.

You're trained in the Intimidation skill and the Banditry Lore skill. You gain the Group Coercion skill feat.

ROSTLANDER BACKGROUND

You were raised in the south of Brevoy, a land of dense forests and rolling plains, of crystalline rivers and endless sapphire skies. You come from hardy stock and were raised with simple sensibilities—that hard work earns well-deserved gains, the importance of charity and compassion, and the value of personal and familial honor. Yours is the country of the Aldori swordlords and the heroes who refused to bend before the armies of a violent conqueror. You care little for matters of politics and nobles or of deception and schemes. You are thoroughly Brevic, and the call for champions willing to expand your land's influence into the Stolen Lands has inflamed your sense of patriotism and honor, and so you have joined an expedition to journey southward and build a kingdom.

Choose two ability boosts. One must be to Strength or Constitution, and one is a free ability boost.

You're trained in the Athletics skill and the Farming Lore skill. You gain the Hefty Hauler skill feat.

SWORD SCION BACKGROUND

You have lived all your life in and around the city of Restov, growing up on tales of Baron Sirian Aldori and the exploits of your home's heroic and legendary swordlords. Joining an expedition into the Stolen Lands seems like a perfect way to improve your skills and begin crafting a legend worthy of Baron Aldori.

Choose two ability boosts. One must be to Dexterity or Charisma, and one is a free ability boost.

You're trained in the Warfare Lore skill. You gain access to Aldori dueling swords (page 599) and can purchase one as part of your starting equipment. You treat Aldori dueling swords as martial weapons rather than advanced weapons for the purpose of proficiency.



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CHAPTER 1

A CALL FOR HEROES

BY TOM PHILLIPS

PART 1: THE SWORDLORD'S FEAST 16
The PCs should be new 1st-level characters at the start of this chapter.

PART 2: BLOOD AND BLADES 24
The PCs should be 1st level when they begin this part.

PART 3: INTO THE FIRE 32
The PCs should be 1st level when they begin this part, and should be close to reaching 2nd level by the chapter's end.

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PART 1:

THE SWORDLORD'S FEAST

Before the future rulers of the Stolen Lands even set foot in those wild regions, they're merely individuals in the southern reaches of Brevoy in or near the city of Restov, each with their own history and goals. As this Adventure Path begins, the PCs and others have caught the eye of one of the nobles of the city of Restov—Lady Jamandi Aldori.

Lady Jamandi, a wealthy and influential swordlord of the city of Restov in southern Brevoy, has come up with a bold and somewhat unusual plan to officially lay claim to the so-called Stolen Lands, an enormous swath of wilderness wedged between Brevoy and the River Kingdoms that has long resisted attempts at settlement. Her "call for heroes" promises a great and perilous opportunity to claim an equally heroic reward. Though this call has reached the ears of many mercenaries and would-be heroes—including the PCs—it has also drawn the attention of Jamandi's many enemies, especially those who oppose to her attempt to annex the Stolen Lands.

Chief among these enemies is King Castruccio Irovetti, the ruler of the River Kingdom of Pitax on the Stolen Lands' southwestern border. When he learns of Lady Jamandi's plans to send adventurers to explore and settle the Stolen Lands, the king of Pitax enacts an audacious plan to end this threat before her heroes even step foot in the Stolen Lands, so his own (much slower) attempt to expand Pitax's borders won't be threatened. Utilizing a labyrinthine network of intermediaries and middlemen to mask his direct involvement, Castruccio secures the

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services of the Black Tears, a cabal of killers from northern Brevoy. While the gang doesn't know who hired them to attack the manor, they're eager for the job, particularly given the chance to strike a blow against one of Restov's famous swordlords.

As this chapter begins, the PCs have answered Lady Jamandi's "call for heroes" and arrived at her impressive hilltop manor. A cobblestone path, bordered by regal oak trees and well-manicured hedges, winds its way up the hill for nearly a mile, past a two-story guard barracks, the stables, and a dozen thatched-roof cottages that house the families of the manor's servants and retainers. The manor itself is a sprawling, three-story structure constructed of light gray mortared stone, surrounded by hedge-lined rose gardens and ancient oak trees.



JAMANDI ALDORI

Unless otherwise noted, ceilings within the manor are 10 feet high, and the interiors are illuminated by numerous cinnamon-scented oil lamps or wide windows set with panes of glass. The interior walls and ceilings are constructed of masonry and covered with a thin layer of white lime plaster adorned with a layer of wood paneling. The doors throughout the manor are reinforced wooden doors, kept unlocked unless indicated otherwise. The manor's windows have wooden storm shutters that open and close from within, while the window exteriors are protected by artistic-yet-functional iron grillwork designed to deter thieves (treat these iron grills as iron portcullises if someone tries to damage them).

THE GREAT HALL

When you're ready to begin play, the PCs are gathered between the oaks on the walkway leading to the manor's front door, awaiting their turn to be led into the Great Hall. Others who have answered Lady Jamandi's call for heroes also wait, but at this time, the focus should be on the PCs, who are last in line to be admitted. The sky above is gloomy, and distant thunder suggests a storm is imminent. Have each player introduce and describe their character; whether or not they know each other is up to the players. Once the PCs have made their introductions, one of Lady Jamandi's servants calls for them to enter the manor—they are the final adventurers to be led into the building. As they enter, the first raindrops of the storm begin to fall.

Read or paraphrase the following as the PCs are led into the Great Hall.

This spacious hall has been prepared for a great feast. Servants hustle and bustle about, while several armed soldiers—Lady Jamandi's house guards—watch over the hall from their positions against the east and west walls. To the north, a fire crackles away in a large fireplace. An iron lever secured by a lock adorns the fireplace's eastern face. Two massive crystal chandeliers hang from the ceiling twenty feet above. The walls are decorated with painted murals of idyllic woodland scenes: nymphs frolicking amid waterfalls, satyrs dancing with fawns in wooded glades, and various winged fairy creatures flitting through the trees. Nine long tables are arranged around the central portion of the room, each holding plates, utensils, mugs, goblets, and full, ready-to-be-poured pitchers of ale, wine, mead, and water. The smell of roasted meat and other delicious scents fill the room, yet no food has yet been served.

The lever on the side of the fireplace is locked (DC 30 Thievery to Pick a Lock); Lady Jamandi carries the key. This lever is one of several that controls a security feature that she is quick to use when the manor is attacked. When the lever is thrown, several reinforced iron portcullises drop down at the locations indicated on the manor's east and west wings. Once lowered, these portcullises hinder movement through the ground floor and completely block all access to the upper floors—raising each is a complex process requiring manipulation of additional levers found on the uppermost floor. These portcullises are lowered once the manor comes under attack in Part 2 of this chapter, and they will likely remain closed long enough to (hopefully) allow the PCs to defeat the Black Tears before the villains can do too much damage.

Once the PCs step into the Great Hall, they're each escorted to the same table. As chance would have it, several other potential adventurers have been seated here as well ("The Feast" on page 18 provides details on these guests). Feel free to give your players some time to talk among themselves after they're seated, but you should hold back on conversations with the NPCs who share their table for now. Aside from a few sneering looks of obvious disapproval from Tartuccio and perhaps a few coarse comments from Amiri ("Where is this Lady Whoever?" or "Who are these Aldori, anyway?"), the PCs and other adventurers should have very little time to engage one another in conversation before a bell announces Jamandi's arrival.

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THE STORM

As the feast progresses, periodically mention the sight and sound of rain falling outside, rumbles of thunder, and the occasional flash of distant lightning. This storm is meant to add a slightly ominous bit of atmosphere to the prologue, and to encourage the PCs to be eager to spend the night in the manor. You can use the storm as you see fit to push the PCs away from spending the night outside, but if no player seems interested in avoiding a night in the manor, the storm can remain a minor bit of background as this chapter plays out.

THE LADY ARRIVES

Only a moment or two after the PCs are seated, **Lady Jamandi Aldori** (CG female half-elf Aldori swordlord 14) and the lord mayor of Restov, **Ioseph Sellemius** (NG male human aristocrat 5) enter the hall.

While the following readaloud text can simply be presented to the players as-is, consider splitting things up to keep the players involved. You can, for example, ask them to attempt Society checks to Recall Knowledge to identify the speakers—doing so keeps the players on their toes but also gives them the feeling of being part of the scene rather than simply observing it.

A striking half-elf woman enters the hall, followed by an aristocratic, middle-aged human man. The man wears finely tailored clothing, fit for a noble, while the woman appears dressed for battle. She wears a fine leather coat over a sparkling mail shirt, and at her waist hangs an Aldori dueling sword with a bright silver pommel. The two make their way to the head table, where they remain standing.

The man speaks first. "Greetings, heroes! I am Ioseph Sellemius, lord mayor of Restov. And this," he gestures to the woman beside him, "is Lady Jamandi Aldori. We both thank you for answering her call for heroes. You may be few, but we need only the best for this great task."

Lady Jamandi offers the room a broad smile before she speaks. "South of here, beyond Brevoy's border, lie the Stolen Lands. This disputed territory has been claimed time and again by would-be settlers, but because the area has been a haven for bandits and monsters, it has never been held for long. Restov intends for this to change.

"If you have enough courage to drive off the dangerous denizens of the Stolen Lands, you can seize territory for yourselves and name yourselves baronesses or barons. Restov intends to recognize the legitimacy of the new rulers of this land, and none of the other neighboring realms care enough to challenge you. We are prepared to provide backing as a trade partner and military ally. If you claim the land, you will have my—indeed, all of Restov's—support!"

Lady Jamandi raises her goblet. "But the details of your individual missions and charters into the Stolen Lands can wait. I raise my glass to you, brave heroes! For now, let us eat and enjoy the evening. Tomorrow promises to be a very busy day."

After Lady Jamandi finishes speaking, her servants begin circle around the room, filling mugs with ale, fruit juice, or water and serving food from heaping platters. The feast itself includes four courses in all: crisp greens lightly flavored with savory oils, spicy seasoned waterfowl, a main course of tender roast boar, and a finishing selection of fine desserts and cheeses. For the duration of the feast, the servants bustle about in their never-ending quest to keep mugs and goblets full and take discarded plates away to the scullery.

As the feast begins (or anytime they wish), the PCs can attempt a DC 22 Brevoy Lore, Politics Lore, or Society check to Recall Knowledge about Jamandi Aldori. On a critical failure, no information is recalled, but even on a failure, the PC recognizes Lady Jamandi as one of the Aldori swordlords—a wealthy and influential woman who is recognized as one of Restov's greatest warriors. On a success, the PC also recalls that Lady Jamandi's Aldori dueling sword trails magical fire when it strikes, and while she used to take jobs as a mercenary, she now focuses on tending to the needs of her manor, troops, and duties to Restov. On a critical success, the PC also knows Lady Jamandi has recently been at odds with the ruling house of Brevoy, and even her wealth and influence in Restov may not offer long-term protection from the Regent of the Dragonscale Throne to the north.

THE FEAST

During the feast, the PCs have time to chat among themselves or with the NPCs whose table they share. The NPCs described here are destined to become some of the PCs' allies and enemies as Kingmaker unfolds, and their introduction here is meant to establish them as relevant characters from the start.

The exact number of spaces at the PCs' table varies, as it should be enough to seat all of the PCs along with all of the NPCs presented below. Since the feast itself doesn't involve combat, you don't need to track exact square-by-square locations for all the PCs and NPCs at the table as it's presented on the nearby map, and more than one seating can be squeezed into a single five-foot square as needed.

In order to foreshadow specific adventure elements, it's important that the NPCs seated at the PCs' table at least include Maegar Varn and Tartuccio. Fill any other seats from the NPCs detailed below, selecting those you think will make the most interesting dinner

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companions for the party, or add new NPCs of your own choosing (but keep in mind that most of the other companion NPCs detailed in the *Kingmaker Companion Guide* are deliberately not in attendance here, as their introduction is intended for specific encounters or events during the campaign).

The feast itself uses the influence subsystem, as detailed on pages 151–153 of the *Gamemastery Guide*. The feast plays out over 2 hours, broken into six separate 20-minute rounds. In each round, the PCs can attempt to Influence or Discover information about the NPCs at their table. For several of these NPCs, influence awards shift the NPC's starting attitude for determining how they react to the PCs when they next meet—see the *Kingmaker Companion Guide* for more details.

AMIRI CREATURE 1

UNIQUE | CN | MEDIUM | HUMAN | HUMANOID

Female human barbarian 1

Perception +5

Will +5

Discovery DC 15 Perception, DC 17 Society, DC 13 Warfare Lore

Influence Skills DC 13 Athletics (to physically impress Amiri), DC 15 Intimidation (to show Amiri you're not afraid of her), DC 17 Survival (to show Amiri that you're capable in the wilds), DC 19 Performance, DC 19 Diplomacy, DC 21 Deception

Influence 2: Amiri's starting attitude is friendly when she next meets the PCs.

Influence 4: Amiri's starting attitude is helpful when she next meets the PCs.

Influence 8: Amiri is impressed and gives the PC a *+1 dagger* as a gift, asking only that they kill something bigger than them with it someday.

Resistances Amiri is less impressed by weak-looking or small PCs; characters who have a Constitution penalty or are Small or smaller take a –2 circumstance penalty on checks made to Influence her.

Weaknesses Amiri warms up to PCs who present as female and have strong personalities; these heroes gain a +2 circumstance bonus on checks made to Influence her.

Background Amiri left her clan under awkward circumstances to seek her fortune as an adventurer, and she masks the still somewhat fresh hurt of being exiled with crass comments and bravado.

Appearance Amiri is a tall and muscular human woman, clad in a mix of animal skins, leathers, and battle-scarred hide armor. She wears a massive greatsword in a leather scabbard across her back.

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Personality Amiri is blunt and cares little for social niceties. She's casually dismissive of physically weak-looking characters (including Linzi and Tartuccio), but respects displays of strength or stubborn will.

Penalty If the PCs don't engage with Amiri at least once every 2 rounds during the feast, she grows bored and fills in the conversational void with a seemingly endless supply of tales that highlight her greatly exaggerated exploits and near-death experiences as an adventurer. This distraction results in a –1 circumstance penalty to Perception checks attempted by any of the PCs that round.



MAEGAR VARN

HARRIM CREATURE 1

UNIQUE | CN | MEDIUM | DWARF | HUMANOID

Male dwarf cleric of Groetus 1

Perception +7

Will +9

Discovery DC 13 Dwarven Lore, DC 17 Perception, DC 15 Religion

Influence Skills DC 13 Groetus Lore (to speak with Harrim knowledgeably about his faith), DC 15 Dwarven Lore (to talk about dwarven history with Harrim), DC 17 Religion (to impress upon Harrim your own faith), DC 19 Diplomacy, DC 21 Deception, DC 21 Performance

Influence 2: Harrim's starting attitude is friendly when he next meets the PCs.

Influence 4: Harrim's starting attitude is helpful when he next meets the PCs.

Influence 6: Harrim thanks the PC for the chat and says, "I do hope your final fate is distant and pleasant," before giving them a *lesser healing potion* as a gift.

Resistances Harrim grows annoyed with perky optimism. A character who acts irreverently or mischievously at the feast (subject to GM's discretion) can't attempt to Influence him.

Weaknesses Harrim is eager to speak to other dwarves. A dwarf character gains a +2 circumstance bonus on checks to Influence him.

Background Harrim answered Jamandi's call for heroes after learning of the existence of possible lost dwarven ruins in the Stolen Lands, and he hopes to rediscover them before they crumble away entirely, or before the world ends—whichever comes first.

Appearance Harrim is a middle-aged dwarf cleric with a bald head and a long, salt-and-pepper beard.

Personality As a servant of Groetus, Harrim is fond of making declarations such as, "Abandon hope and embrace the inevitable." A calm, level-headed dwarf, Harrim is approachable and surprisingly good at talking to people—that is, until he inevitably starts rambling about the end of days.

Penalty A PC who mocks Groetus or makes light of Harrim's faith can no longer attempt to Influence him.

JAETHAL CREATURE 1

UNIQUE | NE | MEDIUM | ELF | UNDEAD

Female undead elf inquisitor of Urgathoa 1

Perception +8

Will +8

Discovery DC 17 Perception, DC 15 Religion, DC 13 Urgathoa Lore

Influence Skills DC 13 Urgathoa Lore (to impress Jaethal with knowledge about her goddess), DC 15 Intimidation (to impress Jaethal with your fearsome nature), DC 17 Religion (to show Jaethal you have strong faith), DC 19 Performance, DC 21 Deception, DC 21 Diplomacy

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Influence 3: Jaethal's starting attitude is friendly when she next meets the PCs.

Influence 6: Jaethal's starting attitude is helpful when she next meets the PCs.

Influence 8: Jaethal favors the PC with an almost imperceptible smile. She appreciates the PCs' interest in her and gives them a *scroll of restoration* (2nd) as a gift.

Resistances Jaethal is self-conscious about her pale appearance and history, and a character who mentions it or asks if she's ever been to Kyonin causes her to grow more guarded and withdrawn—increase Jaethal's Discovery DCs by 2 for the remainder of the feast.

Weaknesses Jaethal is incredibly lonely, and after a PC successfully uses Diplomacy to Influence her, the DC of that PC's future Diplomacy checks to Influence her is reduced to 15.

Background Jaethal was exiled from Kyonin after a tragedy, and she hopes to find a place in a new society. A nascent nation like the one that may soon grow in the Stolen Lands is an excellent opportunity for such a fresh start. She also sees Lady Jamandi's call for heroes as an opportunity to mingle with the living once again and possibly to atone for some of her past deeds.

Appearance Jaethal is deathly pale and wears dark clothing. Her raven-black hair is long, and she has no jewelry. Leaning against the table next to her is a massive, wickedly sharp scythe.

Personality Although she is both undead and evil, Jaethal isn't antagonistic toward the heroes. In truth, she's very lonely after having spent many decades in self-imposed isolation. For most of the feast, Jaethal is reserved and prefers to observe how the PCs and other adventurers at the table react to one another. Unused to social interaction, she politely rebuffs attempts to engage her in conversation by deflecting comments and questions to another NPC present—usually Tartuccio, since she believes the gnome's behavior will allow her to slip back into anonymity.

Penalty Jaethal's undead nature isn't blatantly obvious to most at first glance, but a PC who succeeds at a DC 25 Religion check to Recall Knowledge notices evidence that she is, in fact, undead. If a PC openly confronts her and outs her as undead at the feast, Jaethal decides to immediately leave the manor; the next time she meets the PCs, her starting attitude is unfriendly.

LINZI CREATURE 1

UNIQUE | CG | SMALL | HALFLING | HUMANOID

Female halfling bard 1

Perception +6

Will +6

Discovery DC 17 Occultism, DC 15 Perception, DC 13 Society

Influence Skills DC 13 Performance (to delight Linzi's artistic sense), DC 15 Society (to trade gossip and news about favorite artisans or performers), DC 17 Occultism (to show off the breadth of your esoteric knowledge), DC 19 Deception, DC 19 Diplomacy, DC 21 Intimidation

Influence 1: Linzi's starting attitude is friendly when she next meets the PCs.

Influence 2: Linzi's starting attitude is helpful when she next meets the PCs.

Influence 8: Linzi is impressed with the PC and starts to hero-worship them (in particular, the character who earned the most Influence Points with her). She offers this PC two talismans—a *jade cat* and an *onyx panther*—as a display of her admiration.

Resistances Linzi grows suspicious of anyone she suspects of suppressing art, and if a PC insults artistry or openly admires organizations that do so (such as King Castruccio Irovetti, House Thrune of Cheliax, or the Hellknight Order of the Rack), that PC suffers a –2 penalty on all checks to Influence her.

Weaknesses Linzi is eager to find someone she thinks will be the true hero of the Stolen Lands, and if a character attempts to Influence anyone at the feast by bragging or citing their accomplishments or heroic goals, they gain a +2 bonus on checks to Influence Linzi.

Background Linzi hopes to chronicle the heroic establishment of a new nation in the Stolen Lands. She spent a fair amount of time in Pitax but left that nation after growing frustrated with the king's persecution and oppression of the arts.

Appearance Linzi is a young halfling woman wearing leather armor and a weather-worn cloak. She keeps a large leather-bound journal in front of her, into which she sketches profile images of everyone present at the table and scribbles occasional notes and verses for tunes she'll never finish.

Personality Linzi is perky, chatty, and very excited to attend what she refers to as the "Feast of Heroes." She's friendly to a fault and possibly a touch over-talkative.

MAEGAR VARN CREATURE 8

UNIQUE | NG | MEDIUM | HUMAN | HUMANOID

Male human swordlord 8

Perception +16

Will +16

Discovery DC 26 Occultism, DC 24 Perception, DC 22 Society

Influence Skills DC 22 Brevoy Lore, Heraldry Lore, Politics Lore, or Warfare Lore (to chat knowledgeably about current events and Brevic history), DC 24 Diplomacy (to treat Maegar like the noble he is without making him feel like you're mocking the fact that he's a third-born son), DC 26 Society (to chat with Maegar about how best to start a village from scratch), DC 28 Deception, DC 30 Intimidation

Influence 1: Maegar's starting attitude is friendly when he's next contacted by the PCs.

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TIMELINE OF EVENTS

The events in this part of adventure occur as follows.

6:50 p.m. The PCs and other guests arrive just before sundown; Lady Jamandi and Lord Mayor Ioseph Sellemius arrive and greet everyone present.

7:00 p.m. The PCs and other guests enjoy a sumptuous and hearty four-course feast. During the feast, the PCs have an opportunity to speak with the NPCs seated at their table.

9:00 p.m. The feast concludes with a final speech from Lady Jamandi. The PCs and other guests are escorted to guest chambers in the manor's east and west wings. The PCs are assigned to the same room (area **A1**).

2:30 a.m. The Black Tears creep into position for their assault.

3:00 a.m. The Black Tears attack (see area **A1** on page 26).

Influence 2: Maegar's starting attitude is helpful when he's next contacted by the PCs.

Influence 4: Maegar is impressed with the PC and will remember them well. Once the PCs establish their own nation, Maegar sends the PCs a letter congratulating them on their success; the letter also invites the PCs to visit him in Varnhold when they can. See Chapter 6 for further details.

Resistances Maegar is a low-ranking swordlord, and anyone who badmouths the Aldoris or Restov burns bridges with him—once a PC does this, that character can no longer Influence him.

Weaknesses Maegar is a keen student of history, and a PC can use Brevoy Lore, Heraldry Lore, Politics Lore, or Warfare Lore to Influence him if they do so by talking about a historical topic. Once a PC succeeds at such a check, the DC of that PC's future checks to Influence him using the same Lore skill is reduced to 15.

Background Maegar is the third son of a Brevic baron, and as such, he doesn't stand to inherit his father's title and holdings. The opportunity to make a name for himself by answering the call for heroes is, he believes, his best chance to make his fortune.

Appearance Maegar is a ruggedly handsome man with a constant shadow of a beard on his jaw; he wears his dark gray hair in a small bun. He carries a distinctive sword that bears the crest of House Varn—four hatchets arranged in a circle—on its pommel guard.

Personality Maegar is impatient to begin exploring the Stolen Lands; he knows he's being assigned to Nomen Heights and brags about how he's already got plans for a new village called Varnhold drawn up back at his home. Yet for all his impatience, he remains a friendly, even charming presence at the feast.

TARTUCCIO CREATURE 4

UNIQUE | CN | SMALL | GNOME | HUMANOID

Male gnome sorcerer 4

Perception +9

Will +11

Discovery DC 17 Nature, DC 21 Perception, DC 19 Society

Influence Skills DC 17 Arcana (to talk shop about magic), DC 19 Intimidation (to frighten him a little and make him doubt his plans), DC 21 Deception (to give him a false sense of superiority), DC 23 Diplomacy, DC 23 Performance, DC 25 Deception

Influence 2: Tartuccio appears to become friendlier to the PC, but a character who succeeds at a DC 21 Perception check to Sense Motive reveals the gnome is entirely faking his friendly interest.

Influence 4: Tartuccio seems to grow even friendlier to the PC than before, but a character who succeeds at a DC 21 Perception check to Sense Motive reveals that, while he's faking the friendly interest, he has become impressed with the way the PC acts.

Influence 6: Tartuccio applauds the PC's obvious skills, and he offers them a *brooch of shielding* to "cement their new friendship." A character who succeeds at a DC 15 Heraldry Lore or DC 20 Society check to Recall Knowledge while examining the workmanship of the *brooch of shielding* notes that it bears distinctive Pitaxian elements. If asked about this, Tartuccio says he hadn't noticed, but he's not surprised; he picked the brooch up at a shop in Pitax several months back. Succeeding at a DC 24 Perception check reveals that Tartuccio is a bit flustered and surprised that the heroes noticed this. If pressed further, Tartuccio grows impatient and says, "Well, if it's that big of a deal, you can just give it back!" Tartuccio intends to use this gift later to help him accuse one of the adventurers of being a Pitaxian spy.

Resistances Tartuccio's arrogance and sense of superiority make him harder to Influence once he witnesses a hero fail at something. As soon as a PC fails a check to Influence him, that PC suffers a –2 circumstance penalty to Influence him for the remainder of the feast.

Weaknesses A PC who incorporates fawning flattery and compliments in a Deception check to Influence Tartuccio reduces the DC of that check to 19.

Background Tartuccio is actually a spy sent from Pitax, ordered to observe the feast and the Black Tears attack that will follow. He has no intent of being among the heroes who seek to claim the Stolen Lands, but will instead become a recurring foil to the party as the campaign progresses.

Appearance Impeccably dressed in fine robes and silks, Tartuccio looks more like a stately gnome prince than an actual adventurer.

Personality Tartuccio is brash and obnoxious and has an obvious superiority complex. He's also rude and argumentative, doing little to hide that he thinks poorly

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of most of the people present. He insults anyone within earshot and loudly proclaims he's the only attendee worthy enough to rule the Stolen Lands.

VALERIE CREATURE 1

UNIQUE | LN | MEDIUM | HUMAN | HUMANOID

Female human fighter 1

Perception +5

Will +3

Discovery DC 15 Perception, DC 17 Society, DC 13 Warfare Lore

Influence Skills DC 13 Diplomacy (to act properly and impress Valerie with your decorum), DC 15 Warfare Lore (to compare notes on fighting styles or chat about military history), DC 17 Society (to speak pleasantly upon current events), DC 19 Deception, DC 21 Intimidation

Influence 3: Valerie's starting attitude is friendly when she next meets the PCs.

Influence 6: Valerie's starting attitude is helpful when she next meets the PCs.

Influence 8: Valerie is impressed with the PCs and gives them a *moderate juggernaut mutagen* as a gift.

Resistances Valerie remains guarded and suspicious of anyone she believes is a worshipper of Shelyn—a PC whom she suspects worships Shelyn can't Influence her.

Weaknesses Displays of honor and lawfulness appeal to Valerie, and a PC who strikes her as particularly honorable or lawful—including anyone openly wearing religious symbols of a lawful good or lawful neutral deity—gains a +2 circumstance bonus on checks made to Influence her.

Background Born into nobility, Valerie once sought to become a champion of Shelyn, but an act of blasphemy forever set her on a much more ordered and organized path. She doesn't regret abandoning her original path, but she does regret how her fellow Shelynites reacted to her choice.

Appearance Valerie is a tall, exceptionally beautiful woman with striking blue eyes and a warrior's physique.

Personality Valerie is polite and extremely well-mannered, but she has little time or interest to take part in humor or jokes.

Story Award: Regardless of the level of success the PCs have at influencing the NPCs, grant them 80 XP for taking part in the event.

Other Guests

Of course, these NPCs are hardly the only guests attending the feast. The other tables are filled with a wide range of guests, most notably Hannis Drelev and the adventuring party known as the Iron Wraiths (who, even during this feast, dress in their full and distinctive suits of armor). Make sure the players are aware of these attendees as the feast progresses, since later in the Adventure Path they'll be encountering some of these people—alive or dead—in very different circumstances!

And don't forget that the PCs themselves are part of this feast. Getting to know NPCs helps foreshadow upcoming events, but this extended roleplaying encounter is also the first chance for the players to introduce their characters to the other players.

CONCLUDING THE FEAST

Two hours after the feast begins, a bell rings to announce its conclusion. Servants bustle about as they clean up the feast's remnants and bring after-dinner drinks to anyone who requests them. Lady Jamandi rises and addresses everyone gathered one final time before retiring for the evening.

"My friends," Lady Jamandi begins, "I hope you have enjoyed the food and drink this evening!" Her words are quickly met with a round of cheers and the enthusiastic tapping of several dozen mugs and goblets. It takes a few moments for the room to grow quiet again.

Smiling broadly, she continues. "You honor me, truly, but this night is for you! As heroes, you have responded to my call, and I can't wait to hear tales of your exploits in the weeks and months to come.

"Tomorrow, I shall speak with you all about your individual charters. I suspect it will be a busy day, so I suggest we make an early evening of it. After all, you have kingdoms to plan!" Lady Jamandi's words are met with an even louder round of cheers and drinkware-tappings. A few goblets even shatter thanks to overeager hands.

Lady Jamandi gestures to the large double-doors to the east and west. "Of course, I've arranged bedchambers for all of you. My guards will escort you to them now. I hope you find them restful. We shall speak further tomorrow when we meet back here at sunrise."

Lady Jamandi and the lord mayor leave the hall, followed by a retinue of armed guards wearing garnet-colored cloaks over suits of chainmail. Other guards begin to escort groups of revelers to their rooms for the night. Maegar Varn graciously declines a room, insisting he must to return to Restov to attend to other matters and that he'll be back in the morning when the charters are given out. Other groups, notably those accompanying Hannis Drelev and the well-armored Iron Wraiths, have all made arrangements to stay the night elsewhere as well, but the assumption is that the PCs and several of those they spoke to during the feast will be staying the night here at the manor. At this point, the PCs themselves are escorted by tired-looking guards east to their rooms.

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PART 2:

BLOOD AND BLADES

All of the adventurers invited to the feast who have elected to stay the night have been assigned different rooms on the ground floor of Lady Jamandi's spacious manor. The PCs have been assigned to an east wing bedroom (area **A1**). This room, like many in this part of the manor, houses four beds—if your group numbers more than four, feel free to have some or all of the beds be bunk beds, or adjust the map so that area **A3b** is a connected suite (in this case, the actual contents of that room are identical to area **A1**).

This part of the adventure assumes that all the PCs agree to stay the night in the manor, but in the event that one or more prefers to stay outside, their guard escort warns them it could be insulting to Lady Jamandi if she found out that a would-be adventurer turned down her offer of hospitality. Furthermore, the storm outside has steadily grown more and more severe—a PC who wants to sleep outside will be uncomfortable at best and in danger of being struck by lightning at worst.

If a player stubbornly pushes for their character to sleep outside, you can either allow that player to play one of the NPC companions (such as Amiri or Linzi) once the mayhem begins (adjusting that NPC's starting point as needed so they can work side by side with the other PCs), or have the door at the guard post in area **A2a** left open so PCs left outside have a chance to get back into the manor just in time—in this case, the portcullis to area **A2a** should be stuck as well, only falling into place once all the PCs are indoors.

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Once the PCs are safely in their room (area **A1**), nothing happens until shortly after 3 a.m., when the Black Tears launch their attack.

ALDORI MANOR: EAST WING

The encounter areas described below assume the Black Tears have started their attack, and that they have already moved through several of the rooms, killing other would-be adventurers. If the PCs decide to explore these areas early, adjust the read-aloud text as appropriate.

THE BLACK TEARS

Originally formed through a merger of seven street gangs from New Stetven and Port Ice, the Black Tears are a criminal organization of cutthroats and thieves known to dabble in kidnapping, extortion, assassination, and the sale of illicit substances. Members are fanatically loyal and exceptionally ruthless. Each carries the group's signature weapon (a dagger with an ebony pommel), displays a trail of three black tears tattooed under their left eye, and bears a tattooed script on their right forearm that reads "Live free or slaughter" in Draconic.

Share the above information with any PC who succeeds at a DC 15 Society or Thievery check to Recall Knowledge after examining a member of the Black Tears. A critical success reveals that they are a relatively small-time gang that has been looking for a chance to make it big; it's likely they were hired to raid the manor in return for a chance to bolster their criminal fame. Surviving guards can relay this information as well.

Black Tears who are captured alive avoid talking. Whether a PC can succeed at getting such a cutthroat to talk is left to the GM; the assailants know little more than what's detailed above. At your discretion, though, a captured member of the Black Tears could warn the PCs about other, more dangerous members of their band elsewhere in the manor.

A1. GUEST CHAMBER — LOW 1

This room contains four beds, a dresser, an oil lamp attached to the center of the south wall, and several potted plants. A decorative brass brazier forged to resemble a sleeping red dragon sits in one corner.

This is the PCs' assigned bedchamber—remember to adjust the description above if you need to turn beds into bunk beds or add a connecting door to area **A3b**.

Creatures: Shortly after 3 a.m., the PCs are alerted to danger by the cry of the lone house guard stationed in the east foyer (area **A2**) as he's murdered by a trio of Black Tears cutthroats. The Black Tears spend a few rounds quietly dragging his body out of sight and doing a few quick patrols to ensure no other guards lie in wait. The PCs have about 1 minute (enough time to don light armor, but not medium or heavy armor) to prepare before three Black Tears cutthroats attempt to quietly enter the room and attack them, using Stealth to roll initiative.

If the PCs open the door to their room and step out into area **A2** before the cutthroats are ready to sneak in, the PCs can roll Perception or Stealth to determine initiative; in this case, the cutthroats roll Perception for initiative. Once the fight begins, they fight to the death.

During this encounter, describe the sounds of battle raging in nearby rooms as other Black Tears make short work of other invited guests.

BLACK TEAR CUTTHROATS (3) — CREATURE -1

UNCOMMON | CE | MEDIUM | HUMAN | HUMANOID

Perception +3
Languages Common
Skills Athletics +4, Stealth +5
Str +2, **Dex** +3, **Con** +1, **Int** +0, **Wis** +0, **Cha** +0
Items dagger, hand crossbow (10 bolts), studded leather armor, belt pouch with 5 sp

AC 15; **Fort** +5, **Ref** +7, **Will** +2
HP 8

Speed 25 feet
Melee ❖ dagger +6 (agile, finesse, thrown 10 ft., versatile S), **Damage** 1d4+2 piercing
Ranged ❖ hand crossbow +6 (range increment 60 feet), **Damage** 1d6 piercing

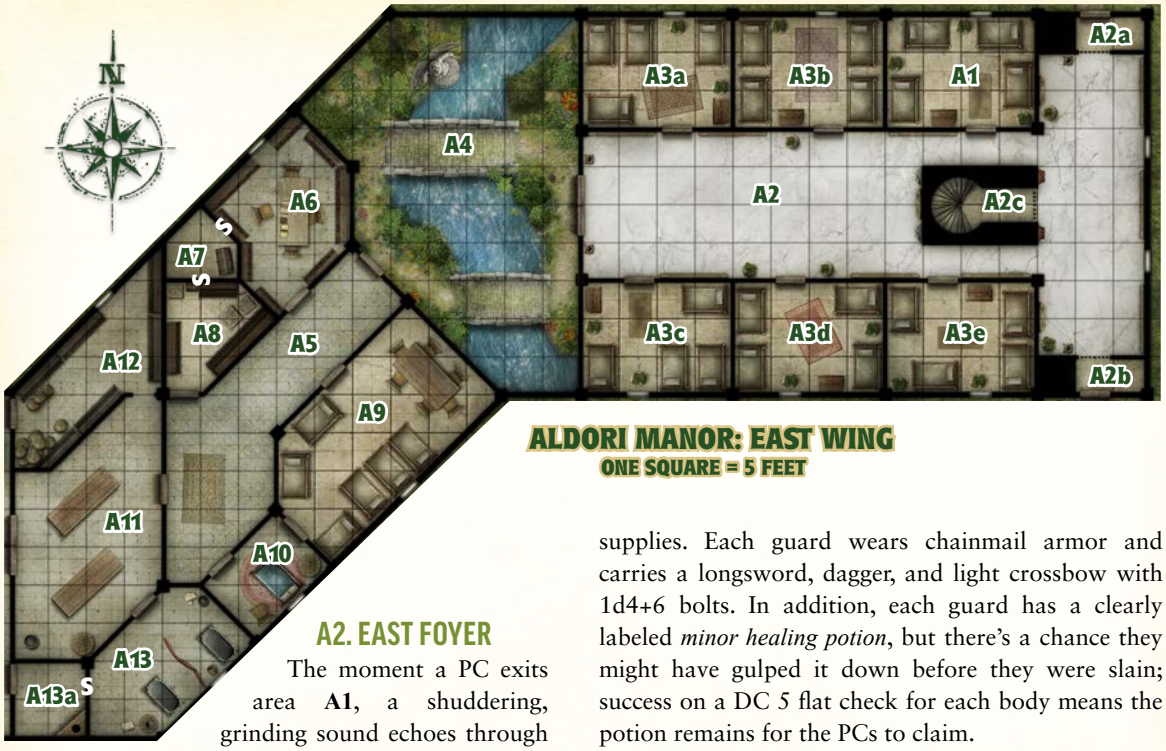
NO TIME TO REST

The PCs won't have time to rest during this prologue, so you should make sure they start fully healed and ready to go when the first fight occurs. Individually, most of the encounters in the prologue aren't threatening, but attrition will take its toll, so keep an eye on the situation. The PCs can bolster their resources by finding healing potions and other gear while searching rooms, or recruiting the aid of companions along the way. If the PCs run out of resources and need to hole up to rest, you can let them do so, provided they find a safe place.

The PCs don't have to complete every encounter for the story to progress. If it looks like the PCs won't make it through the prologue on their own, Lady Jamandi and her guards manage to defeat any Black Tears the PCs can't. The party won't gain the experience points they otherwise would have, but they'll survive the night and be ready to head out into the Stolen Lands.

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ALDORI MANOR: EAST WING
ONE SQUARE = 5 FEET

A2. EAST FOYER

The moment a PC exits area **A1**, a shuddering, grinding sound echoes through the manor. This sound is followed by a series of reverberating booms as the manor's interior portcullises are all lowered, sealing off the upper floors from invaders—but also sealing the PCs into the ground floor with them!

This large hall has a polished marble floor. Several potted plants line the walls and tapestries depicting woodland hunting scenes adorn the east wall.

When the PCs exit their room during or after the ambush, they automatically notice a body to the east. This was the guard who escorted the PCs to their room. He now lies dead in a pool of his own blood near one of the windows.

Areas **A2a** and **A2b** are guard posts. If any PCs chose to remain outside, the portcullis to area **A2a** is jammed open, allowing them into the building—once all the are inside, the portcullis should drop down alarmingly, just in time to lock everyone in. Rules for lifting and damaging iron portcullises appear on page 515 of the *Core Rulebook*.

Another portcullis bars entrance into area **A2c**, which houses a spiral staircase up to the manor's upper floors and down to its basement. These areas are beyond the scope of this adventure, but feel free to expand on them as you see fit if you want to allow the PCs to explore further.

Treasure: As they tear through the manor's defenses, the Black Tears don't loot the guards they slaughter, allowing the PCs to scavenge the dead bodies for supplies. Each guard wears chainmail armor and carries a longsword, dagger, and light crossbow with 1d4+6 bolts. In addition, each guard has a clearly labeled *minor healing potion*, but there's a chance they might have gulped it down before they were slain; success on a DC 5 flat check for each body means the potion remains for the PCs to claim.

A3. GUEST CHAMBERS

These five guest chambers are all furnished identically to area **A1**; although areas **A3a** and **A3e** each have a bunk bed in place of one of the standard beds. Use the read-aloud text from area **A1**, adjusted as needed, to provide descriptions for these chambers. Other would-be settlers of the Stolen Lands slept here; most have already been slaughtered by the Black Tears.

Treasure: These were low-level adventurers and, unlike the PCs, most of them didn't come to the feast fully outfitted in their adventuring gear. Nonetheless, many of these rooms still hold items of value missed by the Black Tears that the PCs can discover by succeeding at a DC 13 Perception check to Search the room.

Area A3a: There are five corpses in this room (two male humans, two female dwarves, and a male halfling). A *minor healing potion* is tucked under the halfling's pillow.

Area A3b: There are no bodies in this room, although two of the beds are soaked with blood and a severed human hand lies in the middle of the floor. The adventurers housed here were killed in their sleep and their corpses were carried to area **A6** by the ogre, Gromog. A longsword and a tanglefoot bag were kicked under one bed and went unnoticed.

Area A3c: This room is currently empty, though the beds show signs of having been slept in. Amiri, Harrim, Linzi, and Valerie were assigned to this room. They were alerted by one of Lady Jamandi's guards shortly after the Black Tears initiated their assault. Unused to

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working together, the four quickly separated and went their separate ways to the east (more information on their respective fates can be found in the descriptions of areas **A6** and **A12**).

Area A3d: This room is currently empty, but fresh bloodstains hint at recent violence. This room was used by some of the guards, whose corpses now decorate Gromog's altar in area **A6**.

Area A3e: There are five corpses here (two female humans, a male human, a male dwarf, and a male elf). The elf wears a silver ring worth 15 gp.

A4. WATER GARDEN MODERATE 1

This large, indoor garden resembles a tropical paradise. Lush plants and flowering vines hang from the walls, while a slow-moving stream of water cuts through the center of the room, flowing languidly from north to south through stone drains. Planters filled with colorful flowers line the stream. Two narrow wooden bridges arch over the water, allowing passage from one side to the other. Partially submerged in the stream to the north stands a life-sized marble statue depicting an armored half-elf woman holding a rose and wielding a shield.

Several years ago, Lady Jamandi saved the life of a well-connected Nexian wizard who was spending some time in Rostland on vacation only to be ambushed by bandits. Before she departed for her distant homeland, the grateful wizard created this magical water garden for Lady Jamandi as a token of friendship and gratitude. Though the room has no windows, the 15-foot high ceiling is enchanted to simulate the day-night cycle found in the Mwangi Expanse. Additionally, a soft breeze constantly ripples through the chamber, keeping the air circulating and clean; each afternoon, a gentle rain keeps the garden's plants healthy and lush.

The placid stream cutting through the center of the room bears a teleportation effect that causes its waters to flow in a continuous loop. When the water (or any other non-living item in it) comes into contact with the south wall, it's instantly rerouted to the north wall and purified, where it continues to flow south uninterrupted. The stream is 5 feet deep, and the current is slow enough that it requires only a DC 13 Athletics check to Swim. While Identifying the powerful teleportation effect requires a DC 28 Arcana or Nature check, a successful DC 15 Society check made to Recall Knowledge allows a character to remember hearing the story of the garden.

The statue is of Milani, Lady Jamandi's patron deity (DC 15 Religion check to Recall Knowledge). The statue stands atop a small stone shelf, so the water flows level with the statue's knees.

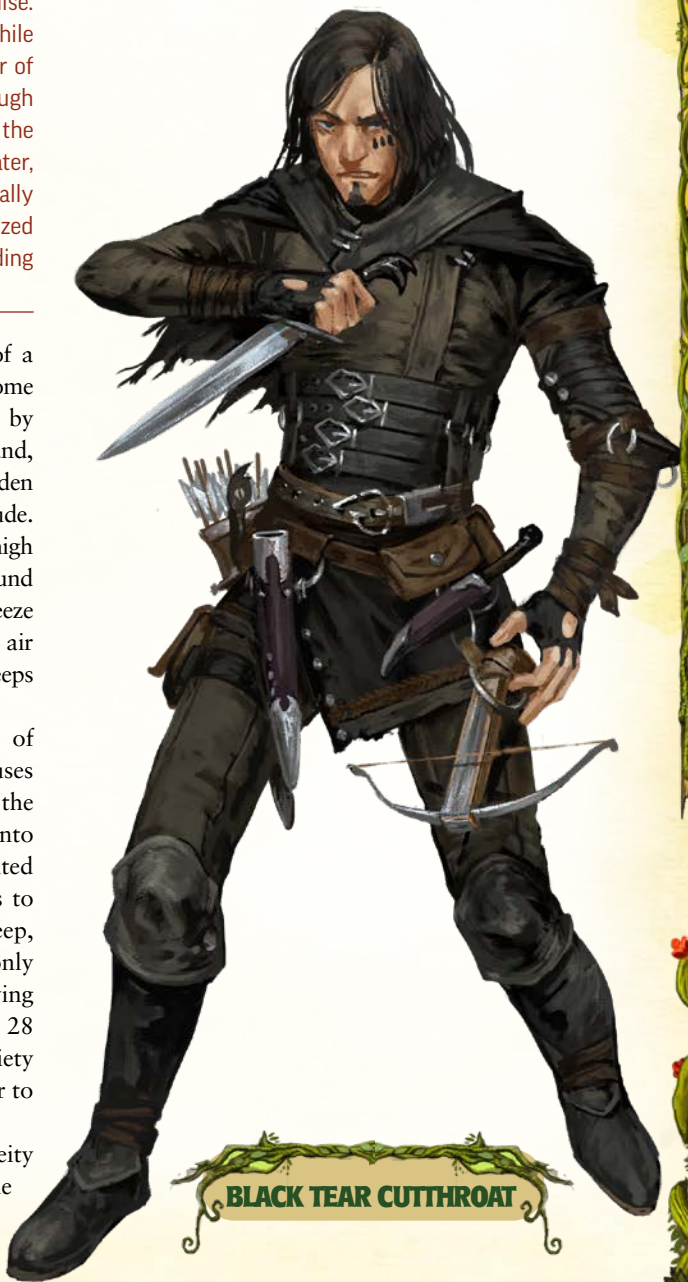
Creatures: Four Black Tears cutthroats have taken up positions on the west side of the chamber, where they wait with hand crossbows at the ready. One of the cutthroats carries a vial of lesser alchemist's fire, which she throws at the PCs on the first round of combat.

BLACK TEAR CUTTHROATS (4) CREATURE -1

See page 25

Initiative Stealth +5

Treasure: Anyone investigating the statue's stone shelf can attempt a DC 15 Perception check to notice a watertight compartment below the waterline. The



BLACK TEAR CUTTHROAT

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stone lid of the submerged compartment slides easily into the wall to reveal several clearly labeled potions Lady Jamandi stashed here for emergencies: four *minor healing potions*, a *barkskin potion*, and a *lesser potion of fire resistance*. A small bronze key sits in the compartment as well—a backup key for the trunk in area **A7**.

A5. HALLWAY

The bloodied corpses of six guards and three people wearing black cloaks litter the floor of this wide hallway.

In this area, a PC who succeeds at a DC 5 Perception check can hear the sound of a deep voice roaring and howling from area **A6**; on a critical success, the PC can make out words as Gromog, the ogre in the room beyond, roars phrases like, "Where are you, halfling?," "I can't see no more!," or "I smash your eyes good when I get you!" interspersed with cries of frustration and pain.

Treasure: The PCs can collect the gear belonging to Lady Jamandi's six fallen guards (see area **A2**) and the three Black Tears cutthroats (see area **A1**).

A6. LIBRARY LOW 1

This modest-sized library lies in ruins. Bookshelves along the east and west walls have been emptied; books lie heaped into a pile in the northeast corner. Set atop this heap are the severed arms, legs, and heads of a dozen guards and would-be heroes. A blood-spattered padded chair sits next to a shuttered window.

Lady Jamandi occasionally uses this room to read and relax when she's not practicing swordplay or attending to the business of managing her various intrigues. The room has been recently converted into an altar of gore and depravity by Gromog, an ogre mercenary.

The secret door connecting this room with area **A7** can be discovered with a successful DC 17 Perception check.

Creatures: Gromog isn't officially a member of the Black Tears. He was hired by the gang to join their assault on Lady Jamandi's manor when they encountered him in the wilds north of Restov. The filthy furs he wears are lice-ridden and keep him constantly itching and scratching. Gromog was severely hurt in the assault and bears many fresh wounds, including a crossbow bolt embedded in the small of his back that he's been unable to remove. More significantly, Gromog has been blinded by his prisoner, the halfling bard Linzi.

Linzi is currently cowering behind the padded chair on the slanted northwest wall. After she slashed at the ogre's eyes with a lucky strike of her longsword, she's been hiding here and hoping for a chance to bolt for the exit, but so far, the blind ogre's thrashing hasn't given her the opportunity. She knows if she says anything, Gromog will know where she is, but as soon as the PCs enter, she cries out for help. At your option, if you're using the *Kingmaker Companion Guide*, Linzi scurries out to help in the fight; otherwise, she uses a single action each turn to cast *inspire courage* to bolster the PCs in the battle.

Gromog's reduced stats below represent him in his current state—blinded, wounded, and itchy from the lice, and as such he presents a less deadly threat to 1st-level PCs. On the unlikely event that he gets the chance to recover from this battle, heal his wounds, and remove his lice-infested furs, his stats return to those of an ogre warrior (*Pathfinder Bestiary* 252). Gromog won't pursue foes out of this room, and if he's reduced to fewer than 6 Hit Points his nerve cracks, and he breaks off combat to escape from the manor. Of course, as long as he's blinded, his fumbling attempts to flee aren't likely to be successful. If the PCs press their attack against him, he fights to the death.

GROMOG CREATURE 2

UNIQUE | CE | LARGE | GIANT | HUMANOID

Perception +1; blinded
Languages Common, Jotun
Skills Acrobatics +12, Intimidate +9
Str +5, **Dex** –1, **Con** +4, **Int** –2, **Wis** +0, **Cha** –2
Items lice-infested furs, ogre hook

Blinded Gromog's eyes have been wounded by Linzi. In time, he'll recover his eyesight (mostly), but for the duration of this combat he is blinded (*Core Rulebook* 618).

Itchy Not only have the itchy lice in Gromog's furs reduced his AC, Reflex save, and attack modifier through distraction (resulting in the values below the standard values for an ogre warrior), he also must succeed at a DC 10 flat check at the start of each round to avoid spending 2 actions furiously scratching himself. On a successful flat check, he must spend only one action scratching at the vermin. Finally, as a side effect of the discomfort caused by his lice, Gromog is too distracted to properly wield his ogre hook. While the weapon can still inflict grievous damage, as long as he remains itchy it doesn't possess the deadly trait these weapons normally possess.

AC 16; **Fort** +11, **Ref** +4, **Will** +5
HP 28

Speed 25 feet
Melee ❖ ogre hook +9 (reach 10 feet, trip), **Damage** 1d10+3 piercing

Companion: If the PCs defeat Gromog (either by killing him or letting him get away), Linzi thanks them

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profusely. She can reveal the secret door to area **A7** and will accompany the PCs if they ask. If she began hero-worshipping one of the PCs earlier in the evening at the feast, she'll accompany them without asking. If you're using the *Kingmaker Companion Guide*, Linzi can help the PCs in fights and may elect to travel with them after the prologue—otherwise she'll hang back, use *inspire courage* during battles, but otherwise not engage.

Story Award: If the PCs rescue Linzi, grant them 30 XP.

A7. SECONDARY TREASURY

This small, windowless room contains a large, wooden trunk secured with a formidable-looking padlock.

Lady Jamandi uses this room as a backup treasury (her primary treasury is located on the manor's currently inaccessible second floor). The trunk is locked (DC 20 Thievery to Pick the Lock); the key from area **A4** unlocks it.

The two secret doors connecting this room with areas **A6** and **A8** are plainly obvious from within this chamber, requiring no Perception checks to notice.

Treasure: Inside the trunk are eight small cloth bags, each holding 100 gp (these presorted coins are used to pay Lady Jamandi's guards and servants), two *lesser healing potions*, a *+1 mace*, and a *+1 longsword*. A small leather-bound journal at the bottom of the trunk contains the names of all Lady Jamandi's servants and guards, along with the dates on which they receive their monthly pay.

If the PCs loot this room, word reaches Lady Jamandi several hours after the Black Tears are defeated. She eventually questions them about it, and if the PCs admit they took the treasure and return the gold and magic items, she thanks them for their honesty. In this case, she reclaims the gold but allows them to keep any remaining potions and the magic weapons as a token of appreciation. If the PCs Lie or otherwise claim ignorance of looting her treasury, they'll need to succeed at a DC 35 Deception check to make her think a Black Tears cutthroat stole the treasure and managed to escape with it. In the likely event this check fails, or if she or her servants witness the PCs using the longsword or mace, she's obviously disappointed but allows the theft of the weapons to go unpunished, demanding only the return of the gold so she can continue to pay her guards and servants. If the PCs outright refuse, Lady Jamandi grows angry, but ultimately cedes the treasure to them as a show of good faith—they were, after all, attacked while under her roof. At the GM's discretion, Lady Jamandi might try to recoup her losses later in the campaign by demanding a temporary tariff on goods once the PCs finally establish their own kingdom in the Stolen Lands, but she's more likely to just shrug and write off the loss as a cost of doing business with adventurers.

A8. STORAGE

This storage room holds items necessary for running the estate, including extra oil lamps, bed linens, candles, common tools, and crates of supplies.

The secret door to area **A7** can be discovered by succeeding at a DC 20 Perception check.

Treasure: Any piece of common adventuring gear (*Core Rulebook* 288) can be found here at the GM's discretion. Three full barrels of lamp oil can be found here as well (each barrel holds 248 pints of lamp oil). Feel free to add a few *lesser healing potions* into storage here if the PCs could use a bit of healing in order to keep going.

A9. SERVANTS' QUARTERS

This large room contains two rows of simple beds along the slanted southeast wall. At the foot of each bed sits a small wooden chest, though the lids all stand ajar and the contents—mostly clothes and personal items—lie scattered about the floor. A sturdy oak table and six chairs sit against the northeast wall.

This room houses Lady Jamandi's male servants. There are 14 beds here, five of which still hold the bloody corpses of servants murdered in their sleep.

Treasure: A PC who Searches the clothes and personal items scattered about the floor and succeeds at a DC 15 Perception check locates a thin silver necklace with a heart-shaped charm worth 10 gp inside the pocket of a pair of trousers.

A10. COOK'S QUARTERS

This small room is comfortably furnished with a bed, rocking chair, and small side table with three chairs. An overturned wooden chest lies in the middle of the room amid a tangle of discarded clothing and personal items.

Lady Jamandi's head cook, Tirzendi, a Varisian chef who once served the former king of Korvosa, lives here. When the attack began, Tirzendi was lucky enough to escape to the Great Hall, where he's currently cowering along with many of Lady Jamandi's other surviving servants (more details are included in Part 3 on page 32).

Treasure: Although the Black Tears looted most of Tirzendi's valuables, Searching the clutter and succeeding at a DC 15 Perception check locates a small

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leather pouch holding 6 gp and 23 sp tucked into a shoe. If the PCs offer to return this to Tirzendi, he gratefully thanks them but offers to let them keep it as a reward.

A11. SCULLERY MODERATE 1

This oddly shaped scullery contains two sturdy tables for prepping food, a large tin washbasin for cleaning dishes and laundering clothes, a hefty wooden bucket for hauling water, and many shelves containing goblets, plates, dishes, and eating utensils. Though the fragile-looking dishes and glassware remain miraculously undamaged, many bloody corpses lay piled in the middle of the room.



JURGRINDOR

The western double door leads to the Great Hall but has been barricaded from the opposite side. A PC who succeeds at a DC 25 Athletics check can Force Open the doors. Otherwise, if the PCs knock on the doors and yell through them, the guards in the Great Hall beyond will remove the barricades from the doors as long as the PCs promise them that the giant is dead. Proceed with Part 3 once the PCs pass through the doors into the Great Hall.

Creature: One of the most dangerous mercenaries hired by the Black Tears is an exiled frost giant named Jurgrindor. Cast out from his clan for his unusually small stature, the giant still towers over humans at a height of nearly 10 feet. He and his equally undersized brothers, Thurvulf and Vragnar (see area **A23**), hope to use the money they make working for the Black Tears to start new lives in the mountains to the east, but otherwise Jurgrindor feels very little loyalty to his current employers.

The Black Tears positioned Jurgrindor here to keep unexpected stragglers from escaping the east wing, and the numerous bodies strewn about the room are a gory testament to his efficiency. Among the bodies are 11 of Lady Jamandi's guards and five of the adventurers invited to the feast (three male humans, a female halfling, and a male half-orc). Amiri, Harrim, and Valerie aren't among them; they survived the fight but were rendered unconscious, and Jurgrindor has tied them up and placed them in area **A12** for the moment, under orders from the Black Tears to keep a few adventurers alive for potential ransoms at a later date.

The fight against those three left Jurgrindor injured and worn out. He's been sitting with his back against the doors leading to the Great Hall, resting and recovering, yet he remains severely wounded from his battles. He's riddled with crossbow bolts and sword wounds, and his left arm has suffered a particularly brutal blow from Amiri's greatsword—the same blow that shattered his spear. He's been slipping in and out of consciousness ever since.

Jurgrindor pays no notice to the sound of fighting elsewhere in the east wing, but he does notice the PCs when they enter this room. He gurgles in rage as he staggers to his feet and prepares to fight yet more foes, this time with his bare knuckles. He won't attack until the PCs do, or until they approach within 5 feet of his position at the doors to the Great Hall. He won't deign to speak to the PCs on the topic of his employers or what he's doing here, and if pushed too far on this topic, he'll roar and attack. However, any offer of healing gives him pause; a successful attempt to Make an Impression, Lie, or Coerce him convinces Jurgrindor to allow one PC to approach and provide healing. If the PCs do heal him, he quietly nods in appreciation, then steps aside to allow

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them entry into the Great Hall. While Jurgrindor won't fight at their side in the West Wing, he could (at the GM's discretion) smash into a room later to save the PCs from a fight gone poorly—provided the fight isn't against his brothers!

JURGRINDOR CREATURE 3

UNIQUE | CE | LARGE | COLD | GIANT | HUMANOID

Perception +9; low-light vision
Languages Common, Jotun
Skills Athletics +10, Crafting +7, Intimidation +9, Stealth +8
Str +5, **Dex** +1, **Con** +3, **Int** +0, **Wis** +2, **Cha** +0
Items battered breastplate

AC 17; **Fort** +12, **Ref** +6, **Will** +9
HP 50 (currently 25); wounded arm
Wounded Arm Jurgrindor's left arm is dreadfully wounded, courtesy of Amiri's greatsword. The discomfort of this wound causes Jurgrindor to take a –2 circumstance penalty to his Armor Class and Strikes (these modifications are included in his stats). At the end of each of his turns, Jurgrindor must succeed at a DC 12 flat check or the wound begins to bleed again, dealing him 1d6 persistent bleed damage. He can't use Catch Rock or Throw Rock (as typical giants) until he's healed back to full hit points.

Speed 30 feet
Melee ❖ fist +10 (agile, reach 10 feet), **Damage** 1d8+8 bludgeoning
Chill Breath ❖ (cold, evocation, primal) Jurgrindor breathes out a 15-foot cone of freezing moisture that quickly condenses into ice, dealing 2d6 cold damage (DC 18 basic Reflex save). A creature that critically fails the save is also immobilized until it Escapes (DC 18). Jurgrindor can't use Chill Breath for 1d4 rounds.

Treasure: There are 11 fallen guards in this chamber, and also the following gear from other fallen adventurers: a suit of half-plate armor, three suits of gore-stained chainmail armor, a battle axe, four longswords, nine daggers, a crossbow, 13 bolts, a glaive, several pieces of minor jewelry (rings, brooches, and necklaces) worth a total of 30 gp, and a blood-smeared *coyote cloak*.

A12. PANTRY

Floor-to-ceiling shelves cover the walls of this well-stocked pantry. The shelves contain various salted meats, loaves of bread, sacks of grain and flour, and an assortment of potatoes and vegetables. Twelve barrels sit against the west wall.

Lady Jamandi made sure her pantry and wine cellar (located in the manor's currently inaccessible basement) were well stocked for the feast. There's enough food here to easily host two feasts as large as the one Lady Jamandi presided over a few hours ago. Nine of the barrels on the west wall hold a respectable local wine; the other three contain a locally brewed ale.

HANDLING TOUGH FIGHTS

Some of the fights in this chapter have the potential to suddenly turn deadly for 1st-level PCs, particularly those where they face foes like Jurgrindor. The point of these fights isn't to devastate the PCs, though, so if the PCs at your table seem to be struggling, consider reducing enemy Hit Points, or even omitting some of these encounters entirely in order to avoid the campaign coming to an end before it really has a chance to begin!

Companions: Amiri, Harrim, and Valerie lie unconscious in a tangled heap in the middle of the pantry floor. They're bruised, battered, and each currently has 1 Hit Point. The frost giant Jurgrindor defeated these three when they each foolishly decided to face him individually in one-on-one combat. Amiri wears her hide armor, and her enormous greatsword lies next to her. Harrim didn't have time to don his armor, but he still clutches his flail in one hand. Valerie also didn't have time to don armor, though her shield and bastard sword lie nearby.

If the PCs provide Amiri, Harrim, or Valerie with any healing, they wake up and immediately pepper the PCs with questions, always starting with, "Where is the frost giant?" Still reeling from their defeat, the three are unlikely to accompany the PCs further; instead, they gather their gear and skulk back to their guest chamber (area **A3c**) where they barricade the door and hide until the attackers are driven from the manor. However, at your discretion, and if you're using the *Kingmaker Companion Guide*, these companion NPCs might assist or even accompany the PCs for the rest of this adventure.

Story Award: If the PCs rescue the three NPCs, grant them 90 XP.

A13. WASHROOM

This room holds a few large washtubs, along with some folding screens that provide a modicum of privacy for the few chamber pots found here. A small brass oil lamp on the ceiling sheds plenty of light and fills the small room with the thick scent of cinnamon.

On the west wall, a secret door to area **A13a** can be detected with a successful DC 20 Perception check. The room beyond is a privy for guests of the Great Hall; the secret door was built into it as an emergency escape route. The privy's main door leads to the Great Hall; if the PCs step through this doorway, proceed with Part 3.

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PART 3:

INTO THE FIRE

Read or paraphrase the following when the PCs enter the Great Hall.

The Great Hall looks much different than it did hours ago during the feast. Three of the long tables have been turned on their sides and pushed against the large entry doors to the south to form a makeshift barricade. Dishes, broken goblets, and bloody stains mar the floor, while at least a dozen bodies lie against the east wall. Lady Jamandi's guards gather at the barricades and in front of the double doors leading into the west wing. These doors are sealed, and several tapestries have been torn from the walls and wedged into the gap between the floor and the door in a feeble attempt to keep smoke from flowing into the hall from an apparent fire in the manor's west wing.

Ivenzi (LG male human fighter 6), a lieutenant of Lady Jamandi's guards, holds the Great Hall along with a half dozen other guards (human fighters 3). A large man with gray eyes, closely cropped black hair, bushy eyebrows, and a thin mustache, Ivenzi greets the PCs enthusiastically when they enter. None of the other adventurers invited to the feast have made their way back to the hall, so Ivenzi had feared they were all slain.

SPEAKING WITH IVENZI

The PCs likely have questions for Ivenzi, but he has questions of his own to ask first. He asks the PCs to tell him what happened in the east wing. He's primarily interested in the enemies they faced and how many

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of them remain in the east wing—and is especially interested in "the frost giant with the enormous spear" who killed some of his guards in the scullery a short time ago. The guards have been in mortal fear that the giant could smash into this room at any moment. After he asks his questions, Ivenzi is happy to answer anything the PCs might ask. Here are some possible questions and the answers he can provide.

What happened here? "Armed mercenaries, along with several giants, attacked the manor. Lady Jamandi rallied her guards in this room, and after some tough fighting, we drove them off, though it was a near thing. Some of the attackers fled to the east wing, but most fled to the west wing."

Is the west wing on fire? "The hallway leading from the Great Hall and several of the guest chambers next to it are ablaze, but we also heard clashing blades coming from the west wing as recently as a few minutes before you arrived. So, I think the rooms further west are still safe. Getting to them is risky, but certainly possible."

Who are the attackers? "Judging from their tattoos, I think they're members of the Black Tears, an organized gang of killers who usually operate in northern Brevoy. I'm surprised they've made such a brazen move—either they're desperate, or someone paid them well enough to attempt this attack."

Where is Lady Jamandi? "She ordered me to hold the Great Hall, then took a squad of eight guards with her and went to clear out the West Wing. Her goal was to retake the Dueling Hall at the far end of the manor, so I'll wager you'll find her there."

Will you raise the portcullises? "Even if I could, I wouldn't. They're meant to limit the movement of invaders, and the levers to raise them are located upstairs. They'll stay lowered until we retake the manor."

Where is Lord Mayor Sellemius? "He left hours ago, shortly after the feast concluded. His carriage probably took him to his villa in Restov. I hope he wasn't waylaid by these criminals on his way home!"

What are your plans? "I intend to hold this hall until Lady Jamandi returns."

Are the manor grounds safe? Can we leave the manor? "I'd advise against it. I've heard reports that roving bands of these attackers still hold the manor grounds. I won't have enough guards to secure them until Lady Jamandi returns."

ALDORI MANOR: WEST WING

Ivenzi is desperate for help of any kind, and after answering the PCs' questions, he asks them to make their way through the West Wing and help Lady Jamandi defeat the remaining attackers. If the PCs balk or outright refuse, he reminds them that Lady Jamandi can be a significant ally. The attack on the manor is a clear threat to the PCs as well, and it would be in their best interest to help Lady Jamandi retake her home. If they still balk, he nods his head in disappointment, and allows them to hunker down here in the Great Hall. In this case, Lady Jamandi returns successful but bloodied at dawn; continue with Concluding the Chapter.

Story Award: Grant the PCs 30 XP for reaching the Great Hall.

DEFEAT THE BLACK TEARS

30 XP

Lady Jamandi can use all the help she can get in defeating the Black Tears.

Source: Lieutenant Ivenzi

Completion: Reach area **A24** and defeat Volodmyra.

Reward: Lady Jamandi rewards the PCs as detailed on page 38.

A14. CENTRAL STAIRS

A portcullis bars entrance to these stairs from the Great Hall. The stairs themselves lead to the manor's upper floors and its basement. These areas are beyond the scope of this adventure, but feel free to expand upon them as you see fit if you want to allow the PCs to explore further. The door to the east leads to the Great Hall.

A15. WEST PRIVY

This room holds a toilet. A small brass oil lamp on the ceiling provides plenty of light and fills the small room with the thick scent of cinnamon.

The door to the east leads to the Great Hall.

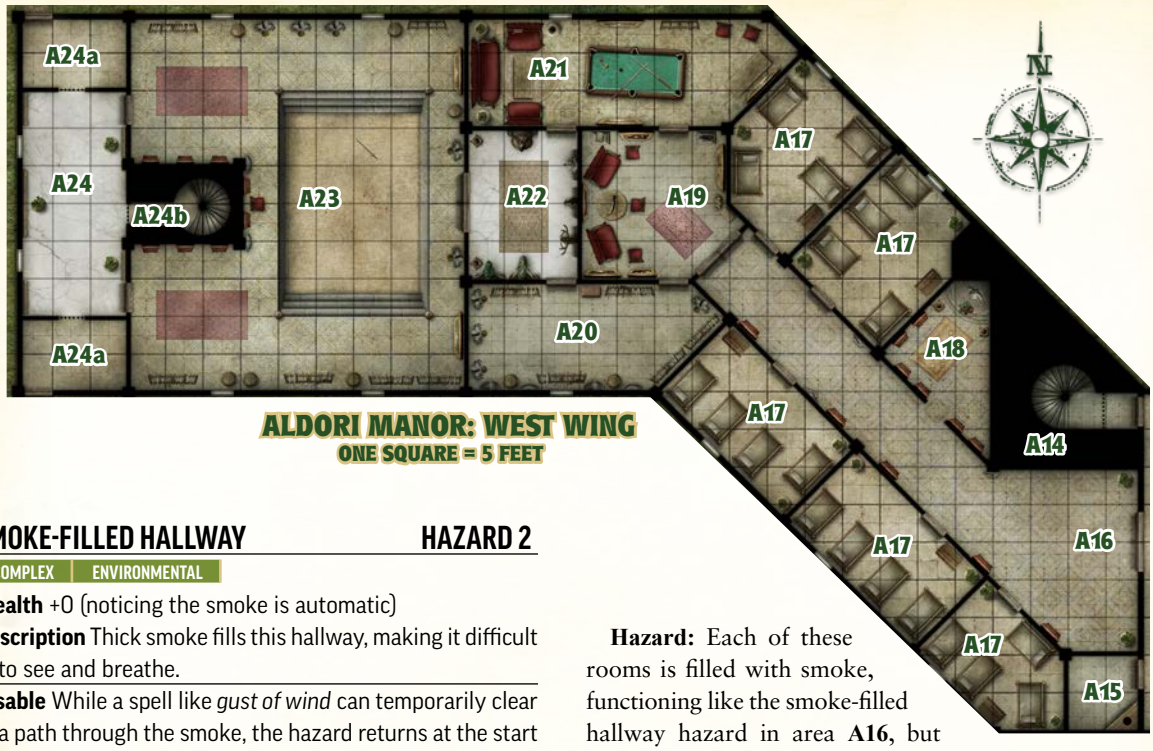
A16. SMOKY HALLWAY LOW 1

This wide hallway is filled with billowing smoke. Further ahead, on either side of the hall, several open doorways are illuminated by flickering flames.

Hazard: As the Black Tears began their attack, their leader Volodmyra (area **A23**) sent agents to light each of the west wing guest chambers (areas **A17a–A17e**) on fire while locking their panicked occupants within. The adventurers housed in this wing all perished except for Tartuccio (area **A19**) and—assuming she didn't leave during the feast—Jaethal (area **A21**). The rooms have continued to burn, filling this area with thick clouds of acrid smoke. While the smoke persists, all creatures in the smoke become concealed, and all creatures outside the smoke become concealed to creatures within it.

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ALDORI MANOR: WEST WING
ONE SQUARE = 5 FEET

SMOKE-FILLED HALLWAY HAZARD 2

COMPLEX ENVIRONMENTAL

Stealth +0 (noticing the smoke is automatic)

Description Thick smoke fills this hallway, making it difficult to see and breathe.

Disable While a spell like *gust of wind* can temporarily clear a path through the smoke, the hazard returns at the start of the next round as long as the fires in area **A17** continue to burn; DC 18 Survival to know how best to cover your nose and mouth with a wet cloth to help alleviate the choking effects of the smoke.

Choke ❖ Trigger A creature that isn't holding their breath walks into the hallway or starts their turn in the hallway; **Effect** The triggering creature must attempt a DC 18 Fortitude save.

Critical Success The creature is unaffected by the smoke.

Success The creature is sickened 1 by the smoke.

Failure The creature is sickened 1 and takes 1d6 nonlethal damage from choking on the smoke. A creature that falls unconscious from the nonlethal damage begins to suffocate in 1d4+1 rounds (*Core Rulebook* 478) if not dragged to safety.

Critical Failure As failure, but sickened 2 and 1d6 persistent nonlethal damage.

Reset The smoke continues to affect anyone who enters area **A16** until the fires in area **A17** are extinguished.

A17. BURNING ROOMS LOW 1

Each of these guest rooms is completely ablaze. The doors to each have burned to rubble, but not before the doomed adventurers sleeping within perished. Left as they are, the rooms continue to smoke and burn for 30 minutes, and the rooms themselves (along with area **A16**) remain filled with smoke until dawn. Fortunately, the manor's stone walls and the lack of carpet or other flammable materials in area **A16** prevent the fire from spreading through the rest of the manor.

Hazard: Each of these rooms is filled with smoke, functioning like the smoke-filled hallway hazard in area **A16**, but the flames and heat also deal 1d6 fire damage (DC 16 basic Reflex save) on creatures who end their turns in any of these burning chambers as long as the fires continue. Breaking the room's glass window before the fire is extinguished causes the fire within to flare up and deal 2d6 damage at the end of that round (rather than the standard 1d6), but once at least three of the burning rooms have their windows ventilated, the smoke in these rooms and in area **A16** lessens, and the DC of the Fortitude save to resist its choking effect is reduced to 11.

A PC in one of these burning rooms can attempt to extinguish the flames in that room by using the Fight Fires action (below); doing so builds up Extinguish Points. Once a room has accumulated 4 Extinguish Points, the fire within is extinguished. Once all five rooms have been extinguished, the smoke in these rooms and in area **A16** diminishes in an hour, or in 10 minutes if windows in at least three of these rooms have been broken.

FIGHT FIRES ❖

MANIPULATE

You attempt to put out flames by kicking apart burning debris, smothering smaller fires, or moving unburnt items out of the path of flames. Attempt a DC 15 Acrobatics, Athletics, or Survival check to determine the level of your success. If you use water as part of this action, you gain a +2 item bonus to this check. Alternately, you can use a spell to Fight Fires by attempting a spell attack roll as you Cast, although you'll need to describe how you're using the spell

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to the GM, who will then decide if the plan has a chance to succeed. If the spell has the Water trait, you gain a +2 circumstance bonus to this check. Certain spells, at the GM's discretion, may automatically grant a critical success or instantly extinguish the flames.

Critical Success You gain 2 Extinguish Points.
Success You gain 1 Extinguish Point.
Critical Failure You lose 1 Extinguish Point.

Reward: If the PCs extinguish the fires in all five rooms, grant them 30 XP.

A18. REJUVENATING SHRINE

This room's plain stone walls and polished floor have already become stained with smoke. At the far end of the room—atop a stone dais—stands a marble statue of an armored half-elf woman. One of her hands clutches a heavy shield, while the other is clenched into a fist over her heart.

The air in this small shrine to Milani (identifiable with a successful DC 15 Religion check to Recall Knowledge) is smoky, but not nearly as thick as in areas **A16** or **A17**, thanks to lingering magical auras meant to instill tranquility and relaxation in those who visit. Anyone in the room who succeeds at a DC 13 Perception check notices the sense of security, while a critical success confirms that the feeling of safety and calm comes from the statue itself. A PC who succeeds at a DC 15 Religion check made to Identify Magic realizes that at this time, any ally of the Aldoris—currently including each of the PCs—who spends at least 1 minute in this room engaged in meditation or prayer to any non-evil deity becomes infused with vigor and energy as if they had rested for 8 hours and made their daily preparations (*Core Rulebook* 480). This one-time effect isn't an intrinsic quality of the shrine, but a boon granted by the goddess herself; while the gods rarely intervene directly in the affairs of mortals, Milani is thankful the PCs are doing what they can to defend the manor.

A19. GALLERY

Drifting coils of smoke waft in the air of this finely furnished room. Padded chairs and side tables are set along the west wall and a thick burgundy carpet covers most of the floor. Oil paintings hang on the walls, and shelves contain statuettes and other small art pieces.

The smoke in this room is slight and doesn't hamper vision or breathing, unless the doors to area **A16** are left open for more than 5 rounds while the area is filled with smoke; if that happens, the smoke-filled room hazard extends into this area.

HELP FROM THE GREAT HALL

Ivenzi would rather not risk his guards to help fight the flames in the west wing; he knows the fire will be contained thanks to the manor's stone walls. However, if the PCs succeed at a DC 17 check to Request Aid or Coerce, Ivenzi will authorize his guards to help the PCs fight the fire, granting a +4 circumstance bonus on all Fight Fires attempts.

Creature: One of the adventurers who was seated at the PCs' table during the feast, Tartuccio, lies sprawled on the floor near the door to area **A16**.

While Tartuccio is a spy for King Castruccio Irovetti, he's not an ally of the Black Tears. Like the rest of the guests, he was caught off-guard by the attack and suspects Castruccio may have orchestrated the assault. When the Black Tears began lighting fires, Tartuccio woke in time in to use his magic to become invisible and crept out of his room, then spent some time watching the mercenaries before the smoke became too much. He staggered into this room and closed the doors to prevent the smoke from spreading, then faked a collapse from smoke inhalation, hoping to appear as merely another victim.

If the PCs make any effort to restore Tartuccio to consciousness, he sputters and coughs as he staggers to one of the padded chairs to slump into it. He quickly recognizes the PCs and thanks "his loyal henchmen" profusely, then begins to bark orders at them to escort him safely back to the Great Hall. If the PCs balk at this, Tartuccio snarls in disgust—he'll head there on his own if the smoke in area **A16** is clear; otherwise, he'll hunker down here to wait.

If the PCs managed to earn 6 Influence Points with Tartuccio during the feast, though, he'll specifically thank the PC who earned the most Influence Points, saying "I knew you had the makings of a fine hero in you!" In this case, he'll agree to accompany the group but pretends to be missing his gear and to have no magic prepared, so he can't aid them in battle. While Tartuccio travels with the PCs, you generally don't need to track his actions in combat. He can offer advice (albeit delivered with an insufferable air) to the PCs if they seem stumped, and he will provide Aid to a favored PC in combat; this automatically provides that PC with a +1 circumstance bonus to their first check made during their turn.

In any event, the goal with Tartuccio shouldn't be to build him up as a potential ally or companion, but simply to let the PCs get to know his personality a bit. The next time they meet, they will be adversaries in the Stolen Lands (more information can be found on page 41).

Treasure: While the art here is quite valuable (easily worth 5,000 gp for the entire collection), it's bulky

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ANGERING THE HOSTESS

This adventure assumes the PCs don't willfully anger Lady Jamandi, but there are certainly opportunities to do so, such as stealing any of the paintings from the gallery, attacking her guards, or otherwise inflicting excessive damage to her home. It's left to the GM to determine if the PCs anger her to the point that she has them arrested. If she does, you can have her grant them freedom on the condition that they agree to head into the Stolen Lands to claim a region for her—in this case, the PCs will need to undertake additional actions of your own design to redeem themselves in Lady Jamandi's eyes and earn the right to rule their own kingdom.



NISHKIV THE KNIFE

and difficult to transport—and it's very unlikely the PCs can make off with it without Lady Jamandi noticing.

Story Award: If the PCs "restore" Tartuccio to consciousness, grant them 30 XP.

A20. ARMORY

This slightly smoky room contains wooden racks holding various weapons and wooden stands designed to hold suits of armor. Many of the weapon racks and armor stands are empty, and several weapons and discarded armor pieces lie about the floor.

The smoke here is barely even an annoyance. This armory is used by Lady Jamandi's household guards. Though the Black Tears looted the room of obviously valuable pieces, they left behind quite a bit in their haste.

Treasure: The armory still holds the following weapons and armor, all bearing Lady Jamandi's crest: 11 daggers, five longswords, ten spears, two glaives, one halberd, two battle axes, six crossbows, a barrel containing 106 crossbow bolts, three suits of half plate armor, ten suits of chain mail armor, three chain shirts, and five steel shields. Lady Jamandi graciously allows the PCs to keep any of the weapons or armor they "borrow" from this room, provided they used it to aid in the defense of the manor.

A21. PARLOR MODERATE 1

This large room contains several padded chairs, a comfortable-looking pair of couches, several side tables, and a finely crafted billiards table.

Lady Jamandi uses this room to entertain important guests and allies. The furniture and billiards table are of excellent quality. The slight trickle of smoke that taints the air is distracting but not hazardous.

Creatures: The second-in-command of this particular Black Tears operation, a violent killer named Nishkiv the Knife, is here along with two Black Tears cutthroats.

If Jaethal didn't flee the manor during the feast, she's sprawled on one of the couches with her mouth gagged and hands tied behind her back with rope. While most of the guests were sleeping off the previous evening's indulgences, she was wandering the west wing; when the Black Tears attacked, they found her relaxing here and subdued her. Nishkiv and the rest of the Black Tears are currently preparing to interrogate her. If Jaethal departed during

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the feast, the Black Tears are instead busy searching the room for valuables.

In either case, as Nishkiv and his cutthroats are focused elsewhere, they take a –2 circumstance penalty to Perception checks until they detect the PCs. As soon as they spot the PCs, they attack. Nishkiv fights to the death, but if he falls, the other two cutthroats panic and try to flee the manor entirely rather than face heroes who cut down the frightening murderer.

BLACK TEARS CUTTHROATS (2) CREATURE -1

See page 25

Initiative Perception +3

NISHKIV THE KNIFE CREATURE 1

UNIQUE | CE | MEDIUM | HUMAN | HUMANOID

Male Black Tears rogue

Perception +5

Languages Common, Jotun

Skills Acrobatics +7, Athletics +4, Deception +7, Society +6, Stealth +7

Str +1, **Dex** +4, **Con** +1, **Int** +1, **Wis** +0, **Cha** +2

Items daggers (6), *lesser healing potions* (3), leather armor

AC 16; **Fort** +6, **Ref** +9, **Will** +5

HP 20

Attack of Opportunity ↷

Speed 25 feet

Melee ❖ dagger +9 (agile, finesse, thrown 10 ft., versatile S), **Damage** 1d4+1 piercing

Ranged ❖ dagger +9 (agile, finesse, thrown 10 ft., versatile S), **Damage** 1d4+1 piercing

Double Strike ❖❖ Nishkiv makes two dagger Strikes against the same target. If his first attack hits, the target is flat-footed to the second attack. The multiple attack penalty applies to these attacks as normal.

Sneak Attack Nishkiv deals 1d6 extra precision damage to flat-footed creatures.

Companion: If Jaethal is set free, she thanks the PCs for their aid. She's a little rattled from her ordeal and wants to return to the Great Hall to gather her wits. However, before she leaves, she tells the PCs she overheard Nishkiv mention that "the lady of the manor has been cornered in the dueling pit by the boss and those two giants."

If the PCs managed to earn 8 Influence Points with Jaethal during the feast, she apologizes for not being able to offer any magical healing (she doesn't normally keep such spells prepared, being undead, but she doesn't offer this excuse to the PCs) but can use her Battle Medicine ability to patch up the PCs if they're wounded; she has a Medicine modifier of +10 (trained).

Story Award: For reaching Jaethal and helping to finish off the bandits, grant the PCs 30 XP.

A22. TROPHY HALL

This large room has a floor of polished white tiles. Hanging from the walls are various trophy heads: a stag with an impressive set of antlers, a large tusked boar, a cranky-looking oversized owl, a snarling wolf, and two different reptilian monsters.

Lady Jamandi's trophies include the following creatures' heads: a stag, boar, owlbear, dire wolf, forest drake, and tatzlwyrm.

Treasure: A PC who succeeds at a DC 18 Perception check notices a *bloodseeker beak* talisman stashed in the tatzlwyrm's mouth, left there long ago by one of Lady Jamandi's guests.

A23. DUELING CHAMBER SEVERE 1

A large recessed area sits in the floor of this enormous chamber. Racks containing practice blades and stands holding suits of padded armor line the north and south walls.

Lady Jamandi uses this room to practice her swordplay and host sporting duels with local officers and nobility. The recessed area is the dueling court—a 2-foot-deep rectangular arena with steps at its north and south ends. Now, though, bodies litter the floor. Eight of Lady Jamandi's guards lay dead among the cloaked corpses of 11 Black Tears cutthroats and two dead ogres.

Creatures: When the PCs arrive, they see Lady Jamandi facing off against a pair of frost giants—the brothers Thurvulf and Vragnar—in the open area to the northwest of the dueling pit. At the same time, the Black Tears leader, Volodmyra, and four more Black Tear cutthroats enter the room from the door to the southwest and immediately move to attack the PCs. Lady Jamandi spots the PCs and points out Volodmyra, yelling, "Just in time! That's their leader; take her out while I deal with these oafs!"

During the first round of combat, Lady Jamandi kills one of the frost giants with her enchanted flaming Aldori dueling sword. She eventually kills the remaining giant; this fight lasts as long as it takes for the PCs to defeat Volodmyra and her cutthroats. This adventure doesn't expect the PCs to directly face either of the two undersized frost giants. If statistics for either of them become necessary, use the stats for Jurgrindor on page 31, but without the wounded arm disadvantage.

Volodmyra is a mid-ranking member of the Black Tears, a ferocious fighter in her late twenties with waist-length auburn hair, pale blue eyes, and a crooked scar on her chin; she's missing a small piece of her left ear. She wears a long black leather coat over a suit of

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chain mail armor and wields a wickedly curved greataxe. Volodmyra still has hopes that a success here will elevate her in the gang, and as a result, she and her cutthroats fight to the death. While this is a severe encounter, Lady Jamandi's presence can serve as a safety net; if Volodmyra is besting the PCs, Lady Jamandi should finish off the last giant then step in to defeat Volodmyra in time to save dying PCs. Should this happen, the swordlord is just as thankful and supportive of the PCs for their aid as if they'd defeated Volodmyra and her goons themselves.

BLACK TEAR CUTTHROATS (2) CREATURE –1

See page 25

Initiative Perception +3

VOLODMYRA CREATURE 3

UNIQUE | NE | MEDIUM | HUMAN | HUMANOID

Female Black Tear commander

Perception +7

Languages Common, Jotun

Skills Acrobatics +7, Athletics +9, Deception +9, Society +7, Stealth +5

Str +4, **Dex** +2, **Con** +2, **Int** +0, **Wis** +0, **Cha** +2

Items chain mail, *+1 greataxe*, *lesser healing potions* (4), jade and pearl necklace (worth 20 gp), silver ring (worth 30 gp), *tracker's goggles*

AC 18; **Fort** +11, **Ref** +9, **Will** +7

HP 48

Attack of Opportunity ↻

Speed 25 feet

Melee ❖ *greataxe* +11 (magical, sweep), **Damage** 1d12+4 slashing

Overhand Smash ❖❖ **Requirements** Volodmyra is wielding her greataxe and is adjacent to an enemy; **Effect** Volodmyra raises her greataxe above her head and puts all of her might into a single attack. If the attack hits, Volodmyra deals an additional 8 points of damage and the opponent must succeed at a DC 17 Fortitude save to avoid being knocked prone.

Spinning Sweep ❖ **Requirements** Volodmyra successfully Strikes a second enemy when making a sweep attack with her axe and is within 10 feet of a third enemy she hasn't yet attacked; **Effect** Volodmyra spins in a circle (Stepping 5 feet if she chooses) and makes a third attack against a foe she hasn't attacked this round. This third attack suffers only a –8 penalty to the attack roll (instead of the standard –10 on a third Strike). If it hits, Volodmyra deals an additional 2d6 points of damage from the furious impact.

A24. WEST FOYER

This large hall has a polished marble floor. Several potted plants line the walls, and tapestries depicting the snow-capped mountains of north central Brevoy adorn the west wall.

The corpses of five of Lady Jamandi's guards and two Black Tears cutthroats lie scattered about the hall. The two guard posts to the north and south (area **A24a**) are similar to those at the far end of the manor in the East Wing (areas **A2a** and **A2b**), complete with lowered portcullises, while the staircase at **A24b**, also behind a portcullis, provides access to the manor's other floors.

Treasure: The PCs can collect the gear belonging to Lady Jamandi's five fallen guards (page 26) and the two Black Tears cutthroats (page 25).

CONCLUDING THE CHAPTER

Once Volodmyra and her cutthroat companions are defeated, Lady Jamandi thanks the PCs for their heroics and promises them a suitable reward, but her primary concern is securing the manor, extinguishing any remaining fires, and tending to the wounded. With or without the PCs' assistance, this takes the rest of the night and the better part of the morning.

Unless the PCs have already looted her treasury (area **A7**), Lady Jamandi offers each PC a reward of 50 gp and two *lesser healing potions* for their valorous deeds the night before. She also allows the PCs to keep as much bandit treasure and gear as they can carry, though she hints that she will put any looted gear they leave behind to good use.

A few hours after dawn the next day, the situation at the manor is more or less under control. Engineers from Restov have arrived and are busy surveying the fire-damaged parts of the manor to plan repairs, while the dead have been gathered and are being prepared for funeral services. Servants are busy throughout the manor and grounds, making minor repairs, cleaning up bloodstains, or recovering from the ordeal.

THE HEROES GATHER

Lady Jamandi gathers the PCs and the other surviving adventurers (Amiri, Harrim, Linzi, Tartuccio, Valerie, and—if she didn't leave the prior evening—Jaethal) in the Great Hall at noon. As the PCs enter, they'll have a chance to see even more adventurers and explorers who have been contacted by Lady Jamandi. At this point, you can simply read or paraphrase the following text to the PCs if you wish to begin the adventure into the Stolen Lands, or you can use the following information to roleplay the scene how you see fit. There should be no significant encounters or challenges for the PCs to face at this point—the goal here is to introduce them to their future neighbors (and in some cases, competitors) in the Stolen Lands and present them their initial charter.

It's shocking how quickly Lady Jamandi's staff have restored the manor's Great Hall in the space of a few morning hours.

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Very few signs of the violence of the night before remain, and things have been mostly returned to normal. As the adventurers who survived the assault take seats at the tables, other adventurers who arrived just today settle in as well. Even with these newcomers, though, there are far fewer heroes in the hall than there were the previous evening, and the atmosphere is serious and somber as Lady Jamandi steps up to speak.

"I would like to thank those of you who helped defeat the Black Tears last night," Lady Jamandi begins. "It's obvious someone doesn't like our plans to settle the Stolen Lands. Well, we're not so easily dissuaded, are we? I say no, and this morning, I would like to issue formal charters to all of you to begin exploring the Stolen Lands and make them safe for tomorrow's settlers.

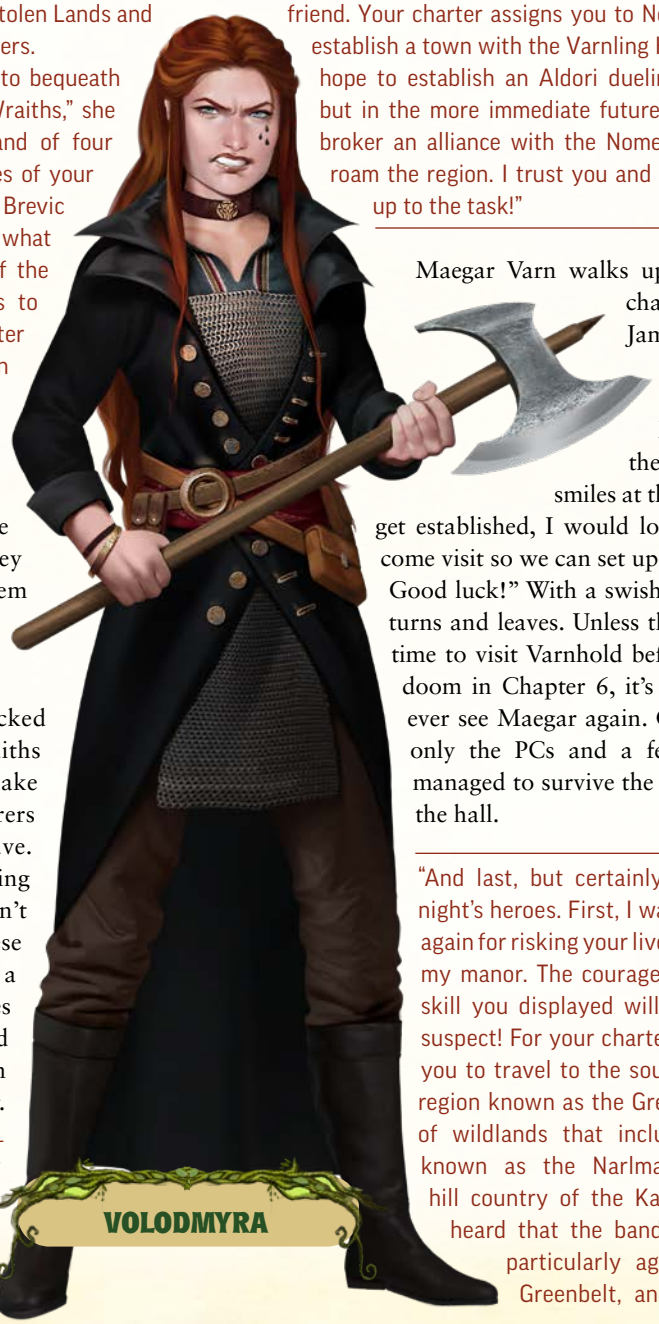
"The first charter we would like to bequeath goes to the group called the Iron Wraiths," she states, with a wave towards a band of four well-armored adventurers. "The tales of your adventures have thrilled many Brevic nobles, and I'm excited to see what you can do with the exploration of the Glenebon Uplands. Your charter is to establish a base for Brevoy there after dealing with the Tiger Lords and then to open diplomatic relations with Pitax from a point of strength."

The Iron Wraiths make their way up to Lady Jamandi and she gives them their charters. As they leave the room, make them seem arrogant but also experienced and confident, so when the PCs learn of their fate later in the campaign, they should be shocked and a bit terrified. As the Wraiths leave the hall, some might even make catcalls at the remaining adventurers (including the PCs) as they leave. "Hey, 'heroes,' don't forget to bring your stuffed animals so you don't get scared." or "I bet 30 gold these other 'adventurers' won't last a fortnight." Lady Jamandi shakes her head in frustration and disapproval at these antics then proceeds with the second charter.

"Baron Hannis Drelev, as per our previous discussions, your charter is one of specific importance for Brevoy. Securing the southern trade routes along the East Sellen River and establishing a base for merchant caravans and barges alike is of utmost importance! Hooktongue Slough will be your base of operations."

A dour-looking nobleman takes his charter from Lady Jamandi with a crisp bow that's barely more than a nod, then walks from the room. The PCs notice a slight sneer on his face as he makes his exit with nary a word nor look toward anyone else. Once he's on his way, Lady Jamandi turns to one of the PCs' table mates from the previous evening.

"Maegar Varn, your father Androth has long been a faithful friend. Your charter assigns you to Nomen Heights to establish a town with the Varnling Host. In time, we hope to establish an Aldori dueling school there, but in the more immediate future, we ask you to broker an alliance with the Nomen centaurs who roam the region. I trust you and your fellows are up to the task!"



Maegar Varn walks up to accept his charter from Lady Jamandi. As he leaves the Great Hall, he passes by the PCs' table and smiles at them. "Once you get established, I would love to have you come visit so we can set up trade relations. Good luck!" With a swish of his cape, he turns and leaves. Unless the PCs take the time to visit Varnhold before it meets its doom in Chapter 6, it's unlikely they'll ever see Maegar again. Once he's gone, only the PCs and a few others who managed to survive the night remain in the hall.

"And last, but certainly not least, last night's heroes. First, I want to thank you again for risking your lives to help defend my manor. The courage, gumption, and skill you displayed will take you far, I suspect! For your charters, we're asking you to travel to the southwest into the region known as the Greenbelt, a swath of wildlands that includes the forest known as the Narlmarches and the hill country of the Kamelands. We've heard that the bandits have grown particularly aggressive in the Greenbelt, and they need to

VOLODMYRA

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Be it known that the bearer of this charter has been charged by the swordlords of Restov, acting upon the greater good and authority vested within them by the office of the Lord-Mayor of Restov, the right of exploration and travel within the wilderness regions known as Restov's Hinterlands and the Greenbelt. Exploration should be limited to an area west and south of Oleg's Trading Post, no further than the banks of the Shrike and Skunk Rivers. The carrier of this charter should strive against banditry and other unlawful behavior to be encountered. The punishment for unrepentant banditry remains, as always, execution by sword or rope. So witnessed on this 24th day of Calistril, under watchful eye of the Lordship of Restov.

HANDOUT 1-1

be stopped before anyone safely settles in the region. A small trading post in the Rostland hinterlands has been particularly hard hit—I suggest starting there. Once the bandits have been dealt with, we will be ready to bequeath to you more permanent charters to settle the land and establish a government of your own!"

Lady Jamandi hands each of the remaining adventurers copies of the same charter, reprinted as **Handout 1–1**. (The date provided in the handout is arbitrary—you can adjust the date that this campaign begins to whatever you prefer in your game.) In any event, Lady Jamandi is eager to get back to the task of tending to her employees and family and repairing damage to her manor; she encourages the PCs to leave for Oleg's Trading Post at once and wishes them luck on their adventures.

THE OTHER EXPLORERS

The PCs' party is but one of several groups chartered by the swordlords to explore and settle the Stolen Lands. If any of the characters expresses an interest in learning more about the other groups, each of the following paragraphs of information can be learned with a successful DC 14 Society check or a DC 12 Brevoy Lore check to Recall Knowledge.

Hannis Drelev: The East Sellen River runs through the swamps known as Hooktongue Slough. As the most vital trade route from the south, this area is initially the most important to Brevoy—as a result, a large group of diplomats and high-ranking soldiers led by Baron Hannis Drelev is sent into this area to ensure the trade route is open and safe. (More information about Drelev appears in Chapter 7.)

Iron Wraiths: The Iron Wraiths are a relatively experienced band of four adventurers who all wear heavy armor that includes full helms; they don't remove these helms during this initial scene in an attempt to further bolster their intimidating reputation. They've been charged with dealing with the Tiger Lords and, eventually, establishing diplomatic contact with Pitax to work out border issues. As fate has it, the Iron Wraiths' confidence in their own abilities is misguided, and they'll go missing before long. (More information about the Iron Wraiths' fate appears in Chapter 7.)

Maegar Varn: The centaurs of Nomen Heights have always been trouble, and in an attempt at diplomacy, the swordlords send a group of explorers and diplomats led by one of their own, a low-ranking but eager-to-impress swordlord named Maegar Varn, to establish a

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town and make peace with the Nomen centaurs. (More information about Maegar Varn, the town of Varnhold he'll found eventually, and his fate can be found in Chapter 6.)

Companion NPCs: During the feast, the PCs met some potential NPC companions—Amiri, Harrim, Jaethal, Linzi, and Valerie. If you're using the *Kingmaker Companion Guide*, refer to that book for how to integrate some or all of these companions into the group. If you're not using the *Kingmaker Companion Guide*, or if your players don't incorporate them into their group, you can simply have some or all of the NPCs form their own adventuring group and set off into the Stolen Lands on their own. In this case, what fate awaits them is left to you to decide.

A BITTER RIVAL

One of the people the PCs likely shared their table with isn't intended to be an ally, but instead a bitter rival. When Tartuccio claims his copy of the charter, he makes no attempt to join with the PCs. On the contrary, he crows about his own ability and brags "I'll have my own kingdom carved out before you all are done wrestling in the dirt with bandits!"—specifically targeting the PCs with his comments. Any companion NPCs whom the PCs have annoyed or failed to impress may well join up with Tartuccio at this point—if you're not using the *Kingmaker Companion Guide*, having all of the others join him might make sense, although keep in mind that those who throw in their lot with Tartuccio are likely doomed.

Tartuccio is a spy in the employ of Pitax, yet one who's been mostly left to his own devices on how to stymie the expansion into the Stolen Lands. Kingmaker assumes that Tartuccio leaves Lady Jamandi's manor and heads south into the Stolen Lands with a small band of mercenaries (and any potential NPC companions the PCs failed to befriend) hired as protection. Tartuccio's plan is to recruit a clan of kobolds he's had contact with before, the Sootscales, as his minions. Using a ritual to change his appearance into a strange, purple-scaled kobold, he swiftly infiltrates and takes over the Sootscales within days of receiving his charter. By the time the PCs begin to explore the Greenbelt in detail, he'll be established among the kobolds as a mysterious magical ruler.

If you wish, you can have the PCs encounter clues or evidence of Tartuccio's activity in the Stolen Lands as they explore. Rumors of a purple-haired gnome leading a band of mercenaries through the grasslands, small dungeon complexes that have been looted of their treasures, or potentially even sightings of the gnome in the wild can keep Tartuccio's presence on the PCs' minds. Tartuccio's stats are presented on page 605, but you should strive to limit actual encounters with the gnome until the PCs finally confront him among the Sootscale kobolds later on.

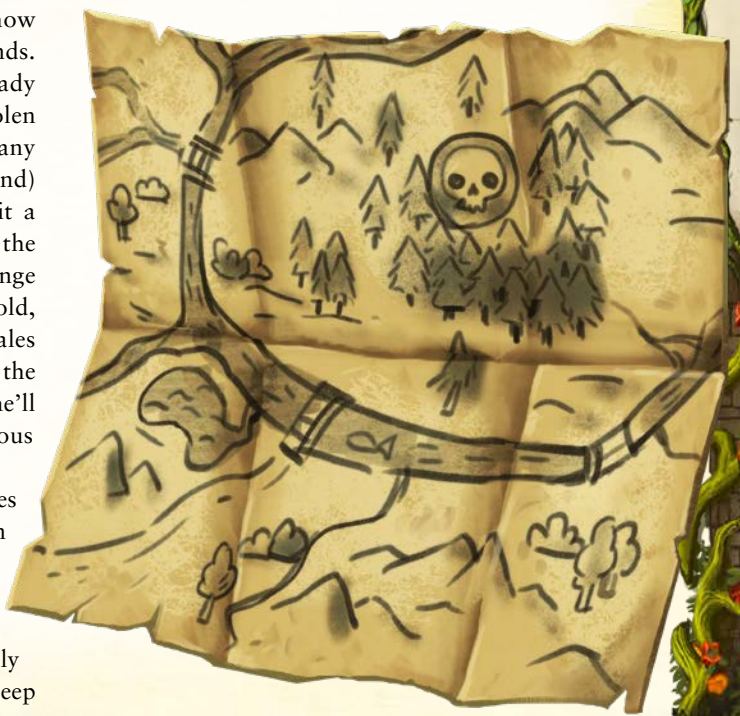
If any of the potential companion NPCs left with him, you can also have the PCs encounter them in the wild after they're abandoned by Tartuccio; by the time he enacts his plan to take over the Sootscales, he has long since left any mercenaries or traveling companions behind. In this case, the companion NPC should have nothing nice to say about Tartuccio, and the last they saw the gnome, he was heading toward area **GB20**; none of these adventurers know about his actual plans or destination, or the presence of a kobold warren there!

Full details on Tartuccio and his role among the kobolds are given in Part 4 of Chapter 2, while his statistics appear in Appendix 5, page 605.

HEADING WEST

Once the PCs have their charter and have accepted any potential companion NPCs into their ranks, the time to head out and begin the exploration of the Stolen Lands is nigh! If you wish, you can gloss over their journey west from Restov to Oleg's Trading Post and jump right into Kingmaker's story by starting Chapter 3. Alternately, you can play out this journey using the hexploration information in Chapter 2, letting the players chart their own course through the region.

The Stolen Lands await!



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CHAPTER 2

INTO THE WILD

BY TIM HITCHCOCK, JAMES JACOBS, ROBERT G. McCREARY, JASON NELSON, NEIL SPICER, AND GREG VAUGHAN

PART 1: HEXPLORING THE STOLEN LANDS 44

This chapter officially opens the sandbox for the PCs, who are likely still at 1st level after finishing the events of Chapter 1. The encounters and quests described in the remainder of this chapter are meant to be interspersed throughout the entire campaign as the PCs explore and discover the many, often dangerous, secrets of the Stolen Lands.

PART 2: HEX ENCOUNTERS 50

This section provides encounters for all levels of play save for 20th-level characters.

PART 3: THE OLD SYCAMORE..... 120

The PCs should be 2nd level before to exploring the Old Sycamore.

PART 4: SOOTSCALE CAVERNS..... 126

The PCs should be 2nd level before to exploring the Sootscale caverns.

PART 5: THE LONELY BARROW.....132

The PCs should be 3rd level before exploring the Lonely Barrow.

PART 6: ISLE OF THE LIZARD KING.....136

The PCs should be 4th level before approaching the Isle of the Lizard King.

PART 7: CANDLEMERE ISLAND..... 142

The PCs should be 4th level before exploring Candlemere Island. The encounters in the basement skew to the severe, and while they can be handled by a well-prepared (and lucky) 4th-level party, they could still challenge a 5th- or even a 6th-level party.

PART 8: THE FORGOTTEN KEEP..... 148

The PCs should be 5th level before exploring the Forgotten Keep.

PART 9: M'BOTUU 154

The PCs should be 10th level before exploring M'botuu.

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PART 1:

HEXPLORING THE STOLEN LANDS

The Stolen Lands have long resisted attempts at exploration and settlement. Wedged between the River Kingdoms and Brevoy, the approximately 35,000-square-mile swath of wilderness has long been referred to as "stolen"—though "from whom" and "by whom" vary depending on the point of view. In Brevoy, the lands are considered stolen from that nation's southern expanse by bandits and barbarians from Numeria, Iobaria, or the River Kingdoms. In the River Kingdoms, the general impression is that Brevoy deliberately allowed the lands to fall into the hands of monsters (and worse) in order to prevent the lords of the River Kingdoms from taking them over. Even within the wildlands themselves, lands are stolen and conquered in struggles between groups of centaurs, kobolds, fey, trolls, bandits, lizardfolk, boggards, barbarians, and more, all constantly skirmishing to expand their holdings while defending their lands from enemies.

In truth, the Stolen Lands belong to no one and are stolen from no one. Many have tried to claim them, but the abandoned ruins that dot the swath of wilderness stand as testaments to the difficulty of such a task. They have remained wild with fierce tenacity, a haven for monsters, criminals, and dangerous secrets, and as such, have posed a menace to their neighboring nations for as long as anyone can remember. Unknown to many who look upon these lands from surrounding nations and empires, a hidden hierarchy of latent power resides within the Stolen Lands, organized

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STOLEN LAND ZONES

Level	Name	Code	Page	Description
0	Brevoy	BV	50	Includes the city of Restov and its environs
1	Rostland Hinterlands	RL	51	Southern hinterlands of Brevoy, lightly settled
2	Greenbelt	GB	58	Lightly forested to the west, rolling hills to the east
3	Tuskwater	TW	69	Forested hills surrounding a large lake
4	Kamelands	KL	78	Rolling hills with periodic small copses of trees
5	Narlmarches	NM	82	Deep, thick forests
6	Sellen Hills	SH	84	Unsettled grassy hills surrounding the Little Sellen River
7	Dunsward	DS	87	Largely unsettled grasslands and rolling hills
8	Nomen Heights	NH	90	Rocky hills with sparse patches of rugged vegetation
9	Tors of Levenies	LV	91	Rugged mountains with lightly forested valleys
10	Hooktongue	HT	94	Vast stretch of swampland surrounding a large lake
11	Drelev	DR	103	Grasslands with a few small settlements and a large fort
12	Tiger Lords	TL	105	Grassy hills; ancestral lands of the Tiger Lord barbarians
13	Rushlight	RU	108	Unsettled grasslands claimed (in theory) by Pitax
14	Glenebon Lowlands	GL	108	Largely empty grasslands with poor-quality soil
15	Pitax	PX	109	Settled reaches of the kingdom of Pitax
16	Glenebon Uplands	GU	110	Rugged hills, tangled undergrowth, rocky outcroppings
17	Numeria	NU	112	Rugged badlands with sporadically vegetated hills
18	Thousand Voices	TV	115	Dense, dangerous forest haunted by the First World
19	Branthlend Mountains	BR	117	Dangerous, towering mountains

under the watchful eyes of Nyrissa, a cursed nymph queen from the mysterious realm of the First World. Yet these times of relative calm in the Stolen Lands are coming to an end.

Under Lady Jamandi Aldori's stewardship, the swordlords of Restov are poised to send agents and explorers into the disputed region. Spurred to action in part by an increase in aggression among the bandits and the worsening political tensions to the north, the swordlords hope their agents can chart and settle the Stolen Lands. The establishment of four new "puppet kingdoms," all beholden to Restov's swordlords and the rest of Rostland, would bring not only freedom from banditry and raids along Rostland's southern border, but also the resources and clout needed to make a play for a higher station in Brevoy's complicated political scene. If all goes well, the return of the Stolen Lands to Brevic control could give Rostland the footing it needs to challenge the Surtova hold for the crown.

Unfortunately, the swordlords haven't anticipated the result of these pushes into the Stolen Lands, for in each of these regions, agents and allies of Nyrissa, King Castruccio Irovetti of Pitax, the Tiger Lord barbarians, and others are already laying their own plans. When confronted by explorers and expansionists from the north, their reactions will be anything but calm and serene. The swordlords may not realize it, but they're bringing war to their border, and their agents may well become liabilities and enemies when they gain a taste of what it is to rule.

Kingmaker uses the rules for running hexploration, as detailed on pages 172–173 of the *Pathfinder Gamemastery Guide*; you should familiarize yourself with those rules before running the more sandbox-oriented portions of this Adventure Path. Encounter-specific activities beyond those detailed in the *Gamemastery Guide* are presented in the context of the encounter text itself.

THE STOLEN LANDS

The map of the Stolen Lands is divided into 20 zones, 19 of which are keyed to different levels. (The Brevoy zone is not keyed to a level since the PCs cannot settle it or expand into it during the scope of this Adventure Path; it's therefore listed as "zone 0.") Zone levels suggest the level the PCs are likely to be as the storyline moves into that zone and indicate the general threats that might confront explorers in that zone.

Each zone contains within it a number of encounter sites, all of which are tagged using a two-letter code for the zone plus a number for the encounter itself. For larger encounter sites, specific locations use more typical alphanumeric encounter keys and are presented in their own parts later in this chapter. There are also several encounter sites that play specific roles in the primary storyline of Kingmaker: locations like the Stag Lord's Fort, Vordakai's Tomb, and Whiterose Abbey are detailed in the appropriate chapters later in this book.

A summary of each zone is provided in the Stolen Land Zones table above, while a map of the region and its zones appears on pages 56–57.

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ENCOUNTER SITES

The PCs can discover a hex's encounter site either by traversing the hex in exploration and encounter modes or by using the hexploration rules in the *Gamemastery Guide*.

The hex encounters in the Stolen Lands have four potential traits: landmark, resource, standard, and secret.

Landmark Encounter: A landmark encounter is apparent from any adjacent open terrain hex. The PCs automatically discover it when they Travel in the hex. At your discretion, particularly enormous or obvious landmarks can be spotted from even further distances.

Resource Encounter: A resource encounter contains materials of value to the PCs' kingdom or opportunities for its expansion. If the PCs explore hexes containing resource encounters before they begin building their kingdom, bring these potential resources to their attention once they begin focusing on kingdom management (full rules for kingdoms appear in Appendix 2).

Standard Encounter: A standard encounter is automatically discovered when the PCs Reconnoiter the hex. If the hex is open terrain, it's also automatically discovered when the PCs Travel in the hex.

Secret Encounter: If the party doesn't already know about the site's location, such as by learning about it from an NPC, the PCs discover a secret encounter only if they take specific actions (often involving a successful skill check) as detailed in the encounter's text.

FAIR WARNING!

While the chance of stumbling upon an encounter well beyond the PCs' capabilities is part of the attraction and thrill of sandbox play, it can also catch players off guard. The flow of Kingmaker's storyline seeks to keep the players focused on zones that are appropriate for their level, but still, the players should be free to make choices of their own.

As long as the PCs are exploring hexes in zones that are keyed no more than 1 level higher than the party, there's no need to warn the players. In hexes 2 or 3 levels above the party, you're probably safe letting the PCs find out what awaits them organically, but be prepared to help out the PCs if they get in trouble. If the PCs attempt to Travel or Reconnoiter a hex that's 4 or more levels higher, though, consider providing some form of warning that they may be getting in over their head. An old "Danger" sign, the discovery of a dead monster that would have been a difficult challenge for them, or the sighting of a distant overwhelming threat like a giant, dragon, or megafauna can let the players know to proceed with caution. Advice and rumors from NPCs can help as well, but make sure that the players don't interpret a sincere warning as a tempting dare!

RANDOM ENCOUNTERS AND HAZARDS

As the PCs explore the Stolen Lands, you can liven things up using random encounters with monsters that roam the area. You can leave these random encounters to a roll of the die by making a flat check as detailed on page 173 of the *Gamemastery Guide*, or you can simply decide that a random encounter happens whenever you feel like the pace of play could use a bit of action. Each zone has its own random encounter table (presented in part 2, at the start of each zone's section), or you can pick a thematic monster of your choice.

You can also spice up exploration with environmental hazards. Hazards like yellow mold or quicksand (both detailed in the *Core Rulebook*) or others like shriekers, treacherous scree, or perilous flash floods (all detailed in the *Gamemastery Guide*) can help spice up stretches of exploration when a more complex combat encounter isn't needed. You can even build new hazards by adjusting existing environmental dangers presented in these books simply by describing them differently. A patch of purple puffball-like fungus that spews flesh-eating spores can surprise veteran groups, even though the rules you're using for the dangerous fungus are the same as for a patch of green slime!

MINOR ENCOUNTER MAPS

While many of the encounter areas in the Stolen Lands are detailed in their own parts later in this adventure, others are relatively simple. Some of these encounters are supported by specific maps, but others are not; for them, and for encounters with wandering monsters, you can create maps of your own, repurpose one of the many maps presented in the pages of this book (such as the forest pond map on page 70, the creek map on page 81, or the creature lair map on page 84), or pick an appropriate map from the wide assortment of Pathfinder Flip-Mats and Flip-Tiles. In addition, three Flip-Mat products designed specifically for Kingmaker are available, including *Flip-Mat: Noble Manor*, *Flip-Mat: Campsite*, and *Flip-Mat: River Kingdoms Ruins*.

POSTER MAP FOLIO

The *Kingmaker Poster Map Folio* comes with six four-panel poster maps, including four that combine to show the entirety of the lands that your characters will explore during this campaign. You can mount the four posters onto foam-core boards and use them as a physical representation of the party's progress and as a tool to track their growing kingdom. Stickers can be used to indicate landmarks, forts, villages, cities, roads, dungeons, and even empty hexes that have been thoroughly explored. The posters give your players an idea of what areas are left to explore and which parts of the PCs' kingdom may need further development.

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KINGDOM MANAGEMENT SCREEN

A much smaller version of the map of the Stolen Lands appears on the face of the *Kingmaker Kingdom Management Screen*; you can use wet-erase markers on it to provide a similar effect. This screen also contains numerous tables and helpful reminders to aid GMs in running a Kingmaker campaign, focused particularly on the mechanics of building kingdoms and settlements, running Kingdom turns, and running warfare encounters. (Full details for these rules appear in this book in Appendices 2 and 3, starting on page 518.)

CAMPING AND WEATHER

Wilderness-based explorations can be affected deeply by the places the PCs decide to set up camp or by unexpected changes in the weather. You can certainly gloss over these elements in your game if you wish, using camping, terrain, and weather simply as flavor to keep things exciting, or you can have these elements add an exciting new layer of complexity to your campaign. Camping encounters can help to make the Stolen Lands seem even more dangerous and can give PCs opportunities to earn a bit more XP if they've fallen behind. At the same time, if the PCs spend time camping in lands they've claimed, consider the option of downplaying the dangers they face to make it feel like the PCs are making progress in settling the dangerous territory. In any event, the *Kingmaker Companion Guide* provides additional rules and resources for adding both of the following elements to your game.

Camping: Expanded rules for camping can be found on pages 106–119 of the *Kingmaker Companion Guide*, including rules on how to fortify campsites, the effects that different meals might have, and how to integrate roleplaying elements between the PCs and their NPC companions.

Weather: Pages 120–125 of the *Kingmaker Companion Guide* present rules for weather in the Stolen Lands. This is a detailed system for generating weather and climate effects as Kingmaker's seasons roll on, but if you'd rather use a less complex system for incorporating weather, you can use this quick and easy system: roll three different-colored dice—one for temperature, one for precipitation, and one for wind. If you roll lower, the temperature is lower, the sky is clearer, and the wind is calmer. If you roll higher, the temperature is higher, there is more precipitation, and the wind is stronger. These variations can then be used as you see fit to add flavor to the PCs' explorations.

RUMORS

As the PCs explore, they'll have numerous opportunities to speak to NPCs and creatures that dwell in the Stolen Lands. In some cases, information these characters might reveal to the PCs is indicated in their respective encounters, but each zone also has its own table of rumors you can roll on or pick from if you need to supply the PCs with a bit of excitement!

In the early part of Kingmaker, Oleg's Trading Post makes a perfect place for PCs to hear news. The PCs might learn something from Svetlana over dinner, or perhaps from Oleg while they're selling some loot to him. Traveling hunters, merchants, and pilgrims at the trading post can also be a source of rumors. The Gather Information exploration activity is the best way to run this sort of rumor-gathering—a success generates one rumor regarding the region the PCs are in, while a critical success could generate either two rumors about their region or one rumor from a different region.

Many intelligent creatures dwell within the Stolen Lands. If the PCs make peaceful contact with any of them, you can reward that accomplishment by giving them one or two rumors relevant to the area.

The tables on the following two pages present several stories, rumors, and bits of news that the PCs could learn when gathering information. Some of these entries may well become obsolete as the PCs explore and defeat foes, so make sure to adjust things as necessary. A few of the rumors are false; these are noted as such in the table. Even false rumors can fuel adventure by sending the PCs to investigate a region that may well hold secrets or opportunities far beyond what they expect!



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CENTRAL STOLEN LANDS RUMORS

These rumors can be discovered in Brevoy or in zones 1–6. If you want to constrain lower-level PCs to hearing rumors for sites that won't challenge them beyond their capabilities, roll 1d10 on this table instead of 1d20.

d20	Rumor
1	Breeg Orlivanch, a foul-mannered trapper, has been missing for some time; they say he gave up trapping and joined a bandit camp hidden at the head of Thorn River! (False.)
2	Some of the bandits wear amulets that resemble a stag's skull. These bandits belong to a debased cult dedicated to a hideous animal demon. (The second sentence is false.)
3	There used to be a bridge crossing the Shrike River to the southeast, but bandits ruined it. They say the old bridge keeper Davik Nettles haunts the place now.
4	The bandits are getting braver and more organized, and there are whispers they've got a new leader: a man who dresses in animals' bones and calls himself the Stag Lord.
5	Bandits aren't the only things in the Kamelands that cause trouble—kobolds and gremlins live in the hills too. They aren't as much trouble as the bandits, but their presence certainly makes the idea of settling the land less attractive.
6	The primary trade route between the River Kingdoms and Brevoy is the East Sellen River, a major waterway that runs through a swampy region to the west called the Hooktongue Slough. That trade route has been closed for several months, due to increasing violence from members of the boggard knots who dwell there. Hopefully, the frog folk keep to the swamp and don't turn their bulging eyes east toward the Narlmarches!
7	A group of evil monks and priests of the goddess of hatred, extortion, and spite once lived on the northern shore of the Tuskwater. I bet there are still cultists out there, and that they're behind the sudden rise in bandit raids! (Partially false: a monastery dedicated to Gyronna did once sit on the shores of the Tuskwater, and while the bandits have repurposed the ruined structure as their hideout, Gyronna's faith has nothing to do with the Stag Lord or his bandits.)
8	Some people report that a unicorn lives in the Narlmarches, but sightings of the magnificent creature have fallen off in recent months. Perhaps the unicorn was driven out by the bandits?
9	Folks have mentioned spotting strange plantlife and fungi growing in the wilds—flora that doesn't seem natural to the Stolen Lands. (This rumor doesn't pertain to any one encounter in particular, but is meant to foreshadow the growing influence of the First World over the region as the Adventure Path progresses.)
10	An old friend of a friend had a brother—a traveling wizard—who went missing in the Stolen Lands a while back. His spellbook is probably just rotting away in the underbrush or in some monster's lair. Shame, really!
11	The Stag Lord has risen from the dead and now stalks the Greenbelt, gathering an army of ghostly bandits from an ancient crypt in the eastern Kamelands. (This rumor is false, but can't occur at all until after the PCs kill the Stag Lord at the end of Chapter 3.)
12	Beware the hateful hermit to the south. He speaks to beasts and lives in a hollow tree.
13	A red dragon lives in the Narlmarches and eats anyone who crosses its path. (False. This rumor is the result of sightings of the drake at area **SP1**.)
14	Some gnome explorers came by a few weeks ago, claiming they're here to map the entire Greenbelt; they were last seen heading up the Skunk River.
15	A hag known as the Swamp Witch lives in a marsh on the northwest shore of the Tuskwater. She consorts with demons and steals children, boiling them for stew in her magic cauldron. (False.)
16	A brutish hill giant has been seen wandering the southern Kamelands. Give him a wide berth—or a stiff drink—and he'll leave you alone. For the most part.
17	To the west, there's an old ruin built long ago by the elves. Some say it's full of treasure, but others say it's haunted by angry spirits and worse.
18	In the southern Stolen Lands dwells a band of violent lizardfolk led by a lizard king who talks to the spirits of his dead ancestors.
19	The old tower on the island in Candlemere marks a place where the boundary between this world and another has grown thin; it's now guarded by some sort of deadly monster.
20	The Swamp Witch is friendly enough if you call out to her before you enter her yard. Those foolish enough to trespass end up working for her as scarecrows or worse! (The former is true, but the latter is false.)

EASTERN STOLEN LANDS RUMORS

These rumors can be discovered in zones 7–9.

d10	Rumor
1	A silver dragon lives in the Tors of Levenies, but no one has seen her for some time. Perhaps she moved on? (Partially false: the silver dragon is now dead.)
2	A giant bird lives in the ruins of an old tower on Talon Peak.
3	Lake monsters lurk in Lake Silverstep, they say, but the eels that also live there make damn fine eating.

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4	The centaurs of Nomen, in the Dunsward, are violent and territorial; if you're going to visit them, don't make any sudden moves when one of their war parties approaches you.
5	The centaurs from Nomen eat humans. I suppose that's not technically cannibalism—but still pretty horrible! (False.)
6	One of my cousin's friend's fathers was an assayer, and he says that there's probably some pretty good grounds for mining south of Lake Silverstep.
7	One-eyed giants once ruled this entire area; the strangely regular mounds you see on the Tors now and then are the ruins of their lost kingdom.
8	There's a valley to the south that the Nomen clan centaurs say is an old cyclops graveyard. It's said that an army of one-eyed, blood-drinking ghosts guards the place! (Partially false: the cemetery contains no ghosts.)
9	The Nomen centaurs bury their dead in strange boneyards in the Dunsward; there's probably lots of treasure buried with them. Too bad the places are swarming with undead centaurs! (False.)
10	A group of spriggans lives somewhere in the Tors. They've been at war with the Nomen centaurs for as long as anyone, I reckon. Rumor holds that the current spriggan leader stole a magic bow from the centaurs quite a few years ago, and that's what started the whole fight between them.

WESTERN STOLEN LANDS RUMORS

These rumors can be discovered in zones 10–12.

d10	Rumor
1	The Tiger Lord barbarians have a new warlord who seeks a powerful weapon long thought lost; if he finds this weapon, he may become a dangerous foe.
2	Baron Drelev has taken on a beautiful young lover, much to his wife's dismay. . . and with good cause, for this lover is in fact a succubus who has dominated the baron and is behind all of Fort Drelev's problems. (Partially false: the baron's lover is human.)
3	There's a secret tunnel between the dungeons of Drelev Keep and a hidden exit somewhere near the city.
4	Baron Drelev was a plant from Pitax from the start, and he's only now showing his true colors—"surrendering" to King Castruccio was just a sham. (False, and this rumor won't start to circulate until the PCs are about to start Chapter 7.)
5	The most powerful boggard settlement in the swamp has found a strange new god to worship.
6	Giants have been spotted to the north; some say they're part of a larger force moving in from Numeria, and they carry strange weaponry with them. (False.)
7	People say the black dragon Ilthuliak has returned to the Stolen Lands and has recently moved into Hooktongue Slough. (Partially false: Ilthuliak is back, but her lair is in the Branthlend Mountains).
8	An old but dangerous saber-toothed tiger called Speartooth lives somewhere in the hills north of the swamp. Baron Drelev hired a hard-case hunter to seek out the tiger and kill it, but no one's heard of the hunter since. The tiger must have eaten him!
9	A group of strange, intelligent insects known as bog striders live in the swamp. They're said to be at war with the much more prolific boggards.
10	Old Hooktongue, the lake monster, hasn't been sighted in many years. (True.) Maybe he died? (False.)

PITAX RUMORS

These rumors can be discovered in zones 13–19.

d10	Rumor
1	A flight of wyverns has destroyed the village of Littletown, and they say that King Castruccio Irovetti actually gave the wyverns permission to do so! (This rumor won't start until after the War of the River Kings begins.)
2	A lot of folks are unhappy with Castruccio's rule, including a woman named Ilora Nuski, who once led the River Razors. She's said to be hiding out in the wilds still, plotting a way to raise an army against the king.
3	Castruccio caught a huge remorhaz several years ago. He marched it through Pitax and still keeps it in his dungeon as a pet.
4	There's a mammoth graveyard in the Branthlend Mountains; whoever discovers it will surely make a great fortune in ivory!
5	Some say that the black dragon Ilthuliak is dead, but a friend of a friend saw her flying over Glenebon just last month!
6	The old abbey on Whiterose Hill is still haunted by the priests of Cayden Cailean who were murdered there years ago. (Partially false: it's haunted by their murderer.)
7	The so-called mother of all wyverns, Minognos-Ushad, lives in a cave just at the easternmost edge of Thousand Voices.
8	Castruccio has fallen under the spell of a vampire priestess of Urgathoa who lives in a secret cave under his palace. She wants to turn Pitax into a necropolis! (False.)
9	The mastodon-riding hill giants known as Tusker's Riders are on the march! Some say King Castruccio hired them, but I don't believe that.
10	Somewhere in Thousand Voices lies a mysterious ruin called the Castle of Knives, but no one seems to know who built it.

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PART 2:

HEX ENCOUNTERS

This part provides encounters and quests for all 20 zones of the Stolen Lands. With the exception of the first zone, each zone includes a wandering monster table that includes that zone's two-letter abbreviation. All significant hex encounters are detailed thereafter.

ZONE 0: BREVOY

The southern reach of Brevoy is Rostland. Restov is the most sizable and significant settlement in Rostland, but otherwise the landscape consists of sparsely populated farmlands. A single road runs along the country's southern border; banditry here remains relatively light.

Brevoy is settled enough that there is little fear of wandering monsters, but if you wish to include some, you can use the chart for zone 1 on page 52.

BV1. RESTOV

LANDMARK

The large city of Restov is the cultural center of southern Brevoy and the birthplace of the world-famous Aldori dueling style. Restov owes its allegiance to the Brevic crown, and its lord-mayor must bend his knee before the Dragonscale Throne like any lord, but otherwise Restov belongs to no house, making it a haven for independents like the Aldori swordlords and those who long for the old days before the region was under Brevic rule. While many of those in power in Restov have their city's best interests at heart and are individually kind-hearted, the value they put on individuality and personal freedom makes Restov as a whole less concerned with what's best for the rest of Brevoy.

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Restov is a city of both refined tradition and rough-and-tumble manners, as only a colony fondly recalling and imitating its motherland can be. Its location on Brevoy's southern border makes it a bustling trade center, so its relative wealth can support no small number of idle and titled nobles and merchant guilds. Citizens frequent various Aldori and Taldan dueling schools, as well as alehouses, and fight each other in street corner duels at dawn and dusk. The schools, salons, and taprooms of Restov are hotbeds of rebellious talk against the reign of King Noleski Surtova, with young firebrands in search of a leader to rally them to the cause.

Restov is more than just where this Adventure Path begins—it's also an excellent place for the PCs to buy or sell expensive items before their own cities reach a point where they can make purchases there instead. As this adventure continues, the citizens and government of Restov grow increasingly concerned with their Issian neighbors to the north, and so—assuming the PCs don't encroach politically upon their lands—Restov is likely to play a minor role beyond the PCs' potentially long-term support from Lady Jamandi Aldori.

RESTOV — SETTLEMENT 9

CN CITY

Cultural center of Rostland

Government autocracy

Population 18,670 (15,240 humans, 1,220 dwarves, 950 gnomes, 820 halflings, 240 half-elves, 130 elves, 70 other)

Languages Common, Hallit, Skald, Varisian

Religions Calistria, Cayden Cailean, Erastil, Gorum, Milani, Pharasma

Threats political unrest and scheming, hinterland banditry

Swordlord Stronghold As the heart of the traditions of the Aldori swordlords, Aldori dueling swords (*Lost Omens World Guide* 28) are commonly available, and those in good standing (at the GM's discretion) can gain access to the Aldori Duelist archetype (*Lost Omens World Guide* 35).

Ioseph Sellemius (NG male human aristocrat 5) Lord mayor of Restov

Jamandi Aldori (CG female half-elf Aldori swordlord 14) Renowned swordlord and influential noblewoman

Ezvanki Keegh (NG male human cleric of Erastil 10) High priest of Erastil

BV2. NIVAKTA'S CROSSING

LANDMARK

Nivakta's Crossing is the southernmost village in Rostland and an alert assembly of traders, hunters, fishers, and trappers. The village itself is surrounded by a wooden palisade and is set on the northeastern bank of the Shrike River. A low bridge allows access over the river to the wilderness to the south—the southwestern side of the bridge being fortified by well-defended guard towers.

The people of Nivakta's Crossing are sturdy, down to earth, and possess stunted senses of humor. Serious to a fault, they are slightly more suspicious of visitors from what they call "the South" than they are of those from "the North," but they're willing to take the PCs' coin for trade nonetheless.

Nivakta's Crossing is where Maegar Varn and his mercenaries cross the Shrike to head into Nomen Heights when they set out to establish Varnhold; the passage of the small army through town is novel enough that it's all that the locals seem to chat (and complain) about for weeks afterward.

NIVAKTA'S CROSSING — SETTLEMENT 1

CN VILLAGE

Government autocracy

Population 140 (110 humans, 15 gnomes, 10 dwarves, 5 others)

Languages Common, Hallit

Religions Pharasma

Threats banditry

Rumor Mill The folk of Nivakta's Crossing are gossips, so any character attempting a Diplomacy check to Gather Information to learn rumors while in town gains a +2 circumstance bonus.

Irven Revanisu (CN male human aristocrat 2) Mayor of Nivakta's Crossing

Lorin Kaven (N male human ranger 2) Local sheriff and commander of the town guard

Kara Ilarenika (N female human cleric of Pharasma 6) Keeper of the town's only church

ZONE 1: ROSTLAND HINTERLANDS

This grassland wilderness sits just outside the border of Brevoy. While not technically part of the nation, its proximity to Brevoy and relative lack of valuable resources means that banditry is relatively light. South Rostland Road was built ages ago by eager engineers, but money eventually ran out, leaving the road to slowly degrade into little more than a glorified trail. To the north of area **RL1**, the road eventually loops back to Brevoy on a long, winding route until it reaches the east bank of the East Sellen River about 40 miles north of Wyvernstone Bridge (area **HT1**).

KINGDOM RESOURCES

Sometimes, a hex contains resources or terrain features of note that can impact kingdom building. In this case, a hex encounter contains a "Resources" entry, which can include additional activities for use during a Kingdom turn. See Appendix 2 for additional details for these sections.

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ROSTLAND HINTERLANDS (RL) ZONE 1

d20	Encounter	Challenge
1–5	3 bandits (use stats for Thorn River bandits on page 170)	Low 1
6–8	2 brush thylacines (page 609);	Low 1
9–11	1 hunter (use stats for poacher)[GMG]	Low 1
12–13	2 elk (page 608)	Moderate 1
14–15	2 wolves[B1]	Moderate 1
16–17	2 boars[B1]	Moderate 1
18–19	3 thylacines (page 609)	Moderate 1
20	1 grizzly bear[B1]	Severe 1

Bandits These bandits are not affiliated with the Stag Lord, but they have heard of him and hope to rob the PCs and use the wealth they steal to buy their way into his band.

Hunter Encounters with a hunter use the stats for a poacher (*Gamemastery Guide* 218), but these hunters are neutral and relatively law-abiding. They can be an excellent source of rumors for the PCs, or can warn them about nearby dangers (such as the threat of crossing into a more dangerous zone). At your discretion, some hunter encounters can be with poachers who attack the PCs rather than risk having someone tell the authorities about their activities.

RL1. OLEG'S TRADING POST

LANDMARK | RESOURCE

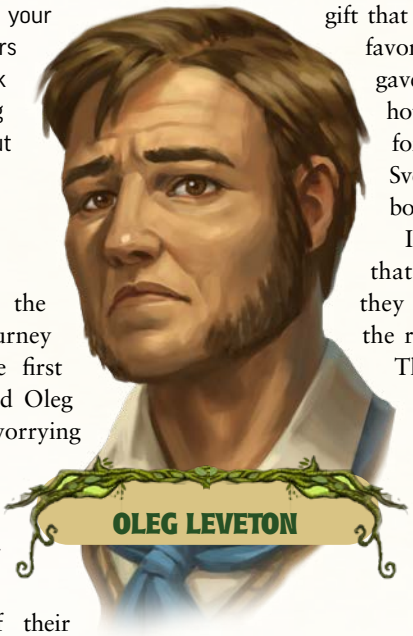
Oleg's Trading Post represents the true beginning to the PCs' journey through the Stolen Lands. The first time they arrive here, they'll find Oleg Leveton and his wife Svetlana worrying about an imminent visit from bandits; Chapter 3 provides more details on this initial encounter.

During the early stages of Kingmaker, before the PCs have established the foundations of their kingdom, they are likely to return time and time again to this trading post to rest, sell treasure, replenish gear, and more. The first time the characters return to Oleg's after dealing with the Stag Lord in Chapter 3, they'll find that the long-promised additional security from Restov has arrived—although perhaps not to the extent Oleg had hoped (detailed in Kesten Garess's Arrival, below). However, these extra guards are enough to deter the regional bandits and to make Oleg's Trading Post a generally safe haven for the PCs as they explore the area.

Creatures: The daughter of a minor noble in Restov, Svetlana Beyavin grew up amid wealth and splendor but hated every minute of it. Without the skill at swordplay that might have allowed her to make a name for herself, she was forced to learn to navigate the lavish parties and decadent gatherings of her peers just to fit in. But where she hoped to find friendship, she found only manipulation, and her efforts at kindness and honesty served her poorly in the world of politics. Finding her life in the city stultifying, she longed for something more suited to her sensibilities. She found what she was seeking when she met Oleg Leveton.

The son of a carpenter, Oleg Leveton grew up in a small village before heading to Restov to make his fortune, but his stubborn pride made success difficult. He refused to compromise his work or try to appear humble to curry favor with the nobility. The gentry had no qualms about cheating him, or even refusing to pay for work, leaving him sullen and angry. Despite his best efforts, the success he desired never materialized as the years passed. Afraid he was failing, he longed for a chance to make something of himself.

When Svetlana was tasked by her father to find a gift that could swing a trade deal in her family's favor, her search led her to Oleg, whose work gave Svetlana's house a crucial edge in the hotly contested deal. It led to further work for Oleg, which led to a friendship with Svetlana and eventually—to the delight of both—to love.



It wasn't long before the couple realized that life in the city wasn't for them, and they eloped and left Restov after securing the rights to an old fort in the hinterlands. They managed to rebuild the fort into a proper trading post before long. They were, finally, truly happy—until recently, as their hard work has drawn the attention of local bandits. Now, the couple needs help in defending their home—help the PCs are able provide, if they wish!

OLEG CREATURE 1

UNIQUE | CG | MEDIUM | HUMANOID | HUMAN

Perception +6
Languages Common
Skills Athletics +6, Crafting +7, Intimidation +4, Nature +3, Survival +4
Str +3, **Dex** +1, **Con** +3, **Int** +0, **Wis** +1, **Cha** +1
Items carpenter's tools, hammer, *lover's knots* (5, page 586), padded armor, repair kit

AC 12; **Fort** +8, **Ref** +6, **Will** +6
HP 26

Speed 25 feet
Melee ❖ light hammer +8 (agile, thrown 20 ft.), **Damage** 1d6+3 bludgeoning
Ranged ❖ light hammer +6 (agile, thrown 20 ft.), **Damage** 1d6+3 bludgeoning

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SVETLANA CREATURE 1

UNIQUE | NG | MEDIUM | HUMANOID | HUMAN

Perception +5
Languages Common
Skills Brevoy Lore +6, Diplomacy +7, Medicine +5, Society +6, Survival +3
Str +0, **Dex** +3, **Con** +3, **Int** +1, **Wis** +0, **Cha** +2
Items cleaver, leather armor

AC 15; **Fort** +6, **Ref** +8, **Will** +5
HP 20

Speed 25 feet
Melee ❖ cleaver +6 (agile), **Damage** 1d6 slashing



SVETLANA LEVETON

Resting: The PCs are welcome to stay at Oleg's Trading Post during Downtime activities, from resting and recovery to Crafting, long-term recovery, or anything else. Characters who defend the trading post from the Stag Lord's bandits can maintain a comfortable living here, free of charge, until they've established their kingdom at the start of Chapter 4.

Shopping: The first time the PCs visit, Oleg's Trading Post has a small amount of trade goods and coins available as detailed on page 163 of Chapter 3. Oleg is always happy to buy anything the characters find during their exploration, from looted weapons and armor to magic items taken from treasure caches.

Oleg and Svetlana have a keen eye for the types of things that adventurers want, and as the adventure progresses, the trading post's ability to provide for the characters increases. Oleg continues to trade with traveling merchants and even receives a loan from agents in Restov to increase his holdings.

You should let the characters purchase their goods from Oleg if possible, preventing the need for them to travel to Restov just to buy and sell. Rather than keeping a detailed list of Oleg's inventory, it's easier to simply assume that the trading post always has any of the common weapons, armor, and gear listed in the *Core Rulebook* that the PCs can afford to buy. If the characters wish to purchase something more rare, Oleg can place a special order and the item will be available in 2d6+4 days (subject to GM's discretion).

Resources: Oleg's Trading Post serves as a Refuge if the hex is Claimed. If a settlement is built here, the Trading Post instead functions as a free General Store for the settlement.

Helping the Levetons: As the PCs continue to make names for themselves as capable adventurers, the Levetons will start to make some requests for aid. Feel free to introduce the quests for Oleg's Trophy, Radish Soup, and Svetlana's Ring as you see fit to help guide the PCs in their early days of exploring the Stolen Lands.

OLEG'S TROPHY

10 XP

The way everyone talks about tatzlwyrms, one might think they're everywhere. This isn't the case; they're actually quite rare. A tatzlwyrm head would be a great conversation piece at Oleg's, so he has promised a reward for anyone who can deliver one.

Source: Oleg Leveton (area **RL1**)

Completion: Slay a tatzlwyrm and bring back its head intact.

Reward: Oleg gives the PCs his 5 *lover's knots* for the tatzlwyrm head.

RADISH SOUP

10 XP

Oleg has been under a lot of stress lately, and Svetlana would love to cook him his favorite meal—moon radish soup—to help him relax. Svetlana knows the closest moon radish patch grows about 16 miles south of the trading post, but she hasn't been able to visit the site in months.

Source: Svetlana Leveton (area **RL1**)

Completion: Bring Svetlana a basket of moon radishes from area **GB4**.

Reward: Svetlana pays 15 gp to anyone who can bring her enough moon radishes. If the PCs stay the night at Oleg's, she gives each of them a helping of moon radish soup. After this, the PCs can purchase additional helpings of the soup at regular price (page 587 provides more details on this delicious meal).

SVETLANA'S RING

30 XP

Although Svetlana claims it's not a big loss compared to what the bandits could have taken, Oleg knows the theft of her wedding ring has distressed his wife. She has forbidden him from risking life and limb to recover it, but if anyone can return the ring, he'll be very grateful. The bandits were the last to have the ring, but they might have lost or sold it already.

Source: Oleg Leveton (area **RL1**)

Completion: Find the ring and bring it back to Oleg.

Reward: Oleg promises 50 gp in trading post credit if his wife's ring is recovered.

Wanted Posters: Now and then, officials from Restov visit Oleg's Trading Post and put up wanted posters announcing rewards offered by the Swordlords for troublemakers of all types. The PCs may discover these

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on their own through exploration, but you can also offer up opportunities for adventure with these quests.

WANTED: KOBOLDS

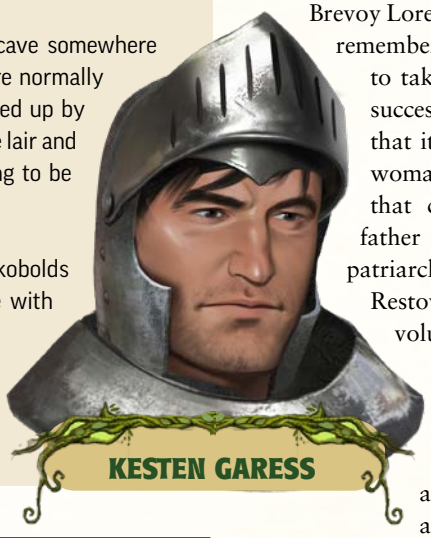
30 XP

The Sootscale kobolds dwell in a cave somewhere in the hills of the Greenbelt. They're normally not a problem, but they've been riled up by something lately. Find the Sootscale lair and ensure that the kobolds aren't going to be a threat.

Source: Wanted poster

Completion: Either slay the kobolds or forge a peace treaty or alliance with them.

Reward: One week after the PCs have ensured that kobold activity is under control, the Swordlords send them a reward of 40 gp.



WANTED: TUSKGUTTER

10 XP

Every Greenbelt hunter has a story about Tuskgutter, the nastiest boar in the Greenbelt. Whoever manages to kill the ill-tempered beast will earn a nice reward from the retired hunter Vekkel Benzen, who lost his leg to the monster pig a year ago.

Source: Wanted poster

Completion: Deliver Tuskgutter's head to Oleg's so Vekkel can spit in that dirty pig's eye!

Reward: Vekkel has promised his composite longbow and three *beacon shot arrows* to whoever can kill Tuskgutter. He also promises to share the delicious head cheese he plans to make out of this trophy.

WANTED: BANDITS

30 XP

The bandits need to be shown that their actions will not be tolerated. Kill or capture enough bandits to send a message to their leaders.

Source: Wanted poster

Completion: Defeat six or more bandits, either killing them (with proof of death) or bringing them captive to Oleg's. The initial encounter at Oleg's with Happs and his bandits does not count toward this number.

Reward: A week after the sixth bandit has been caught, the Swordlords send the PCs a reward of 30 gp.

Kesten Garess's Arrival

At some point after the PCs set out to explore the Stolen Lands after helping defend Oleg's Trading Post from the bandits, but before the next time they return to the trading post, **Kesten Garess** (CN male fighter 3) arrives with a group of three 1st-level mercenaries under his command. They set their small tents up just south of the stable, in the shadow of the palisade.

Kesten is a member of one of Brevoy's noble houses in name only, and a character succeeding at a DC 15 Brevoy Lore or Society check to Recall Knowledge remembers hints of a scandal that forced him to take up a mercenary's life. On a critical success, the character recalls hearing more—that it was an affair between Kesten and a woman named Tania, a weaver's daughter, that caused his exile from nobility. His father Evan, a cousin of the Garess family patriarch, disowned Kesten, who then fled to Restov to seek work as a mercenary. He volunteered to lead the small group of soldiers to help guard Oleg's Trading Post after his own depression and shame grew too much to handle. Kesten hopes to either make his name as the defender of a remote fort or die an honorable death fighting bandits and other dangers in the region.

For now, Kesten need only be a somewhat moody and morose guard but, in addition to providing the characters the opportunity to assist him, he could become an important ally for the characters as they continue to settle the Stolen Lands. If the party gets into more trouble than they can handle, you can have Kesten and his men come to their rescue, but otherwise, he should remain at the trading post, if only to give the post protection and relieve the characters of any need to do that job themselves.

FIND FALGRIM

30 XP

A Varisian mercenary who worked with Kesten Garess months ago, Falgrim Sneeg robbed Kesten's group and fled into the Greenbelt to become a bandit. Kesten hopes to catch him alive and return him to Restov for punishment.

Source: Kesten Garess (area **RL1**)

Completion: Capture Falgrim Sneeg, alive if possible.

Reward: Kesten can arrange a reward of three common *+1 weapons* of the capturer's choice if Falgrim is delivered alive. If he's delivered dead, Kesten can only promise one *+1 weapon*.

Jhod Kavken's Arrival

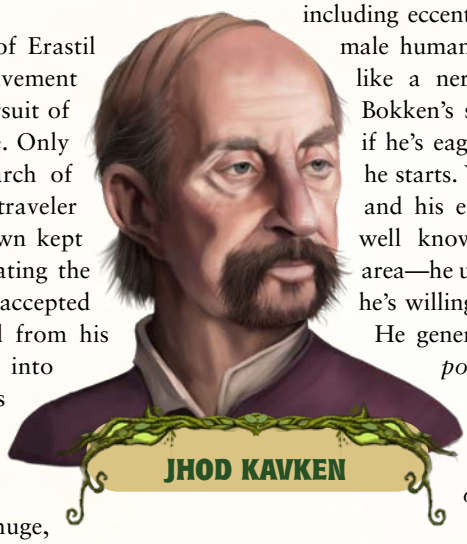
The next time the PCs visit Oleg's Trading Post after meeting Kesten Garess, another traveler has arrived. This is a wandering, Erastil-worshipping druid named **Jhod Kavken** (NG male druid 4), who claims he heard about the exploration charter and came to offer his help. In truth, Jhod has been all but excommunicated from the priesthood after he helped form a mob against a traveler in his home

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village who he thought was a werewolf responsible for several recent killings. Only a few hours after they killed the man, the true murderer was caught by a hunter and revealed to be nothing more sinister than a particularly wily warg.

An investigation by the church of Erastil followed, and they found Jhod's involvement in the village's overly aggressive pursuit of the traveler's death to be actionable. Only the fact that the investigators' search of the man's belongings revealed the traveler as a bandit spy sent to case the town kept the church from fully excommunicating the priest—and even then, only if he accepted exile. After the trial, Jhod traveled from his home in Galt up the Sellen and into Numeria. From there, his wanderings eventually brought him east into Brevoy, where he had a particularly vivid dream about an overgrown temple of Erastil guarded by a huge, angry bear. Upon waking from the dream, Jhod felt an irresistible tug to the south; he now believes that Erastil has given him a chance to redeem himself. The sensation led Jhod to Oleg's Trading Post, but there it stopped—and soon after, he learned from Svetlana about the PCs and their charter. Jhod has also heard rumors of "lost temples" to Erastil in the Stolen Lands, and the first time the PCs return to the trading post after Jhod's arrival, he tracks them down and asks them to keep an eye out for anything of that nature—particularly an old temple guarded by something that's not quite a normal angry bear.



JHOD KAVKEN

VISION OF THE ELK

30 XP

Jhod Kavken asks the PCs to seek out a lost temple of Erastil that he's heard of in his travels. It lies somewhere to the south in the forests of the Narlmarches, and he would like to reconsecrate it, but first he needs the PCs to locate the temple and ensure it's safe for him to visit. He reveals that he had a vision about the temple and warns the PCs that a large bear seems to be guarding the site–and that something is not quite right about the bear.

Source: Jhod Kavken (area **RL1**)

Completion: If the PCs discover the Temple of the Elk at area **GB6** but leave the bear alone, Jhod implores them to return and put the tortured bear to rest before escorting Jhod to the temple. To complete this quest, Jhod or a PC worshipper of Erastil must restore the temple to functionality (see area **GB6** for details).

Reward: Jhod agrees to provide free spellcasting to the PCs for life, with the exception of expensive material components, which the PCs must still supply.

RL2. BOKKEN'S HUT

STANDARD | RESOURCE

Creature: Although the Greenbelt is far from safe, the seclusion promised is too much to resist for some, including eccentric potion-maker **Bokken** (CN male human alchemist 4). With a manner like a nervous bird or a jittery child, Bokken's speech is swift and clipped, as if he's eager to finish every conversation he starts. Yet Bokken is no hater of gold, and his eagerness to sell his potions is well known to many travelers in the area—he usually sells directly to Oleg, but he's willing to sell to the PCs if they ask. He generally keeps two *minor healing potions*, two *lesser healing potions*, a *moderate healing potion*, a *lesser potion of fire resistance*, and a *lesser potion of cold resistance* handy.

In any extended conversation with Bokken, he's likely to mention his younger brother, Kurmil. Bokken spits and curses a fair amount as he does so, bitterly holding up his right hand and indicating his missing pinkie finger. "Bastard cut that off'a me the last time he hit my mother, Desna rest her soul. But he took off right after to live in a hollow tree down south rather than face the guards, so I guess it all worked out well enough." Bokken decided to become a hermit a few years after his brother left home and their parents passed away. Originally, Bokken had toyed with the idea of tracking down his brother and getting revenge, but the wildlife in the Greenbelt was too frightening and dangerous, so he instead settled down not far from the edge of Rostland to live the rest of his life in nature.

Resources: If a settlement is built here, Bokken's Hut grants that settlement a free Alchemy Laboratory.

GATHERING FANGBERRIES

30 XP

Bokken sure knows how to make delicious potions. His secret to deliciousness is fangberry juice, but he's running low on these supplies. A large thicket of fangberries grows about 55 miles southwest of Oleg's Trading Post, and he needs someone canny and strong to fetch them for him. (Helpful PCs may want to ensure the berries they give him aren't dirty; Bokken won't bother washing them before he uses them.)

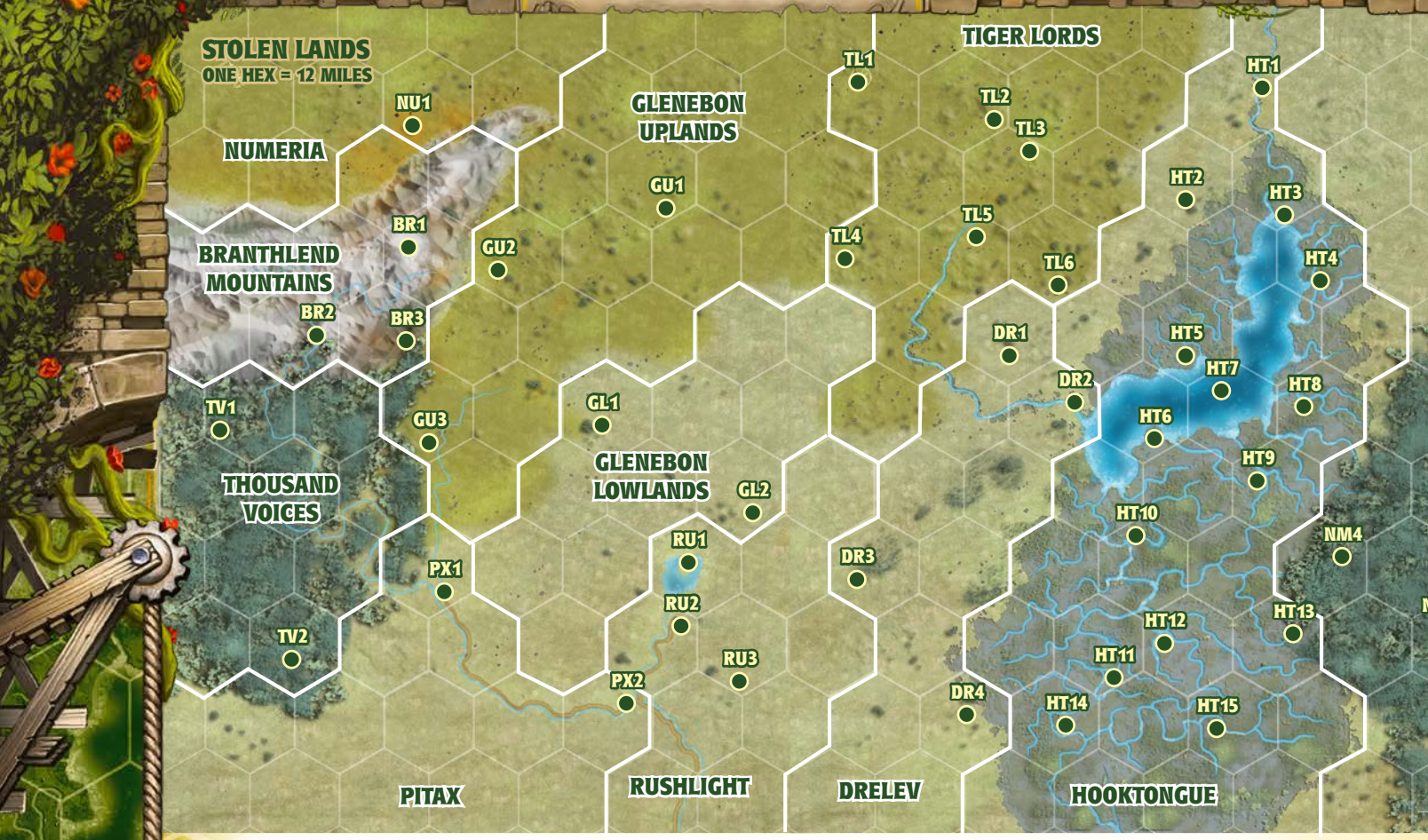
Source: Bokken (area **RL2**)

Completion: Bring Bokken a full basket of berries–enough to make fangberry juice for seven potions.

Reward: Bokken gives the PCs a 25-percent discount on his potions for 1 month. Alternately, he'll give them any three potions he currently has in stock for free.

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RL3. SPIDER NEST

LOW 1

STANDARD

This spider's lair is a 5-foot-diameter, 25-foot-deep shaft. The thick webbing along the walls makes it relatively easy to Climb up and down the shaft (requiring only a DC 10 Athletics check).

Creatures: This area houses the den of a giant trapdoor spider the size of a pony. An area extending nearly 200 feet around the spider's den is strewn with the skeletons of boars, deer, bears, and a few humans, but the spider hiding in the center, just under the web-hinged lids to its den, is not immediately apparent—it uses Stealth to roll initiative as a result.

GIANT TRAPDOOR SPIDER

CREATURE 2

UNCOMMON N MEDIUM ANIMAL

Variant hunting spider (*Pathfinder Bestiary* 306)

Perception +7; darkvision

Skills Acrobatics +7, Athletics +8, Stealth +9

Str +4, **Dex** +4, **Con** +3, **Int** –5, **Wis** +2, **Cha** –4

AC 18; **Fort** +8, **Ref** +11, **Will** +7

HP 28

Trapdoor Lunge ↷ **Requirements** Initiative has not yet been rolled; **Trigger** A creature comes within 25 feet of the spider's lair while the spider is positioned just under the ajar trapdoor, and the spider notices the creature; **Effect** The spider Strides or Climbs before it rolls initiative.

Speed 30 feet, climb 30 feet

Melee ❖ fangs +11, **Damage** 1d10+3 piercing plus giant trapdoor spider venom

Giant Trapdoor Spider Venom (incapacitation, poison); **Saving Throw** Fortitude DC 18; **Maximum Duration** 6 rounds; **Stage 1** 1d10 poison and flat-footed (1 round); **Stage 2** 1d12 poison, slowed 1, and flat-footed (1 round); **Stage 3** 2d6 poison and paralyzed (1 round)

Treasure: Although the spider often cleans out the skeletons that accumulate within 20 feet of its den, it hasn't done so for a week or so, and a few bodies still remain, including a bandit corpse dressed in leather armor and carrying a short sword and 10 sp. He also wears a silver Stag Lord amulet worth 3 gp. Of greater interest is a scrap of paper tucked in his left boot that bears a drawing of a dead, claw-shaped tree atop an otherwise barren hill, with an "X" drawn in blood next to the tree's roots. This crude map offers a clue about the treasure hidden beneath the old tree at area **GB9**.

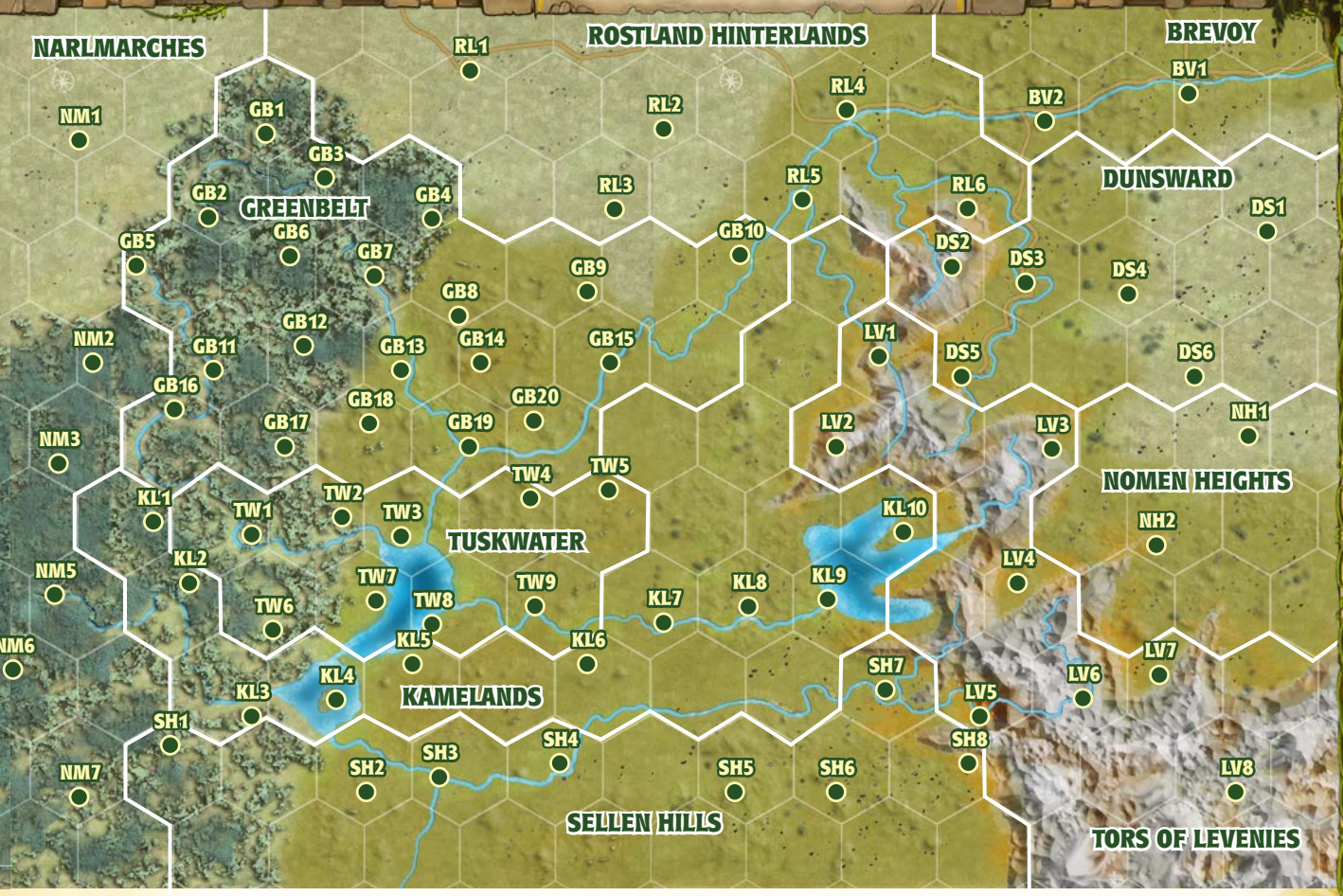
RL4. CROOKED FALLS

LANDMARK

The Shrike River cascades over a series of waterfalls here, each of which drops down 10 to 30 feet. In all,

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CHAPTER 2
PART 1: HEXPLORING THE STOLEN LANDS
PART 2: HEX ENCOUNTERS
PART 3: THE OLD SYCAMORE
PART 4: SOOTSCALE CAVERNS
PART 5: THE LONELY BARROW
PART 6: ISLE OF THE LIZARD KING
PART 7: CANDLEMERE ISLAND
PART 8: THE FORGOTTEN KEEP
PART 9: M'BOTUU

there are five cascades over the course of a mile—the Crooked River tributary flows into the Shrike at approximately the midpoint of the series of waterfalls. These cascades (and the larger Shrike Cascade in area **GB10**) make the Shrike River a poor choice for trade between Brevoy and the south, so river trade traditionally flows along the East Sellen River through Hooktongue Slough to the west—although of late, this route has been particularly dangerous (more details can be found in Chapter 7).

A DC 20 Athletics check to Climb is required to clamber along the banks of these waterfalls.

RL5. FORT SERENKO

RESOURCE | STANDARD

This wooden fortification has stood for years on the southern border of Brevoy, but with the growing tensions between Rostland and Issia, the soldiers and scouts stationed here have been recalled to Restov. The fort itself is empty, with any examination revealing evidence that it was abandoned in a swift but orderly manner.

Resource: The empty fort functions as a Structure terrain feature if the PCs Claim this Hex as part of their kingdom. The fort is rather small, but functions as a Barracks in a settlement established in this hex.

The site's proximity to Brevoy, though, brings with it an extra complication, as Rostland considers it part of their nation's holdings. If the PCs don't secure diplomatic relations with Rostland before attempting to incorporate Fort Serenko into one of their settlements as a Barracks, Rostland's Negotiation DC (page 519) increases to 20, as its nobles consider the PCs' move to be crass and a bit aggressive from a political standpoint.

RL6. DEAD NOBLE

SECRET

This hex contains nothing of interest until the PCs are approached by Edrist Hanvaki after they establish their kingdom. Edrist's concerns about his vanished sibling Temin are presented on page 521 in the quest for "A Missing Brother."

Once this quest is active, poor doomed Temin can be found in this hex. Any time after the quest becomes active, allow each PC who enters this hex to attempt a DC 13 Hills Lore, Hunting Lore, Nature, or Survival check or a DC 17 Perception check to note and understand the presence of buzzards wheeling in the sky. Any success allows the party to discover Temin Hanvaki's body, sprawled dead in a shallow gulch in the foothills here. Temin had hoped to make it to Varnhold to seal a business deal with that village's gem cutter, but

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in his haste to make good time, he slipped and fell into this gulch, breaking his neck in the process.

Treasure: Temin's corpse still wears a mother-of-pearl brooch worth 10 gp; it's this brooch that Edrist seeks. No other valuables can be found here.

ZONE 2: GREENBELT

The region known as the Greenbelt comprises the less-overgrown northern reaches of the Narlmarches to the west and rolling grassy hills to the east. Bandit activity here is relatively strong, with most of the brigands having an affiliation with the Stag Lord. Beyond that, the gremlins and kobolds that lair in the south are the most significant organized danger here.

GREENBELT (GB) — ZONE 2

d20	Encounter	Challenge
1–5	Roll on zone 1 table (page 52)	Varies
6–8	4 mitflit gremlins[B1]	Low 2
9–11	2 hunting spiders[B1]	Low 2
12–13	4 Stag Lord bandits (page 177)	Moderate 2
14–15	2 brush thylacines (page 609)	Moderate 2
16–17	5 kobolds[B1]	Moderate 2
18–19	1 owlbear[B1]	Moderate 2
20	3 ruffians[GMG]	Severe 2

Kobolds An encounter with kobolds consists of 4 kobold warriors led by 1 kobold scout; these kobolds are not part of the Sootscale settlement, but they know about them and, if the PCs capture any alive, could direct the PCs to the Sootscale cave.

Ruffians These independent bandits are not affiliated with the Stag Lord; they know where his fort is, but they prefer not to associate with him (out of fear, or perhaps because they don't want to share their ill-gotten gains). At your discretion, a ruffian whose life is spared can guide the PCs to the fort, or if made helpful, perhaps even help the party take down the Stag Lord and his crew.

Stag Lord Bandits Stag Lord bandits encountered in the wilds haven't yet earned the right to stay in the Stag Lord's fort, but they do know where the fort is located.

GB1. SNARE-FILLED GLADE — TRIVIAL 2

STANDARD

Trappers are common in the northern Greenbelt, since the furs and hides of minks, foxes, deer, and similar creatures can make a skilled hunter rich. Most monitor their traps and are relatively responsible in indicating their presence so that other trappers or wanderers won't fall victim to them, but one misanthropic trapper, a man named Breeg Orlivanch (whose fate is detailed in area **GB2**), takes cruel entertainment from hiding his traps, even from two-legged prey. Breeg's latest trapping grounds can be found in this hex, and while he's long past the point where he can profit from them, his traps can still impede PCs who explore the hex.

Hazard: Breeg's traps consist of cleverly hidden spike snares augmented with additional wooden spikes spread throughout this area. The impact these traps have on the PCs depends on whether they are Traveling or Reconnoitering the hex.

BREEG'S TRAPS — HAZARD 3

MECHANICAL | TRAP

Stealth DC 20

Description Several dozen spike snares are littered across this hex.

Disable DC 17 Survival (made as an individual hexploration activity) to locate and disarm all the traps by hand.

Clamp Shut ↻ **Trigger** Anyone Travels or Reconnoiters this hex; **Effect** If the characters are Traveling, one of them (determined randomly) steps in a trap. If the characters are Reconnoitering, 1d4 of them (determined randomly) step in a trap. When a creature steps in a trap, the trap makes a bear trap Strike against the creature.

Melee ❖ bear trap +14, **Damage** 2d10+7 piercing

Reset There are enough traps in this hex that this hazard can be triggered up to 5 times before all the traps are used up.

Treasure: Each time a PC triggers a trap, the trap is destroyed. If all the traps are disabled, materials to craft six spike snares can be salvaged.

GB2. DEAD TRAPPER

STANDARD

Breeg Orlivanch, the disreputable trapper responsible for the traps in area **GB1**, has set his final trap. At first glance, it appears Breeg overstepped his skill and was pinned to the ground by several large logs when his partially completed deadfall trap collapsed on him. In truth, the faerie dragon Perlivash (detailed in area **GB3**) had grown tired of Breeg's cruelty and caused the "accident" by prematurely triggering his trap.

A DC 14 Perception or Survival check while Searching the site reveals that the deadfall's ropes have been deliberately cut. A critical success reveals more—a tiny, sharp tooth snagged in one of the ropes. Anyone who succeeds at a DC 21 Arcana check identifies the tooth as that of a faerie dragon; it belongs to Perlivash and can be used as evidence of his guilt in the trapper's death.

Treasure: Breeg's hatchet, stuck in the stump of a tree a few feet from his dead body's outstretched arm, is a cold iron hatchet. Next to the stump is a waterskin with fresh water and a backpack containing 2 days of rations, a sleeping bag, a spool of cord, several strips of linen, and enough materials to craft three spike snares (obviously crafted by the same person who made those in area **GB1**). A second bundle holds three cured beaver pelts (worth 1 gp each), a skinning knife, and a set of leatherworker's tools.

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GB3. FAIRY NEST

MODERATE 2

HIDDEN

Creatures: The fey maintain a strong presence in the Stolen Lands, although they are less common in the northern reaches of the Greenbelt, where human bandits, trappers, hunters, and explorers regularly travel. Yet one creature, a grig named Tyg-Titter-Tut, has always lived in the northern Narlmarches, sharing her tree with her close friend, the faerie dragon Perlivash. The two little creatures have long enjoyed taunting, teasing, and occasionally frightening the human "bigginses" they encounter in the woods. Once in a great while their pranks turn vengeful (as detailed in area **GB2**) but never without proper cause. The two creatures' nests are high in a fir tree, although the PCs are likely to encounter the duo even if they don't succeed at the DC 18 Perception check to notice the two nests 40 feet up in the tree's branches.



TYG-TITTER-TUT

Perlivash is a small, butterfly-winged dragon with shining eyes and a quick wit. He is quite fond of flying in loops, sipping wine and mead (but not beer!), and perching on the heads or hats of friendly bigginses. Tyg-Titter-Tut is an excitable grig, a cat-sized fey with the upper body of a waifish humanoid and the lower body of a cricket. She enjoys music and can sit for hours listening even to poor performances, and always has something nice to say about the music when it ends.

Tyg-Titter-Tut and Perlivash are likely to first notice the PCs' approach from high in the leafy canopy where they are hard at work playing tag. At first, the odd pair mistakes the PCs for bandits. Being cautious, they spy upon the characters for a bit, following them about and closely observing their mannerisms and belongings. They take care never to approach closer than 30 feet and use stealth and magic to avoid being spotted. During their stalking, Tyg-Titter-Tut playfully challenges Perlivash to a small wager to see which of them can play the most pranks upon these bigginses without getting caught.

For the next few days, the two trail the PCs and take turns playing pranks at a rate of twice per day. Tyg-Titter-Tut prefers using *ghost sound* to make strange noises, while Perlivash delights in using *dancing lights* or *prestidigitation* to set up strange distractions. The longer the game continues, the more outlandish the pranks become as each one attempts to outdo the other. However, these good-hearted creatures also keep watch over the PCs even as they sport with them. Should an untimely encounter threaten the PCs, the pair aids the party as best they can, though they expose themselves to the PCs only if doing so is necessary to save a PC's life.

As the jokes continue, succeeding at a DC 16 Nature or Forest Lore check or a DC 14 Fey Lore check to Recall Knowledge allows a PC to infer that mischievous fey are likely behind the string of pranks. Individuals who wish to make contact with these unseen tricksters can attempt to stay alert and catch one in the act of pulling a prank (requiring a Search hexploration individual activity and success at a DC 20 Perception check to spot one of Perlivash's tricks or a DC 17 Perception check to spot one of Tyg-Titter-Tut's tricks).

A PC who critically succeeds at the Recall Knowledge check also recalls that fey can often be bribed into leaving someone alone—although it's worth keeping in mind that fey generally consider any offerings as gifts, eschewing the ugly word "bribe." Gifts of shiny bits of jewelry, alcohol, sugary food, and potions are particularly useful, but items that incorporate cold iron are generally hated. Each time a character leaves a gift worth at least 5 sp, allow them to attempt a DC 20 Diplomacy check to Make an Impression to appease the duo. If they succeed, the pair no longer targets that PC with pranks. If all the PCs in the party succeed at such checks, the grig and the faerie dragon reveal themselves to thank the group personally.

If the fey are befriended, they immediately cease their pranks and thank the PCs for being such fine sports. The pair holds no love for the bandits in the area, and eagerly ask the PCs if they're here to "kick

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out the mean bigginses." They know there's a camp of bandits at area **GB7** and can even provide a map (drawn in the dirt) of their campsite and an accurate list of the number of bandits and their descriptions. The two also know about the traps in area **GB1**, the radish patch located in area **GB4**, the hot springs in area **GB5**, and the location of the Temple of the Elk in area **GB6**. While they know about the dead trapper in area **GB2**, they don't tell the characters about this unless the characters ask if they were responsible, in which case they bashfully admit to killing the man but then eagerly point out how bad he was. They have no interest in accompanying the PCs on their adventures.

TYG-TITTER-TUT CREATURE 1

Female grig (*Pathfinder Bestiary* 308)
Initiative Perception +7

PERLIVASH CREATURE 2

Male faerie dragon (*Pathfinder Bestiary* 157)
Initiative Perception +16

Reward: If the PCs befriend Tyg-Titter-Tut and Perlivash and gain their aid in exploring the Greenbelt, award them experience as if they had defeated them in combat. In addition, as long as this friendship lasts, you can have the two periodically show up in the PCs' kingdom once they start to expand into the Stolen Lands. The pair might ask the PCs to leave the land around their home undeveloped, for example, or they could show up at an unexpected moment to provide aid in resolving an ongoing event at your discretion.



GB4. RADISH PATCH LOW 2

STANDARD

A large patch of delicious moon radishes grows in an arrowhead-shaped clearing here.

Creatures: Moon radishes are a delicacy among the kobolds of the region, and the first time the PCs travel to this area, they stumble upon four kobolds lying on their backs in the center of the patch, bellies full of the spicy roots and three overfilled baskets of radishes lying nearby. The kobolds are bloated from stuffing themselves and start the encounter sickened 1, but this won't keep them from shrieking and clambering to their feet as soon as they spot people approaching. Although normally cowardly, the kobolds fight to the death to defend "their" radish patch.

KOBOLD WARRIORS (4) CREATURE –1

Pathfinder Bestiary 212
Initiative Perception +3 (+2 while sickened 1)

GB5. FROG POND LOW 2

STANDARD

Two hot springs bubble at the source of the Skunk River, filling the surrounding area with the distinctive odor of rotten eggs. Despite the smell, the hot springs are rather pleasant to relax in. The springs overflow into the surrounding valley, forming a broad, swampy pond surrounding the source.

Creatures: A 150-foot diameter pond at the river's source is home to a pair of giant frogs; these creatures are aggressive and attack anyone who approaches their lair, but if a giant frog is reduced to fewer than 10 Hit Points, it croaks in fear and splashes back into the pond to hide.

GIANT FROGS (2) CREATURE 1

Pathfinder Bestiary 2 121
Initiative Perception +7

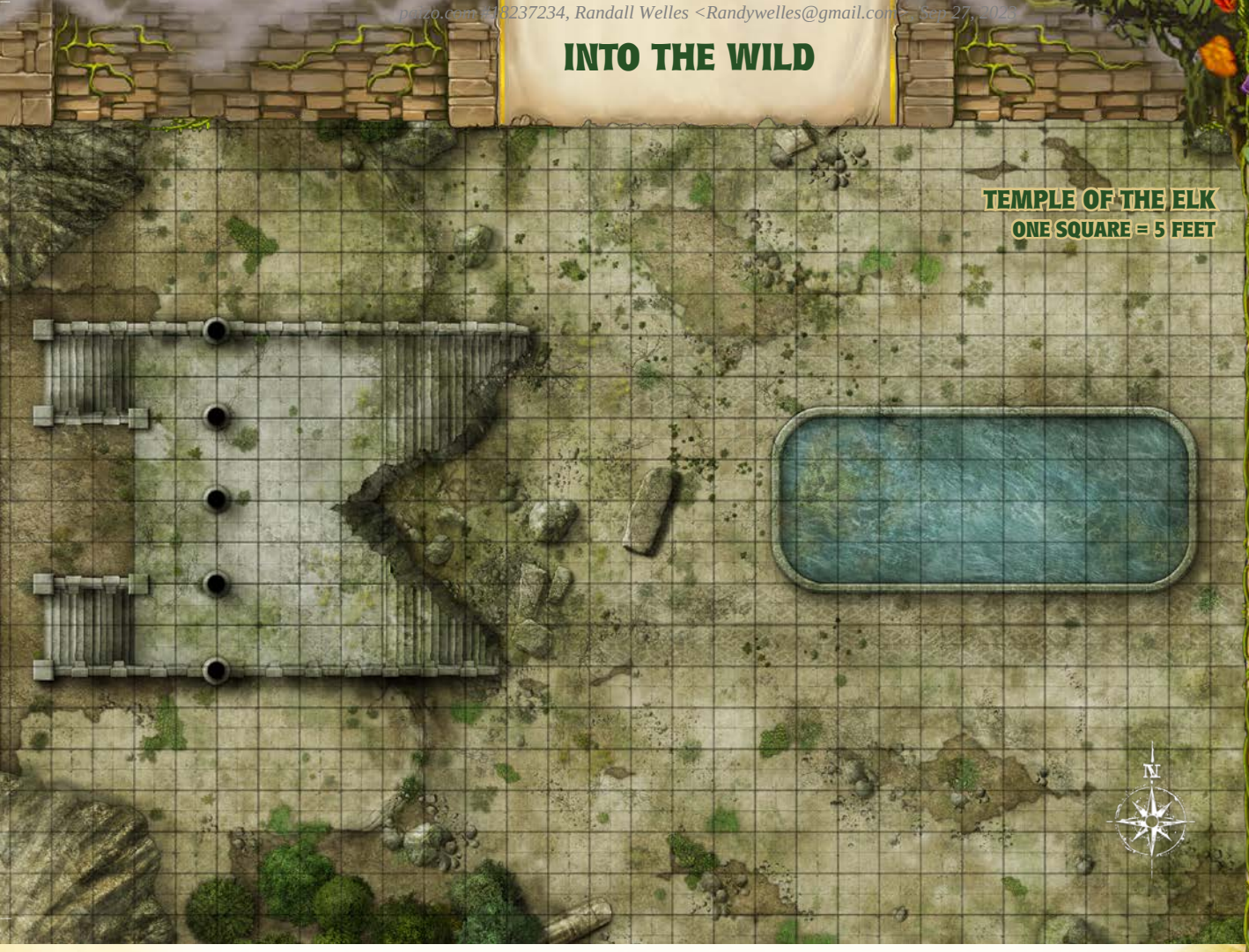
GB6. TEMPLE OF THE ELK MODERATE 2

HIDDEN RESOURCE

A thick tangle of brambles gives way to a large clearing in the woods, its border partially defined by ruined stone pillars. The western face of the clearing is dominated by a looming mass of rock, nearly 300 feet across and rising to a moss-topped height of 100 feet at the center. The side of the towering escarpment facing the clearing has been carved in the likeness of an immense elk, its antlers

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drooping down from its weathered face to frame a 50-foot-wide cave entrance. A flight of stone steps leads up to this entrance from the forest clearing—the steps and the elk face both seem quite old and are thickly encrusted with moss. A 50-foot-long oval pool in the middle of the clearing contains water thick with algae.

Like many ancient things in the forest, the Temple of the Elk lies forgotten. Travelers can easily bypass the overgrown temple, which is surrounded by numerous thorny plants. Anyone who succeeds at a DC 16 Perception check while exploring the hex discovers the location, or the fey at area **GB4** can tell the PCs how to reach this site.

Once a small but well-tended shrine to Erastil, the Temple of the Elk has stood abandoned since Taldor's last attempt to occupy this region ages ago. Unfortunately, the last keeper of the shrine became a little unstable after he finally admitted to himself that the trolls, kobolds, boggards, and other monsters had "won" and would drive the Taldan colonists out. Frustrated, the cleric lured an enormous grizzly bear to the temple and sacrificed it in the name of "any who would answer the call" to aid against his enemies. His lack of faith in Erastil proved his undoing, and as his fall from grace caused him to lose his abilities and perish. His cruel spirit possessed the bear's remains, resurrecting the creature in a mockery of what the cleric once represented.

The water in the pool is foul and stagnant. Succeeding at a DC 12 Religion check or DC 8 Erastil Lore check to Recall Knowledge allows a PC to recognize the entire site as a disused shrine dedicated to Erastil. On a critical success, the PC recalls rites that can be used to help restore the temple to functionality once the lingering malevolence is defeated.

Creature: Neither fully natural nor strictly an undead monstrosity, the cursed grizzly bear—who spent a brief moment dead at the ancient priest's hands—dwells here to this day. Driven by an urge to protect the shrine he despoiled, the priest's lingering influence has kept the bear alive far longer than it should have lived. While the former cleric's intellect has degraded to little more than that of the bear it now possesses, some shards of memory remain, and the sound of spoken words drives the bear into a frenzy as if a swarm of bees buzzed in its head. Eager to destroy the source of this torment, the cursed guardian rumbles out of the cave to issue a bellowing roar. The creature itself appears bear-shaped, yet its flesh and fur have partially transformed into thick tangles of diseased vegetation and dragging roots.

The cursed guardian is a dangerous foe and may well be one of the first significant threats low-level PCs face in this Adventure Path. As it bellows, you should

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KINGDOM ACTIVITIES

Some of the encounters in this Adventure Path include activities like "Restore the Temple of the Elk" that must be resolved during Kingdom turns, using Kingdom skills like Folklore. See Appendix 2 for further details.

give the PCs a chance to flee from the clearing before the beast presses its attack. It won't pursue foes out of the immediate area, but once a fight starts, the cursed guardian fights to the death to defend its lair, even if it doesn't understand or remember why it does so. If an obvious worshipper of Erastil is present, the bear focuses its wrath on that target, even though such worshippers have an advantage over it in combat.

CURSED GUARDIAN CREATURE 4

UNIQUE | CN | LARGE | BEAST

Perception +8; low-light vision, scent (imprecise) 30 feet
Languages Common, Sylvan (can't speak any language)
Skills Athletics +12, Survival +8
Str +6, **Dex** +3, **Con** +5, **Int** –3, **Wis** +0, **Cha** +3

AC 21; **Fort** +13, **Ref** +11, **Will** +6
HP 58; deadeye's shame

Deadeye's Shame The cursed guardian has weakness 5 to all damage inflicted upon it by a worshipper of Erastil, and it takes a –2 circumstance penalty to all saving throws to resist effects caused by worshippers of Erastil. If it ever suffers a critical hit from or critically fails a save against an effect caused by a worshipper of Erastil, the cursed guardian is stunned 1.

Speed 35 feet
Melee ❖ jaws +14, **Damage** 2d6+8 piercing
Melee ❖ claw +14 (agile), **Damage** 2d4+8 slashing plus Grab
Mauler The cursed guardian gains a +2 circumstance bonus to damage rolls against creatures it Grabs.
Rush ❖❖ The cursed guardian Strides and makes a Strike at the end of that movement. During the Stride, it gains a +10-foot circumstance bonus to its Speed.

Resources: Once the cursed guardian is slain, it sighs in relief, then collapses in on itself, transforming first into an incredibly old human man with a look of peace in his eyes before crumbling into a skeleton, and finally to a pile of dust. As this happens, the shrine grows more vibrant and colorful. Wildflowers bloom, the sound of birdsong fills the air, and the overall ambience of the place grows more welcoming. The water in the pool becomes crystal clear and, for the next 24 hours, grants the effects of a *moderate healing potion* to anyone who drinks directly from it. The restorative effects only affect an individual the first time they drink the water; subsequent attempts provide no magical benefits. If the water is removed from the area of the temple, it immediately loses its power.

At this point, the temple can be fully restored via the special Leadership activity detailed below.

RESTORE THE TEMPLE OF THE ELK

DOWNTIME | LEADERSHIP

You work with several worshippers of Erastil, gifted masons, and skilled laborers to restore the temple and once more consecrate it as a sacred place devoted to the worship of Erastil. Spend 1d6 RP, then attempt a DC 25 Folklore check.

Critical Success The temple is restored and can now serve as a Refuge terrain feature. If you later build a settlement here, the temple instead functions as a free Shrine in the settlement. In addition, your work was so excellent that you've attracted Erastil's attention! The PC who rolled the Folklore check is granted Erastil's minor boon: whenever that PC critically fails a check to Subsist in the wild, they gain a failure instead.

Success As success, but without Erastil's boon.

Failure Work proceeds but is not yet complete; you can attempt to restore the temple again on the next Kingdom turn.

Critical Failure Disaster strikes as the temple's cavern collapses and rubble spills out to bury and destroy much of the temple's plaza. Gain 1 Decay and 1d4 Unrest. You can still attempt to Restore the Temple, but the DC for success increases by 4. This increase is cumulative with successive critical failures.

GB7. THORN RIVER BANDIT CAMP

STANDARD

This area is detailed in Part 2 of Chapter 3 (page 168).

GB8. GOLD MINE

HIDDEN | RESOURCE

A rocky crag juts from the hills here. At the crag's base is a 5-foot-wide crack that can be spotted while Reconnoitering with a successful DC 16 Perception or Hills Lore check. The crack opens into a 20-foot-deep crevice that widens into a 30-foot-diameter cave. The cave wall directly opposite the entrance sparkles slightly. A successful DC 16 Nature or Mining Lore check to Recall Knowledge allows a PC to recognize this as a vein of gold ore.

Resources: This hex doubles the output of a Mine established here with the Establish Work Site activity.

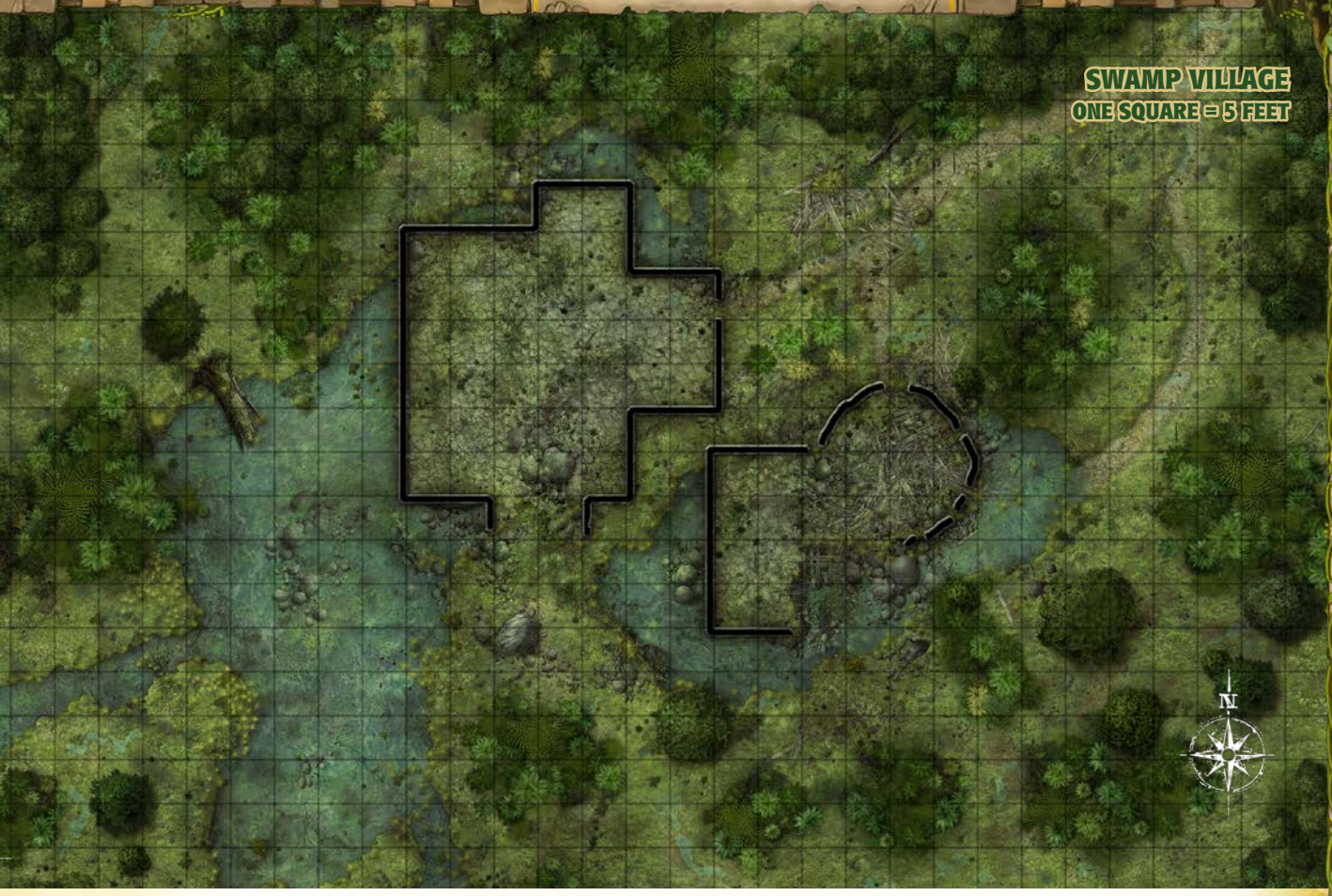
GB9. FORGOTTEN CACHE

HIDDEN

An old, lightning-struck oak tree stands atop a low hill at this spot—it's the only tree in a 2-mile radius. From the north, the tree looks eerily like a claw reaching for the clouds. Succeeding at a DC 20 Survival check to Track

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reveals to a PC that the ground beneath a hollow in the tree's roots on the north side has been disturbed. Several months ago, one of the Stag Lord's bandits robbed a rich traveling wizard and decided to hide some of the loot here to avoid giving the Stag Lord his cut. The Stag Lord found out that the bandit had withheld treasure and executed him as a warning to his fellows, but not before the bandit sketched a picture of the tree and told his lover about the stash. Unfortunately, his lover met an entirely different (but no less final) fate on his attempt to track down the cache (more details in area **RL3**).

Treasure: Digging up the forgotten cache takes 10 minutes once the PCs find the right location. The loot is wrapped in a heavy leather cloak and consists of a *+1 dagger*, a *wand of burning hands*, a silver ring worth 10 gp, and a spellbook. Unfortunately, rain seeping down into the cache has damaged much of the spellbook, but five of the spells (*dispel magic*, *illusory object*, *mage armor*, *shrink*, and *unseen servant*) remain legible. Feel free to add a few more spells to this list if you wish or to swap out spells to avoid duplicating spells that PCs might already know.

GB10. SHRIKE CASCADE

LANDMARK

Unlike Crooked Falls (area **RL4**), the Shrike Cascade is a single waterfall. The river plummets 50 feet over a cliff, making it impossible to navigate by boat, although the vista of the waterfall itself is quite breathtaking. A successful DC 20 Athletics check is required for a PC to Climb the slippery cliff side along the waterfall's edge.

GB11. BOGGARD LAIR MODERATE 2

STANDARD RESOURCE

The ground slumps into a soggy mire, and a pair of ruined stone buildings jut from the ground. This location is presented on the Swamp Village map above.

Creatures: These buildings have been claimed by a lone boggard named Garuum and his monstrous, froglike pet, a slurk called Ubagub. Garuum was once a member of the boggard settlement M'botuu to the west (area **HT6**) until he made a terrible mistake of believing he should be the one to rule the knot (another name for a boggard village). In order to prepare for his coup, he gathered and devoured several dozen of the knot's sacred blue dragonflies, hoping to gain great power and skill from the insects. Alas, while the feast bolstered his self-confidence, it did nothing for his battle skills. He rode his slurk Ubagub into the center of M'botuu to declare war, whereupon he was immediately captured. M'botuu's ruler, Sepoko, sentenced Garuum and his slurk to death after a day of humiliating punishment.

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Fortunately, Garuum's his captors forgot about him after getting drunk on bog whiskey. Later, he used a rock to smash his manacles and escape. He freed his slurk and fled eastward into the Narlmarches. Following his escape, the priest-king branded Garuum an exile and demanded that he be slain on sight should he ever return.

Garuum knows his previous life is over and has made do as best he can. He moved into this ruined village and thinks of the two ruined buildings within as his empire. Garuum sleeps in a nest made of swamp reeds, soggy planks, and mud in the ruins of the smaller building's tower. Neither he nor Ubagub react kindly to intruders, each croaking loudly to alert the other. Yet Garuum has learned from his past mistakes—now he moderates his violent impulses. He even knows several words of Common.

As soon as he sees the PCs (and assuming they don't immediately attack him or Ubagub), Garuum holds up his hands and croaks out, "Truce! Truce!" Garuum just wants to be left alone, but his limited knowledge of Common (the only words he knows are *boggard*, *bug*, *slurk*, *snake*, *truce*, *hungry*, *me*, *you*, *die*, and *go*) might make communication difficult. Garuum is quick to interpret attempts to search his "kingdom" or simply to walk through it as offensive acts, and attacks.

If the PCs establish a line of communication with the boggard, he tells them his story and that he doesn't want to cause problems; if the PCs leave him be, he'll reciprocate. In fact, he's willing to tell the characters what he knows of the nearby woods in return for them leaving him alone. He can tell them about the statue of Erastil in area **NM2**, the location of the Temple of the Elk at area **GB6**, where Tuskgutter lives at area **GB12**, and of the tatzlwyrms living at area **GB16**. At your discretion, if the characters treat Garuum particularly well, he might offer to let them rest in his domain (an uncomfortable but safe place to sleep) or even accompany them on their adventures.



GARUUM

GARUUM CREATURE 2

CN male boggard warrior (*Pathfinder Bestiary* 44)
Initiative Perception +8

UBAGUB CREATURE 2

Male slurk (*Pathfinder Bestiary* 301)
Initiative Perception +6

Treasure: Garuum has gathered a small hoard of treasure. It consists of 21 gp, a chunk of iolite worth 5 gp, a deep green spinel worth 9 gp, and a shard of blue quartz worth 11 gp.

Resource: If the PCs defeat or befriend Garuum, this hex functions as a Refuge if it is Claimed. If a Settlement is built here, the buildings can be rebuilt into Houses.

Award: If the PCs befriend Garuum, award them experience as if they had defeated him and his slurk in combat.

GARUUM'S REVENGE

30 XP

If the PCs befriend Garuum and he still lives once they reach 10th level, the boggard finally approaches them with a request. Since he was exiled from M'botuu, his festering anger has finally reached a boiling point. He claims to have found a magic rock and promises to give it to whoever can travel to M'botuu, kill its priest-king Sepoko, and return to Garuum with Sepoko's head so he can feed it to Ubagub.

Source: Garuum

Completion: Kill Sepoko and bring his head back to Garuum.

Reward: Garuum's "magic rock" is in fact a *greater invisibility armor runestone*.

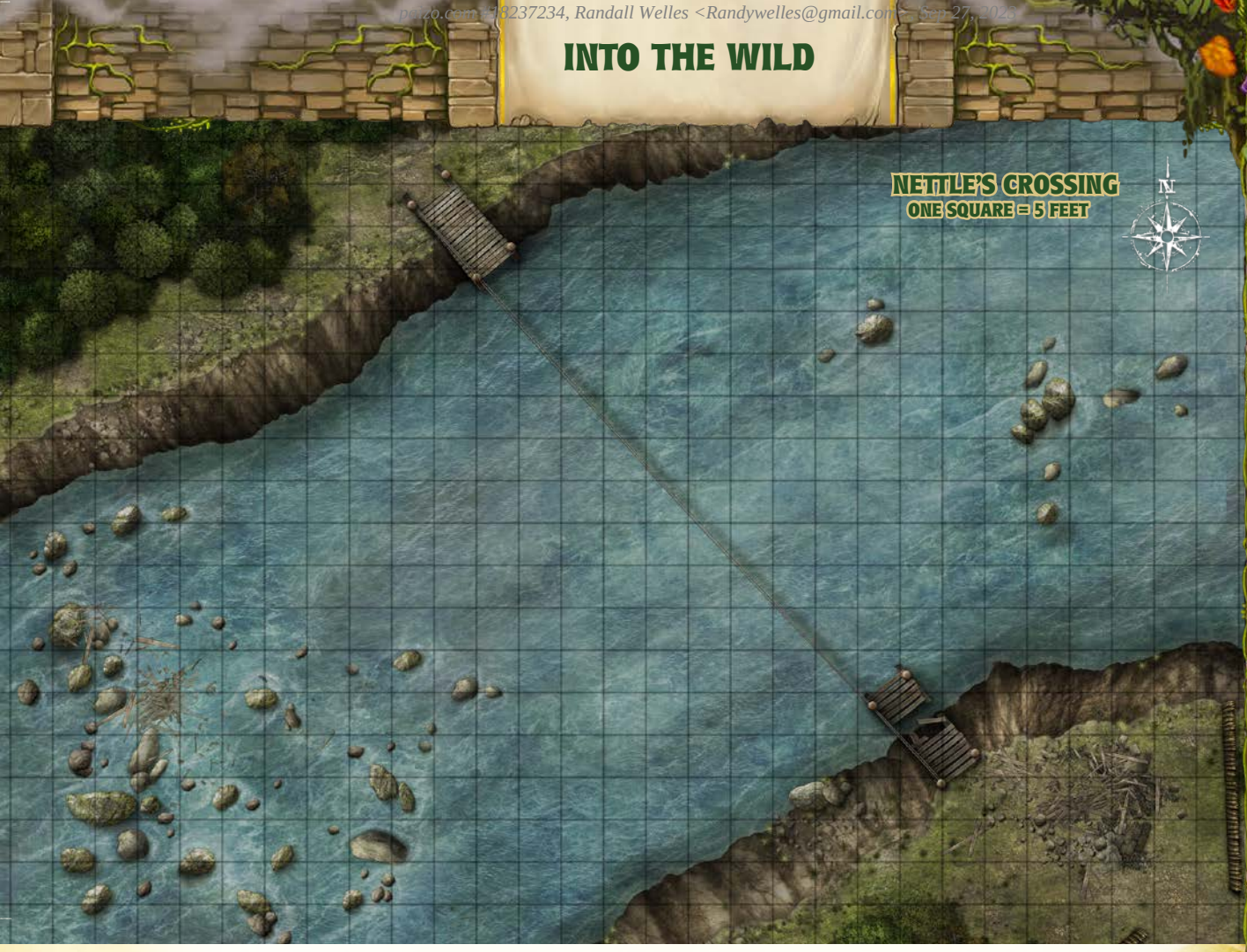
GB12. TUSKGUTTER'S LAIR LOW 2

STANDARD

Creature: Boars are among the more aggressive wild animals native to the Greenbelt, but none are as notorious as Tuskgutter, a grizzled monster who's

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vexed and avoided hunters for years. Most hunters in the Greenbelt have heard wild tales of this ill-tempered beast, identifiable by the distinctive gray bristles on his face. Tuskgutter's lair is a hollow beneath a large fallen pine tree, and the tree's branches create a natural shelter currently littered with bones.

Tuskgutter spends part of each day out foraging and hunting. When PCs reach this hex, roll a DC 6 flat check—on a success, the boar is home. If it's not at home, a PC who succeeds at a DC 16 Nature or DC 14 Hunting Lore check to Recall Knowledge realizes the den as belongs to a particularly large boar. Tuskgutter returns in 1d6 hours.

TUSKGUTTER CREATURE 3

Elite boar (*Pathfinder Bestiary* 6, 43)
Initiative Perception +10

GB13. RICKETY BRIDGE TRIVIAL 2

LANDMARK

Hazard: The Thorn River winds through a 20-foot-deep gulch here, nestled between a pair of rocky hills. An old wooden bridge spans the gulch, allowing passage over the river—provided not too many creatures attempt to cross it at once.

The bridge can support one Medium creature or two Small creatures at a time, but groans and creaks ominously as it does so. The local bandits know to cross the bridge one at a time. A successful DC 15 Athletics check to Climb allows a PC to scale the sides of the gulch, while the river itself can be navigated by a PC who succeeds at a DC 15 Athletics check to Swim.

RICKETY BRIDGE HAZARD 4

ENVIRONMENTAL

Stealth DC 22
Description The bridge creaks and strains alarmingly.
Disable Crafting DC 25 to Repair the bridge as an individual hexploration activity.
Collapse ↷ **Trigger** Two or more Medium creatures or a Large or larger creature crosses the bridge; **Effect** The bridge collapses. The triggering creature(s) fall into the river below, taking no damage from the fall itself due to the deep water, but taking 2d8+5 bludgeoning damage (DC 21 basic Reflex save) from falling debris. For 1 round after the collapse, the waters below the bridge churn violently, requiring a DC 20 Athletics check to Swim.

GB14. OLD SYCAMORE

LANDMARK

This sycamore tree is a den of mitflit gremlins, and is detailed further in Part 3 of this chapter (page 120).

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GB15. NETTLES' CROSSING MODERATE 2

LANDMARK

Not so long ago, a retired Brevic engineer named Davik Nettles ran a simple but profitable toll bridge across a narrow reach of the Shrike River. He made no judgments on those who chose to use his bridge. Be they bandit or trapper, as long as they had the coin, he allowed them to cross the Shrike. As this crossing was the only significant one in the region, Davik made a fair amount of money for his hard work.

Unfortunately, after he finally made enough to recoup the cost of building the rope bridge, the Stag Lord rose to power downriver on the north shore of the Tuskwater. When the Stag Lord paid a visit to the crossing, he informed Davik that not only were the men bearing the Stag Lord's badge to be granted free passage over the bridge, but that Davik would now have to pay the Stag Lord two-thirds of his monthly take in return for "protection." In his response to the Stag Lord's demands, Davik made a foolish error. He not only refused the offer, but ran the bandit and his men off with his trusty ranseur and the aid of his three slavering hounds. After the incident, Davik rewarded himself with a meal of fresh fish and went to bed early. Not surprisingly, the Stag Lord did not stay away for long.



DAVIK NETTLES

In the dead of night, the bandits returned. They surrounded Davik's house and set it on fire with flaming arrows. Davik woke in terror to his dogs' barking, and as he stumbled out of his burning home, ranseur in hand, the bandits attacked. His polearm provided little help as the archers' flaming arrows rained down, killing his hounds and wounding Davik. With his nightshirt aflame, the doomed bridge keeper tumbled down the path toward the river. After dousing himself with water, he clambered up to the bridge and tried to escape to the north shore.

The bandits followed, and as Davik passed the midpoint on his bridge, the Stag Lord and his men cut several ropes. The bridge collapsed, plunging the shrieking Davik into the river below. Though he struggled mightily to swim ashore, the current was too much and he drowned. Onshore, the bandits watched, gleefully chuckling, their leering shadows dancing before the hovel's flames as it burned down to cinders. The Stag Lord returned to his fort, leaving behind several bandits to rebuild the bridge and take up the position of toll taker.

The next night, as the bandits argued over who would get to be the bridge's new "boss," Davik rose from the river as an undead thing of vengeance. He stalked out of the water, weapon in hand, and murdered the brigands before dragging their bodies into the river. The Stag Lord sent more bandits to investigate several days later, and though Davik rose again to kill most of them, three escaped to report back to their leader. The Stag Lord wisely decided to abandon his plans to rebuild the bridge, and in the months since, has all but forgotten about Davik and his tolls.

Today, Nettles' Crossing is a soggy, abandoned remnant. One thick and sagging rope still hangs across the river, all that remains of the bridge that once spanned it. A signpost at either end of the ruined bridge reads "Nettles' Crossing—5 coppers—ring bell for service." A rusty bell hangs by each sign. On the south bank of the river, encroaching vegetation has slowly devoured the crumbled remains of a burned-down wooden building.

Crossing the river via the hanging rope is possible with a successful DC 15 Athletics check to Climb, but the rope

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snaps if more than two Medium creatures (two Small creatures count as one Medium creature) attempt to cross at the same time. Anyone who falls into the river is carried downstream, eventually snagged on the rubble of old bridge remnants; otherwise, it's a DC 15 Athletics check to Swim in the river.

Creature: If anyone rings one of the bells on either shore or attempts to cross the river, Davik's haunted remains take note. Now a unique undead menace, Davik's rotting body climbs from the rubble downstream and makes its inexorable way across the river's surface, walking over the water toward the PCs. The sight of the obviously long-dead man, flesh putrescent and dripping, ranseur clutched in his hands, may well drive the PCs to attack. Yet as Davik rises from the waters, he calls out to them in an eerie, soggy voice, "You are not my tormentors. Bring me the Stag Lord's body. Throw him into the river, that I may look upon his face in death. Or join me instead."

If the PCs attack Davik, he fights back with a furious rage. If destroyed, he rejuvenates the next night. While he cannot travel more than a mile from the site of his death (except to claim the Stag Lord's remains from the Shrike River), he can use *nightmare* to plague one of the PCs.

DAVIK NETTLES CREATURE 4

UNIQUE | NE | MEDIUM | UNDEAD

Perception +10, darkvision
Languages Common
Skills Athletics +11, Intimidation +11
Str +5, **Dex** +3, **Con** +2, **Int** +0, **Wis** +2, **Cha** +3
Items *+1 ranseur*

AC 19; **Fort** +12, **Ref** +11, **Will** +10
HP 70; **Resistances** fire 7

Fearsome Gaze (concentrate, divine, emotion, fear, mental, visual) 30 feet. When a creature ends its turn in the aura, it must attempt a DC 18 Will save.
- **Critical Success** The creature is unaffected and is temporarily immune for 24 hours.
- **Success** The creature is unaffected.
- **Failure** The creature becomes frightened 1.
- **Critical Failure** The creature becomes frightened 2.

Rejuvenation (divine, necromancy) If Davik is reduced to 0 Hit Points, his bones and gear melt into water that runs back into the river or seeps into the ground, leaving nothing behind. The next night, he rises again from his original location in the rubble located downstream from the ruined ferry crossing. When he does, he is completely healed of all damage, but now his unholy anger is directed at those who previously destroyed him as well as at the Stag Lord. He can use *nightmare* to threaten the one who destroyed him, promising to drag them to a drowning death unless the Stag Lord's remains are given to the river. *Dispel magic* (DC 19 counteract check) can remove this sinister link between Davik and his destroyer, preventing Davik from using *nightmare* on that creature again until they return to this location. As long as the PCs don't abandon their goal of hunting the Stag Lord, Davik remains content and does not plague their dreams.

Rotting Stench (aura, olfactory) 10 feet. A creature entering the aura or starting their turn in the aura must succeed at a DC 18 Fortitude save or become sickened 1 (plus slowed 1 on a critical failure for as long as it's sickened). While within the aura, creatures also take a –2 circumstance penalty to saves against fear and to recover from the sickened condition. A creature that succeeds at its save is temporarily immune for 1 minute and does not take the penalty to saves against fear effects.

Speed 25 feet, swim 25 feet

Melee ❖ *ranseur* +14 (disarm, reach), **Damage** 1d10+7 piercing

Melee ❖ fist +13 (agile), **Damage** 2d4+7 bludgeoning

Divine Innate Spells DC 21; **4th** *nightmare*; **Constant (2nd)** *water walk* (self only)

Focus Gaze ❖ (concentrate, divine, emotion, fear, mental, visual) Davik fixes his glare at a creature he can see within 30 feet. The target must immediately attempt a Will save against Davik's Fearsome Gaze. On a failed save, if the target is already frightened, the value of its frightened condition is increased by 1 (or by 2 on a critical failure). After attempting its save, the creature is then temporarily immune until the start of Davik's next turn.

Sure Possession As long as Davik Nettles continues to exist, his *+1 ranseur* cannot be taken from him. If disarmed of the *+1 ranseur*, if he drops it, or if it's destroyed, the ranseur melts into water; he can retrieve his *+1 ranseur* by pulling it out of any body of water as an Interact action. If Davik is put to rest permanently by fulfilling his quest, his *+1 ranseur* loses this ability and can be claimed by someone else.

DAVIK'S REVENGE

30 XP

Davik Nettles craves proof that the Stag Lord no longer walks the earth.

Source: Davik Nettles (area **GB15**)

Completion: Only when the Stag Lord's remains are thrown into the waters of the Shrike can Davik find peace. The remains can be thrown in anywhere along the Shrike River, not just at Nettles' Crossing; wherever it occurs, Davik appears and lurches up from the river to grab the Stag Lord's remains and pull them down into the water forever. Once this scene plays out, Davik is never seen again.

Reward: As soon as the Stag Lord's remains are given over to the river, Davik's *+1 ranseur* washes up on shore at the PCs' feet, a final gift from the grateful undead.

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Reward: If the PCs bring the Stag Lord's remains to Davik Nettles, grant them XP as if they had defeated Davik in combat.

GB16. TATZLWYRM DEN — MODERATE 2

STANDARD

Islets create a ford across this section of the Skunk River, two of them connected by rubble and log jams. The islands make for a natural choke point, but also serve as a nest for a pair of mated tatzlwyrms.

Creatures: One of the tatzlwyrms spends most of its time coiled leisurely upon the central island, sunning itself, while the other generally remains hidden in the rubble, sleeping or digesting a meal. The first time the PCs explore this hex, roll a DC 11 flat check. On a failure, one of the tatzlwyrms is out hunting—otherwise, the PCs face both creatures and anger them into battle by their mere presence in their territory.

TATZLWYRMS (2) — CREATURE 2

Pathfinder Bestiary 2 256

Initiative Perception +8

Treasure: The skeletal remains of a long-dead explorer makes up the tatzlwyrms' meager horde. A successful DC 12 Perception check is all a character needs to spot the skeleton wedged in the debris of the tatzlwyrm's nest. The skeleton wears a suit of ruined scale mail and clutches a *+1 cold iron longsword* in one bony hand. On a critical success on the Perception check, or if a PC specifically digs through the mud and rubble under the skeleton, additional treasure is revealed in the form of a rotting leather backpack that contains 12 gp, 62 sp, a pewter drinking stein worth 2 gp, a silver ring worth 7 gp, a jade carving of a female elf worth 11 gp, and a watertight scroll tube that contains a map.

The explorer had been working to create a map of the northwest corner of the Greenbelt, so the PCs can use it to help with Map the Area individual hexploration activities of any hex in Rostland or the Greenbelt; doing so grants a +2 item bonus to Survival checks made to Map the Area.

GB17. TRAPPED THYLACINE — TRIVIAL 2

STANDARD

Creature: A series of quick, yipping barks comes from an open pit in a clearing here. The pit, once covered by a layer of branches, has claimed a brush thylacine, and the hungry creature paces the confines of the 10-foot-square, 20-foot-deep pit in a frenzy.

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BRUSH THYLACINE CREATURE 2

See page 609

Initiative Perception +8

Hazard: Anyone who comes within 5 feet of the pit's edge causes the side to slip away. The sides of the pit can be Climbed with a DC 15 Athletics check, but exiting the pit in this way triggers the pit's reaction.

UNSTABLE PIT HAZARD 0

ENVIRONMENTAL

Stealth DC 12

Description This open pit was once covered with branches—it's now visible, but its unstable edges are not obvious.

Crumbling Edge ↻ **Trigger** A creature comes within 5 feet of the pit's edge; **Effect** The edge of the pit crumbles. The triggering creature must attempt a DC 19 Reflex save.

Critical Success The triggering creature steps back from the edge before it collapses.

Success The triggering creature falls prone.

Failure The triggering creature falls prone and slides into the pit, taking 1d6 bludgeoning damage.

Critical Failure As failure, but 2d6 bludgeoning damage.

GB18. FANGBERRY THICKET MODERATE 2

STANDARD

A patch of raspberry-like fruits known as fangberries grows in a valley between two low hills here. Much of the thorny thicket is draped in the white gossamer silk of spiderwebs. The best of the berries lie at the heart of the thicket, but harvesting must be done slowly to avoid being lacerated by the thousands of fangberry thorns. To gather a basket of fangberries—enough for a meal, or to satisfy Bokken's need for them (completing the quest on page 55), a PC must perform the Gather Fangberries activity after the thicket's denizens have been dealt with. The thicket itself is difficult terrain. A creature who moves through the thicket in a reckless manner (by making a Strike or taking more than one Stride during their turn) takes 1 piercing damage from the thicket's thorns at the end of their turn.

GATHER FANGBERRIES

EXPLORATION MANIPULATE MOVE

Attempting to gather enough fangberries for a meal or for Bokken requires 10 minutes of work and a successful DC 18 Survival check. Creatures wearing medium armor gain a +2 item bonus on this check, while those in heavy armor treat their results as one degree of success higher than the actual result. Anyone with the Woodland Stride ability or a similar effect automatically earns a critical success.

Critical Success The character gathers a full basket of ripe berries and takes no damage.

Success The character gathers a basket of ripe berries but takes 1d6 piercing damage from the thorns.

Failure The character gathers half a basket of berries but takes 1d6 piercing damage and 1d6 persistent bleed damage from the thorns.

Critical Failure As failure, but the character fails to gather any berries and becomes clumsy 1 from the pain. This clumsy condition lasts until the character receives any healing.

Creatures: The webs that infest the thicket were spun by swarms of chew spiders—a species of aggressive arachnids the size of a human's thumb with particularly large, serrated fangs. Two swarms dwell in the thicket, and they attack intruders as soon as anyone starts to gather fangberries, rolling Stealth for initiative.

CHEW SPIDERS (2) CREATURE 2

UNIQUE N LARGE ANIMAL SWARM

Variant spider swarm (*Pathfinder Bestiary* 306)

Perception +6; darkvision, web sense

Skills Acrobatics +8, Athletics +2, Stealth +8

Str –2, **Dex** +4, **Con** +0, **Int** –5, **Wis** +0, **Cha** –4

Web Sense The chew spiders have imprecise tremorsense to detect the vibrations of creatures touching their web (which stretches through the entire fangberry thicket).

AC 18; **Fort** +6, **Ref** +10, **Will** +4

HP 22; **Immunities** precision, swarm mind; **Weaknesses** area damage 5, splash damage 5; **Resistances** bludgeoning 2, piercing 5, slashing 5

Speed 20 feet, climb 20 feet

Chewing Bites ❖ Each enemy in the chew spiders' space takes 1d6 persistent bleed damage (DC 16 basic Reflex save). A creature that fails its save is exposed to chew spider venom.

Chew Spider Venom (poison); **Saving Throw** Fortitude DC 18; **Maximum Duration** 6 rounds; **Stage 1** 1d6 poison damage and clumsy 1 (1 round); **Stage 2** 1d6 poison damage and clumsy 2 (1 round).

GB19. RIVER CROSSING

STANDARD

The Thorn River grows unusually shallow here. The resulting ford is never deeper than 3 feet.

GB20. SOOTSCALE CAVERNS

HIDDEN

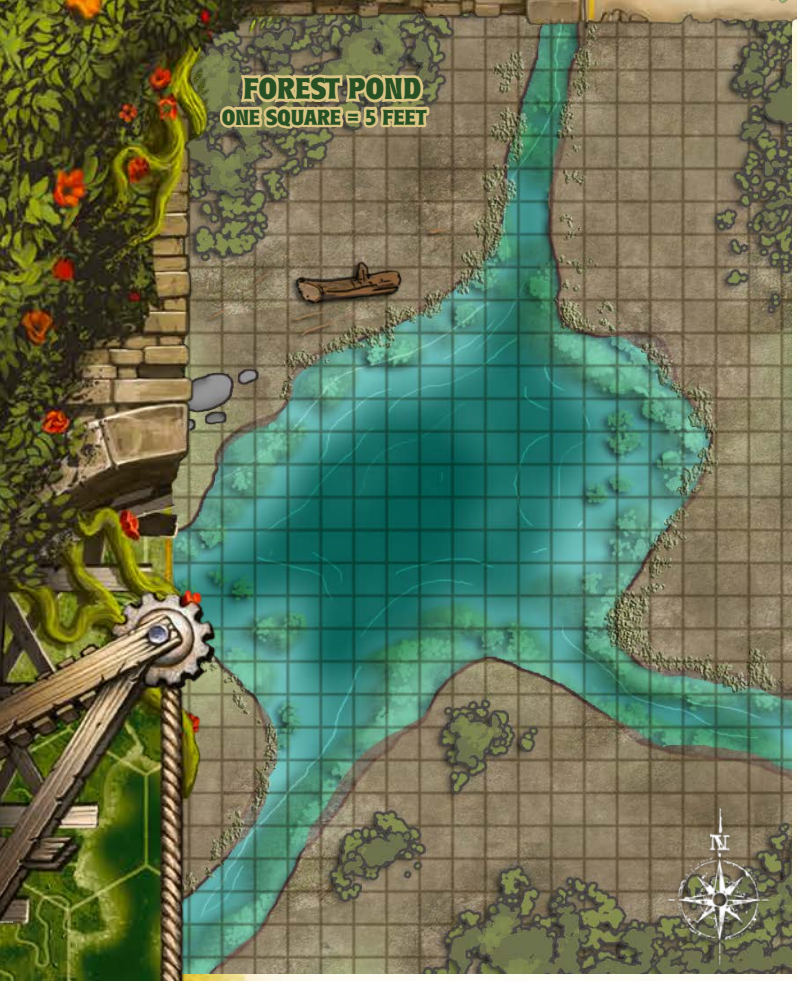
The entrance to these caverns is well hidden. This location is detailed in Part 4 of this chapter (page 126).

ZONE 3: TUSKWATER

The Tuskwater is one of the largest lakes in the Stolen Lands. The Stag Lord's fort sits atop a hill on the lake's hill-crested northeastern shore, and while his bandits are more active in this area, wildlife remains a dangerous concern.

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TUSKWATER (TW) ZONE 3

d20	Encounter	Challenge
1–5	Roll on zone 2 table (page 58)	Varies
6–8	2 brush thylacines (page 609)	Low 3
9–11	1 owlbear[B1]	Low 3
12–13	6 Stag Lord bandits (page 177)	Moderate 3
14–15	3 ruffians[GMG]	Moderate 3
16–17	3 wargs[B1]	Moderate 3
18–19	1 troll[B1]	Moderate 3
20	1 shambler[B1]	Severe 3

Ruffians These bandits are not affiliated with the Stag Lord; they know where his fort is, but they prefer not to associate with him out of fear. A ruffian whose life is spared can guide the PCs to the fort, or if made helpful, even help the party fight the Stag Lord and his crew.

Stag Lord Bandits Stag Lord bandits encountered out in the wilds haven't yet earned the right to stay in the Stag Lord's fort, but they do know where the fort is located.

WANTED: SHAMBLESAP

30 XP

Once the PCs reach 3rd level, they'll start seeing wanted posters for "shamblesap"—a sticky fluid harvested from shambling mounds.

Source: Wanted poster

Completion: Harvest a usable amount of shamblesap from a dead shambling mound with a successful DC 23 Nature check, then deliver the fluid.

Reward: A consortium of alchemists pays a bounty of 65 gp and four minor elixirs of life for the first delivery of shamblesap, after which they'll have enough fluid for their experiments for many years to come.

TW1. A DELICATE SITUATION SEVERE 3

STANDARD

This encounter doesn't take place until the PCs have driven off the Stag Lord—if they explore this hex before then, they could encounter the nixie Melianse, but it's more likely that she remains in hiding and simply watches the PCs pass by. After defeating the Stag Lord, if the PCs had already explored this hex, you should consider having them hear rumors about the freelance loggers having problems here shortly after establishing their kingdom in Chapter 5 to lure them back to this hex to deal with the situation.

Use the Forest Pond map to run this encounter.

The river makes a sharp bend here, widening into a deep pool dotted with lily pads and fringed by waving reeds. Three freshly felled trees lie beside their stumps on the shore of the pool, their crowns dangling in the water among fading tendrils of mist.

Creatures: A band of freelance loggers under the leadership of a man named Corax recently decided to harvest a grove of coachwood trees in this glade, unaware the nixie sorcerer dwelling in a nearby pool. The nixie, Melianse, did not take kindly to the loggers despoiling her home and unsuccessfully attempted to scare them off with ample use of *ghost sound* and *obscuring mist*. When that tactic failed, Melianse took the time to *inveigle* one of the lumberjacks, and then another, and both now stand guard in front of her pool. Since both are good workers, Corax has resisted the urge to fight his own employees, but he is fast losing patience with the nixie and fears the blow to his reputation in his workers' eyes if he dithers much longer. The two groups are now in a standoff, with neither willing to make the next move.

When the PCs arrive on the scene, Corax and six of his eight loggers stand angrily near the felled trees, about 30 feet from the pool. The other two lumberjacks stand at the water's edge, facing Corax. Melianse floats in the center of the pool with only her head above water; she remains about 20 feet from the shore, out of the loggers' reach, and silently observes their response.

As soon as Corax notices the PCs, he sees them as potential allies. He quickly hails them and explains the situation in a gruff voice liberally laced with

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profanity, claiming that the nixie attacked his workers unprovoked and complaining bitterly about how hard it is for "a decent man to make a living with all these damnable fairies in the woods." Melianse responds calmly to this accusation, claiming that she politely asked the loggers to leave at first but was forced to enchant two of them after Corax threatened to hang her from the nearest tree "to drip dry." She adds that the trees felled by the loggers had been growing next to the pool for more than 200 years and deserved a far better fate than serving as "some grubby peasant's slop table." Both Corax and Melianse appeal to the PCs for help. The conversation soon devolves into more accusations and shouted insults.

Unless action is taken by the PCs to defuse the situation, Corax eventually loses patience and orders his six unaffected lumberjacks to subdue their entranced colleagues and attack the nixie. Melianse responds by ordering the inveigled loggers to defend her pool while she targets Corax with her spells. If the PCs ally with Corax, Melianse focuses her magic on them. If the PCs ally with Melianse, Corax orders three loggers to focus on Melianse while he and the other three fight the PCs. Corax surrenders if reduced to 10 or fewer Hit Points, vowing to practice his trade "someplace where the damned fairies don't run the show!" Melianse fights to the death to defend her home.

If the PCs want to defuse the situation, they must negotiate an accord between the two parties. First, Corax and Melianse, both of whom are quite angry, must be calmed down and convinced to talk. Diplomacy or Intimidation checks might work (both Corax and Melianse are unfriendly to the PCs at the start of the encounter), or spells such as *charm* or *calm emotions* can be used (although if they fail, both sides might be spurred to attack the PCs). Once the two agree to negotiate, both must be satisfied with the result. Corax wants his lumber and demands that Melianse release his two workers from her influence. Melianse wants the loggers to leave her glade and provide reparation for the trees they've already felled.

Obviously, there is no single correct answer to appease everyone; reward players who come up with creative solutions as long as both groups get something out of the negotiations. (One possible solution is to provide the loggers with another source of lumber; a PC who succeeds at a DC 18 Nature or Forest Lore check recalls an untouched grove of coachwood trees 10 miles to the north, near the old tatzlwyrm den, that the lumberjacks can freely harvest if shown the way to the grove.) For her part, Melianse releases the two entranced loggers if the group leaves and replaces the three trees they've cut down (as detailed in the quest Melianse's Trees).

CORAX CREATURE 3

UNIQUE | CN | MEDIUM | HUMANOID | HUMAN

Male human logger

Perception +8

Languages Common

Skills Acrobatics +8, Athletics +9, Lumber Lore +9, Nature +7, Survival +8

Str +4, **Dex** +1, **Con** +3, **Int** +0, **Wis** +1, **Cha** +1

Items lesser alchemist's fire (2), composite shortbow (20 arrows), cold iron greataxe, *lesser healing potion*, studded leather armor

AC 16; **Fort** +10, **Ref** +8, **Will** +8

HP 55

Speed 25 feet

Melee ❖ greataxe +11 (sweep), **Damage** 1d12+6 slashing

Ranged ❖ composite shortbow +8 (deadly d10, propulsive, range 60 feet, reload 0), **Damage** 1d6+3 slashing

Felling Blow ❖❖ Corax lunges toward a foe and makes a Strike with his greataxe, increasing his reach by 5 feet for that Strike. If he hits, the target must succeed at a DC 19 Fortitude save to avoid being knocked prone (and stunned 1 on a critical failure).

LOGGERS (8) CREATURE 0

N | MEDIUM | HUMANOID | HUMAN

Perception +6

Languages Common

Skills Acrobatics +5, Athletics +7, Lumber Lore +6, Nature +4, Survival +6

Str +3, **Dex** +1, **Con** +2, **Int** +0, **Wis** +2, **Cha** +0

Items battle axe, climbing kit, hatchet, padded armor

AC 13; **Fort** +8, **Ref** +5, **Will** +6

HP 20

Tandem Chop ↷ **Trigger** A creature or object within their reach is hit with a Strike by an ally using a weapon in the axe group; **Requirements** The logger is holding a weapon in the axe group; **Effect** The logger attempts a Strike against the same creature or object. If it hits, combine the damage with the damage from the triggering Strike for the purpose of Hardness, resistances, and weaknesses. A creature or object can only be the target of a single Tandem Chop per turn, regardless of the number of loggers in reach.

Speed 25 feet

Melee ❖ battle axe +7 (sweep), **Damage** 1d8+3 slashing

Melee ❖ hatchet +7 (agile, sweep, thrown 10 feet), **Damage** 1d6+3 slashing

Ranged ❖ hatchet +5 (agile, sweep, thrown 10 feet), **Damage** 1d6+1 slashing

MELIANSE CREATURE 5

UNIQUE | N | SMALL | AQUATIC | FEY

Female nixie (*Pathfinder Bestiary 2* 183)

Perception +11; low-light vision

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Languages Aquan, Common, Sylvan
Skills Athletics +11, Diplomacy +12, Nature +11, Stealth +13
Str +2, **Dex** +3, **Con** +1, **Int** +0, **Wis** +1, **Cha** +4
Wild Empathy Melianse can use Diplomacy to Make an Impression on aquatic or amphibious animals and make very simple Requests of them.

AC 21; **Fort** +11, **Ref** +13, **Will** +11; +1 status to all saves vs. magic
HP 78; **Weaknesses** cold iron 5

Speed 20 feet, swim 30 feet
Melee ❖ claw +15 (agile, finesse), **Damage** 2d6+5 slashing
Primal Spontaneous Spells DC 22, attack +14; **3rd** (4 slots) *earthbind*, *haste*, *heal*, *wall of wind*; **2nd** (4 slots) *dispel magic*, *glitterdust*, *obscuring mist*, *web*; **1st** (4 slots) *goblin pox*, *grease*, *spider sting*, *ventriloquism*; **Cantrips (3rd)** *dancing lights*, *ghost sound*, *ray of frost*, *shield*, *tanglefoot*
Primal Innate Spells DC 22, attack +14; **2nd** *water breathing*; **1st** *charm* (×3), *hydraulic push*
Rituals *inveigle*
Grant Desire ❖❖❖ (divination, primal) **Frequency** once per day; **Effect** Melianse can duplicate any 3rd-level spell or produce any effect with a power level in line with a 3rd-level spell, but only in response to the request or desire of a non-fey creature. The creature whose desire is granted can never again benefit from Melianse's Grant Desire ability.

MELIANSE'S TREES

30 XP

The PCs must replace three trees that have been cut down in the prime of their lives. Melianse doesn't care how the PCs replace the three trees, nor does she care what kind of trees they replace the felled ones with. She simply wants three new trees planted in her glade to help restore her home.

Source: Melianse (area **TW1**)

Completion: The easiest solution to this quest involves gathering three *tree feather tokens* and placing them near the three felled trees. If the PCs don't think of this, the nixie can suggest it, recommending they contact the dryad Tiressia to the northwest (area **KL1**). Melianse knows the dryad has a few of these *feather tokens* but suspects Tiressia will want a favor before handing over the tokens (Melianse doesn't know about the scythe tree problem facing the dryad). Alternatively, the PCs could buy three of these *feather tokens* from a merchant in a city.

Reward: Not only does Melianse agree to release the two *inveigled* lumberjacks from her control, she also agrees to teach the PCs the *inveigle* ritual if they wish. Once the PCs establish their kingdom, Melianse agrees to keep an eye out along the Greenbelt's rivers for any trouble or rumors of danger, and to spread word of the PCs' reasonable nature to other fey. As long as the PCs don't build a settlement or Work Site in this hex, they gain a +2 circumstance bonus to all checks made to resolve Hex or Settlement events in this zone.



MELIANSE

TW2. ENDANGERED EXPEDITION MODERATE 5

STANDARD

This encounter can only occur once the PCs have defeated the Stag Lord. At your discretion, you can move the location of this encounter to any river hex the PCs haven't traveled through yet.

The sound of unintelligible cursing echoes through the woods. Just visible through the trees, a small wagon sits mired in the middle of a swiftly flowing river as the waters threaten to overlap its sides. Two ponies hitched to the wagon flounder and thrash in the swirling waters, close to panicking. Two more wagons sit safely on the far bank.

Creatures: A group of gnome explorers has been surveying and mapping the Stolen Lands, looking for evidence of First World influences in the region. They've chosen this site as a good place for their base camp, but while they were setting up their tents, a band of kobolds attacked the group. The gnomes managed to drive the kobolds off, but not before the kobolds caused a lot of damage and panicked two ponies that were still hitched to the gnomes' supply wagon. The horses rushed into the water, and the wagon swiftly became lodged in the muddy river bed. The gnomes have been unable to get the wagon unstuck and now stand helplessly on the shore, watching as the powerful current threatens to wash the wagon, its cargo, and the ponies downstream.

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The expedition is made up of nine gnome explorers under the leadership of the flamboyant Jubilost Narthropple, a wealthy gnome explorer, mapmaker, and raconteur. Narthropple stands atop a small hillock next to the river, his eye blackened, glasses missing and helmet askew from the fight with the kobolds, shouting out conflicting orders and growing more furious (and scared) with each passing round the wagon is in danger. While Jubilost is much too proud to ask the PCs for help, the other gnomes are not, and they call out for aid as soon as they see the PCs, as long as the PCs don't immediately appear to be bandits or worse.



JUBILOST NARTHROPPLE

If the PCs wish to help the gnomes, they have 6 rounds to act before the wagon is lost. Anyone helping must first Swim (requiring a successful DC 15 Athletics check) to the stranded wagon, which is 15 feet offshore. Before it can be moved, the ponies must be unhitched and led to safety. Their harness has Hardness 4 and 16 HP (8 BT); it's a two-action Interact activity to unhitch one pony. A PC can then attempt to Command an Animal (DC 18 Nature check) to send one of the distressed ponies to shore (anyone with the Wild Empathy ability can instead use Diplomacy to Request that the pony move to shore). Once the ponies have been unhitched, a PC can push the wagon 5 feet toward the shore with a successful DC 20 Athletics check to Shove (up to four others can Aid on this check). If the PCs save the wagon and ponies, the gnomes cheer and invite the PCs to have a meal with them.

Narthropple has drawn up quite a collection of maps of the southern Greenbelt during his quest for encroaching energies and influences from the First World. The maps show the location of every Landmark site in zones 1–5, and they can contain up to five other encounter sites (Standard or Hidden) that you wish to direct the party toward. Jubilost's maps do not show the location of the Beast's lair (area **SP4**) or the site of the troll lair (area **NM7**).

Jubilost's maps could be very useful to the PCs, but the eccentric gnome refuses to part with them unless he is first made helpful through Diplomacy; Jubilost is initially indifferent to the PCs, and making him helpful requires a successful DC 20 check to Make an Impression. He considers his maps important secrets, so it further requires a successful DC 24 Diplomacy check to Request access to them, at which point he agrees to sell his maps for 10 gp per encounter site marked on the maps. If the PCs saved his wagon and ponies, he sells his maps for half that price. Alternately, if the PCs have discovered Hidden sites not on Jubilost's maps during their explorations, they can trade knowledge of those locations on a one-for-one basis for the locations of sites known to the gnome.

If the PCs decide to attack Jubilost and his gnomes, and you don't have access to the *Kingmaker Companion Guide*, you can either have the gnomes simply flee or use the stats for a gnome chronicler (*Gamemastery Guide* 216) to represent Jubilost.

JUBILOST NARTHROPPLE CREATURE 1

Kingmaker Companion Guide 32

Initiative Perception +4

GNOME EXPLORERS (9) CREATURE 0

Gnome servants (*Gamemastery Guide* 222)

Initiative Perception +9

Companion: If you're using the *Kingmaker Companion Guide*, Jubilost Narthropple could become one of the PCs' loyal companions; see that book for details on how to incorporate the explorer into your campaign.

Treasure: The expedition's wagons contain 200 gp worth of miscellaneous supplies and trade goods. Under no circumstances will Jubilost willingly give any of them away, although he may agree to sell some mundane supplies to the PCs at a 10-percent markup.

Reward: If the PCs help the expedition and acquire Jubilost's maps, grant them 30 XP.

TW3. STAG LORD'S FORT

LANDMARK | RESOURCE

The Stag Lord's fort is explored in detail in Part 3 of Chapter 3 (page 172).

Resource: If the PCs establish a settlement in this hex, the Stag Lord's fort functions as a free Town Hall.

TW4. ON THE PROWL MODERATE 3

STANDARD

Creatures: The Stolen Lands are full of predators, and the worst are those who can think and reason. One such menace, a cruel and cunning warg named Howl-of-the-North-Wind, has claimed this section of Tuskwater as his territory. If he spots the PCs, he informs them they have no right to be on his land; he is open about the fact he is discussing an alliance with the troll Hargulka (detailed in Chapter 4, page 200) if the PCs bring that topic up, and has no interest in any sort of accommodation with the PCs. Should they not retreat, Howl-of-the-North-Wind and his pack

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of ferocious wolves are quick to attack, pursuing any intruders for miles if need be to finish the job.

HOWL-OF-THE-NORTH-WIND CREATURE 2

Male warg (*Pathfinder Bestiary* 322)
Initiative Perception +8

WOLVES (3) CREATURE 1

Pathfinder Bestiary 334
Initiative Perception +7

WANTED: HOWL-OF-THE-NORTH-WIND

30 XP

If he still lives, stories of Howl-of-the-North-Wind spread once the PCs reach 5th level, and they'll start seeing wanted posters for the warg at this point.

Source: Wanted poster
Completion: Slay the notorious warg.
Reward: A consortium of farmers and merchants pay a bounty of 140 gp for the warg's death.



HATEFUL HERMIT

TW5. LONELY BARROW

HIDDEN RESOURCE

This area is detailed in Part 5 (page 132).

Resource: Once the Lonely Barrow is cleared of dangers, it functions as a Refuge.

TW6. THE HATEFUL HERMIT SEVERE 3

STANDARD

Creatures: The younger brother of the hermit Bokken (area **RL2**) makes his home in this area in a huge, hollow oak tree. Even more reclusive than his brother, this misanthrope long ago forgot his own name and has grown progressively crueler and more dangerous over the years. He spends his time muttering to himself or talking to the pet puma he caught and trained years ago, which he calls simply "Cat." When his cruel urges becomes too strong to ignore, the hateful hermit waylays one of the southern Greenbelt's infrequent travelers, as he finds that the act of murder calms his nerves for a time. But they always come back—both the nerves and those pesky travelers—with each victim sating his need for violence less and less effectively.

It has been weeks since his last murder, and as a result, the hateful hermit is in a bad temper and eagerly looking for a fresh victim to sate his growing bloodlust. Unless the PCs are being particularly stealthy, the hermit quickly notices them and decides to waylay them. He prefers to attack with surprise, so if he can't set up a good ambush, he poses as a friendly, harmless druid seeking balance and peace in nature while he waits for the right moment to stab one of the PCs in the back. If reduced to 10 Hit Points or less, the hermit tries to flee and later plot his revenge—even going as far as to infiltrate the PCs' growing city to strike back at them. Cat fights at the hermit's side until reduced to fewer than 15 Hit Points, at which point the puma's training breaks and it flees into the wilds, abandoning the hateful hermit.

CAT CREATURE 3

Male puma (elite leopard; *Pathfinder Bestiary* 6, 52)
Initiative Perception +9

HATEFUL HERMIT CREATURE 5

UNIQUE CE MEDIUM HUMANOID HUMAN

Male human misanthrope
Perception +11

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